

# Bēowulf

## and Other Old English Texts

Original Old English Prose and Verse

Anonymous, King Alfred, Ælfric of Eynsham, and others

Texts composed between the seventh and eleventh centuries

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# The Passing of Scyld

## Fit I

- Hwæt! wē Gār-Dena in geār-dagum  
þēod-cyninga þrym gefrūnon,  
hū þā æðelingas ellen fremedon.  
Oft Scyld Scēfing sceaðena þrēatum,  
5 monegum mægðum meodo-setla oftēah.  
Egsode eorl, syððan ærest wearð  
fēa-sceaft funden: hē þæs frōfre gebād,  
wēox under wolcnum, weorð-myndum ðāh,  
oð þæt him æghwylc þāra ymb-sittendra  
10 ofer hron-rāde hýran scolde,  
gomban gyltan: þæt wæs gōd cyning!  
þāem eafera wæs æfter cenned  
geong in geardum, þone god sende  
folce tō frōfre; fyren-þearfe ongeat,  
15 þæt hīe ær drugon aldor-lēase  
lange hwīle. Him þæs lif-frēa,  
wuldres wealdend, worold-āre forgeaf;  
Bēowulf wæs brēme (blæd wīde sprang),  
Scyldes eafera Scede-landum in.  
20 Swā sceal geong guma, gōde gewyrcean,  
fromum feoh-giftum on fæder wine,  
þæt hine on ylde eft gewunigen  
wil-gesīðas, þonne wīg cume,  
lēode gelæsten: lof-dædum sceal  
25 in mægða gehwære man geþeon.  
Him þā Scyld gewāt tō gescæp-hwīle  
fela-hrōr fēran on frēan wære;  
hī hyne þā ætbæron tō brimes faroðe.

- swāse gesiðas,    swā hē selfa bæd,  
 30 þenden wordum wēold    wine Scyldinga,  
 lēof land-fruma    lange āhte.  
 Þær æt hȳðe stōd    hringed-stefna,  
 īsig and ūtfūs,    æðelinges fær;  
 ā-lēdon þā    lēofne þēoden,  
 35 bēaga bryttan    on bearm scipes,  
 mārne be mæste.    Þær wæs mādma fela,  
 of feor-wegum    frætwa gelæded:  
 ne hȳrde ic cȳmlīcor    cēol gegyrwan  
 hilde-wæpnum    and heaðo-wædum,  
 40 billum and byrnum;    him on bearme læg  
 mādma mænigo,    þā him mid scoldon  
 on flōdes æht    feor gewītan.  
 Nalas hī hine læssan    lācum tēodan,  
 þēod-gestrēonum,    þonne þā dydon,  
 45 þē hine æt frumsceaftē    forð onsendon  
 ænne ofer ȳðe    umbor wesende:  
 þā gȳt hīe him āsetton    segen gyldenne  
 hēah ofer hēafod,    lēton holm beran,  
 gēafon on gār-secg:    him wæs geōmor sefa,  
 50 murnende mōd.    Men ne cunnon  
 secgan tō soðe    sele-rædende,  
 hæleð under heofenum,    hwā þām hlæste onfēng.

# The Hall Heorot

## Fit II

- Pā wæs on burgum      Bēowulf Scyldinga,  
lēof lēod-cyning,      longe þrāge  
55 folcum gefræge      (fæder ellor hwearf,  
aldor of earde),      oð þæt him eft onwōc  
hēah Healfdene;      hēold þenden lifde,  
gamol and gūð-rēow,      glæde Scyldingas.  
Pām fēower bearn      forð-gerīmed  
60 in worold wōcun,      weoroda ræswan,  
Heorogār and Hrōðgār      and Hālga til;  
hȳrde ic, þat Elan cwēn      Ongenþēowes wæs  
Heaðoscilfinges      heals-gebedde.  
Pā wæs Hrōðgāre      here-spēd gyfen,  
65 wīges weorð-mynd,      þæt him his wine-māgas  
georne hȳrdon,      oð þæt sēo geogoð gewēox,  
mago-driht micel.      Him on mōd bearn,  
þæt heal-reced      hātan wolde,  
medo-ærn micel      men gewyrcean,  
70 þone ylðo bearn      æfre gefrūnon,  
and þær on innan      eall gedælan  
geongum and ealdum,      swylc him god sealde,  
būton folc-scare      and feorum gumena.  
Pā ic wīde gefrægn      weorc gebannan  
75 manigre mægðe      geond þisne middan-geard,  
folc-stede frætwan.      Him on fyrste gelomp  
ædre mid yldum,      þæt hit wearð eal gearo,  
heal-ærna mæst;      scōp him Heort naman,  
sē þe his wordes geweald      wīde hæfde.  
80 Hē bēot ne ālēh,      bēagas dælde,

- sinc æt symle. Sele hlifade  
 hēah and horn-gēap: heaðo-wylma bād,  
 lāðan līges; ne wæs hit lenge þā gēn  
 þæt se ecg-hete āðum-swerian  
 85 æfter wæl-nīðe wæcnan scolde.  
 Þā se ellen-gæst earfoðlice  
 þrāge gepolode, sē þe in þýstrum bād,  
 þæt hē dōgora gehwām drēam gehýrde  
 hlūdne in healle; þær wæs hearpan swēg,  
 90 swutol sang scopes. Sægde sē þe cūðe  
 frum-sceaft fīra feorran reccan,  
 cwæð þæt se ælmihtiga eorðan worhte,  
 wlite-beorhtne wang, swā wæter bebūgeð,  
 gesette sige-hrēðig sunnan and mōnan  
 95 lēoman tō lēohte land-būendum,  
 and gefræt Wade foldan scēatas  
 leomum and lēafum; lif ēac gesceop  
 cynna gehwylcum, þāra þe cwice hwyrfað.  
 Swā þā driht-guman drēamum lifdon  
 100 ēadiglice, oð þæt ān ongan  
 fyrene fremman, fēond on helle:  
 wæs se grimma gæst Grendel hāten,  
 mære mearc-stapa, sē þe mōras hēold,  
 fen and fæsten; fifel-cynnes eard  
 105 won-sælig wer weardode hwīle,  
 siððan him scyppend forscrifen hæfde.  
 In Caines cynne þone cwealm gewræc,  
 ēce drihten, þæs þe hē Ābel slōg;  
 ne gefeah hē þære fæhðe, ac hē hine feor forwræc,  
 110 metod for þý mǣne man-cynne fram.  
 Þanon untýdras ealle onwōcon,  
 eotenas and ylfe and orcnēas,  
 swylce gīgantas, þā wið gode wunnon  
 lange þrāge; hē him þæs lēan forgeald.



# Grendel's Visits

## Fit III

- 115 Gewāt þā nēosian, syððan niht becōm,  
hēan hūses, hū hit Hring-Dene  
æfter bēor-þege gebūn hæfdon.  
Fand þā þær inne æðelinga gedriht  
swefan æfter symble; sorge ne cūðon,  
120 won-sceaft wera. Wiht unhælo  
grim and grædig gearo sōna wæs,  
rēoc and rēðe, and on ræste genam  
þrītig þegna: þanon eft gewāt  
hūðe hrēmig tō hām faran,  
125 mid þære wæl-fylle wīca nēosan.  
Þā wæs on ūhtan mid ær-dæge  
Grendles gūð-cræft gumum undyrne:  
þā wæs æfter wiste wōp up āhafen,  
micel morgen-swēg. Mære þēoden,  
130 æðeling ær-gōd, unbliðe sæt,  
þolode þrȳð-swȳð, þegn-sorge drēah,  
syððan hīe þæs lāðan lāst scēawedon,  
wergan gāstes; wæs þæt gewin tō strang,  
lāð and longsum. Næs hit lengra fyrst,  
135 ac ymb āne niht eft gefremede  
morð-beala mære and nō mearn fore  
fæhðe and fyrene; wæs tō fæst on þām.  
Þā wæs ēað-fynde, þē him elles hwær  
gerūmlicor ræste sōhte,  
140 bed æfter būrum, þā him gebēacnod wæs,  
gesægd sōðlice sweotolan tātne  
heal-þegnes hete; hēold hine syððan

- fyr and fæstor,    sē þāem fēonde ætwand.  
 Swā rīxode    and wið rihte wan  
 145 āna wið eallum,    oð þæt īdel stōd  
 hūsa sēlest.    Wæs sēo hwīl micel:  
 twelf wintra tīd    torn gēpolode  
 wine Scyldinga,    wēana gehwelcne,  
 sīdra sorga;    forþām syððan wearð  
 150 ylða bearnum    undyrne cūð,  
 gyddum geōmore,    þætte Grendel wan,  
 hwīle wið Hrōðgār;—    hete-nīðas wæg,  
 fyrene and fāhðe    fela missēra,  
 singāle sæce,    sibbe ne wolde  
 155 wið manna hwone    mægenes Deniga  
 feorh-bealo feorran,    fēo þingian,  
 nē þær nænig witenas    wēnan þorfte  
 beorhtre bōte    tō banan folmum;  
 atol æglæca    ēhtende wæs,  
 160 deorc dēað-scūa    duguðe and geogoðe  
 seomade and syrede.    Sin-nihte hēold  
 mistige mōras;    men ne cunnon,  
 hwyder hel-rūnan    hwyrftum scrīðað.  
 Swā fela fyrena    fēond man-cynnes,  
 165 atol ān-geŋea,    oft gefremede  
 heardra hȳnða;    Heorot eardode,  
 sinc-fāge sel    sweartum nihtum  
 (nō hē þone gif-stōl    grētan mōste,  
 māððum for metode,    nē his myne wisse);  
 170 þæt wæs wræc micel    wine Scyldinga,  
 mōdes brecða.    Monig-oft gesæt  
 rīce tō rūne;    ræd eahtedon,  
 hwæt swīð-ferhðum    sēlest wære  
 wið fār-gryrum    tō gefremmanne.  
 175 Hwīlum hīe gehēton    æt hærg-trafum  
 wīg-weorðunga,    wordum bædon,  
 þæt him gāst-bona    gēoce gefremede  
 wið þēod-þrēaum.    Swylc wæs þēaw hyra,  
 hāðenra hyht;    helle gemundon  
 180 in mōd-sefan,    metod hīe ne cūðon,  
 dæda dēmend,    ne wiston hīe drihten god,

nē hīe hūru heofena helm    herian ne cūðon,  
wuldres waldend.    Wā bið þāē m þe sceal  
þurh sliðne nīð    sāwle bescūfan  
185 in fýres fæðm,    frōfre ne wēnan,  
wihte gewendan;    wēl bið þāē m þe mōt  
æfter dēað-dæge    drihten sēcean  
and tō fæder fæðmum    freoðo wilnian.

# Hygelac's Thane

## Fit IV

- Swā þā mæl-ceare    maga Healfdenes  
190 singāla sēað;    ne mihte snotor hæleð  
wēan onwendan:    wæs þæt gewin tō swyð,  
lāð and longsum,    þē on þā lēode becōm,  
nȳd-wracu nīð-grim,    niht-bealwa mæst.  
Þæt fram hām gefrægn    Higelāces þegn,  
195 gōd mid Gēatum,    Grendles dæda:  
sē wæs mon-cynnes    mægenes strengest  
on þæm dæge    þysse lifes,  
æðele and ēacen.    Hēt him ȳð-lidan  
gōdne gegyrwan;    cwæð hē gūð-cyning  
200 ofer swan-rāde    sēcean wolde,  
mærne þēoden,    þā him wæs manna þearf.  
Þone sīð-fæt him    snotere ceorlas  
lȳt-hwōn lōgon,    þēah hē him lēof wære;  
hwetton higerōfne,    hæl scēawedon.  
205 Hæfde se gōda    Gēata lēoda  
cempan gecorone,    þāra þe hē cēnoste  
findan mihte;    fiftȳna sum  
sund-wudu sōhte;    secg wīsade,  
lagu-cræftig mon,    land-gemyrcu.  
210 Fyrst forð gewāt:    flota wæs on ȳðum,  
bāt under beorge.    Beornas gearwe  
on stefn stigon;    strēamas wundon  
sund wið sande;    secgas bāron  
on bearm nacan    beorhte frætwe,  
215 gūð-searo geatolīc;    guman ūt scufon,  
weras on wil-sīð    wudu bundenne.

- Gewāt þā ofer wæg-holm      winde gefȳsed  
 flota fāmig-heals      fugle gelicost,  
 oð þæt ymb ān-tīd      oðres dōgores  
 220 wunden-stefna      gewaden hæfde,  
 þæt þā liðende      land gesāwon,  
 brim-clifu blīcan,      beorgas stēape,  
 sīde sǣ-næssas:      þā wæs sund liden,  
 eoletes æt ende.      Þanon up hraðe  
 225 Wedera lēode      on wang stigon,  
 sǣ-wudu sǣldon      (syrċan hrysedon,  
 gūð-gewædo);      gode þancedon,  
 þæs þe him ȳð-lāde      ēaðe wurdon.  
 Þā of wealle geseah      weard Scildinga,  
 230 sē þe holm-clifu      healdan scolde,  
 beran ofer bolcan      beorhte randas,  
 fyrð-searu fūslicu;      hine fyrwyt bræc  
 mōð-gehygdum,      hwæt þā men wæron.  
 Gewāt him þā tō waroðe      wicge rīdan  
 235 þegn Hrōðgāres,      þrymmum cwehte  
 mægen-wudu mundum,      meðel-wordum frægn:  
 "Hwæt syndon gē      searo-hæbbendra  
 "byrnum werede,      þē þus brontne cēol  
 "ofer lagu-stræte      lǣdan cwōmon,  
 240 "hider ofer holmas      helmas bāeron?  
 "Ic wæs ende-sǣta,      æg-wearde hēold,  
 "þæt on land Dena      lāðra nǣnig  
 "mid scip-herge      sceððan ne meahte.  
 "Nō hēr cūðlicor      cuman ongunnon  
 245 "lind-hæbbende;      nē gē lēafnes-word  
 "gūð-fremmendra      gearwe ne wisson,  
 "māga gemēdu.      Nǣfre ic mārān geseah  
 "eorla ofer eorðan,      þonne is ēower sum,  
 "secg on searwum;      nis þæt seld-guma  
 250 "wæpnum geweorðad,      nǣfne him his wlite lēoge,  
 "ǣnlic an-sȳn.      Nū ic ēower sceal  
 "frum-cyn witan,      ær gē fyr heonan  
 "lēase scēaweras      on land Dena  
 "furður fēran.      Nū gē feor-būend,  
 255 "mere-liðende,      mīnne gehȳrað

"ān-fealdne gepōht:      ofost is sēlest  
"tō gecyðanne,      hwanan ēowre cyme syndon."

# The Errand

## Fit V

- Him se yldesta      andswarode,  
werodes wīsa,      word-hord onlēac:  
260 "Wē synt gum-cynnes      Gēata lēode  
"and Higelāces      heorð-genēatas.  
"Wæs mīn fæder      folcum gecyðed,  
"æðele ord-fruma      Ecgpēow hāten;  
"gebād wintra worn,      ær hē on weg hwurfe,  
265 "gamol of geardum;      hine gearwe geman  
"witena wēl-hwylc      wīde geond eorðan.-  
"Wē þurh holdne hige      hlāford þinne,  
"sunu Healfdenes,      sēcean cwōmon,  
"lēod-gebyrgēan:      wes þū ūs lārena gōd!  
270 "Habbað wē tō þām mæran      micel ærende  
"Deniga frēan;      ne sceal þær dyrne sum  
"wesān, þæs ic wēne.      Þū wāst, gif hit is,  
"swā wē sōðlice      secgan hýrdon,  
"þæt mid Scyldingum      sceaða ic nāt hwylc,  
275 "dēogol dæd-hata,      deorcum nihtum  
"ēaweð þurh egsan      uncūðne nīð,  
"hýnðu and hrā-fyl.      Ic þæs Hrōðgār mæg  
"þurh rūmne sefan      ræd gelæran,  
"hū hē frōd and gōd      fēond oferswýðeð,  
280 "gyf him ed-wendan      æfre scolde  
"bealuwa bisigu,      bōt eft cuman  
"and þā cear-wylmas      cōlran wurðað;  
"oððe ā syððan      earfoð-þrāge,  
"prēa-nýd þolað,      þenden þær wunað  
285 "on hēah-stede      hūsa sēlest."

- Weard maðelode, þær on wicge sæt  
 ombeht unforht: "Æghwæðres sceal  
 "scearp scyld-wiga gescād witan,  
 "worda and worca, sē þe wēl þenceð.  
 290 "Ic þæt gehyre, þæt þis is hold weorod  
 "frēan Scyldinga. Gewītað forð beran  
 "wæpen and gewædu, ic ēow wīsigē:  
 "swylce ic magu-þegnas mīne hāte  
 "wið fēonda gehwone flotan ēowerne,  
 295 "nīw-tyrwedne nacan on sande  
 "ārum healdan, oð þæt eft byrēð  
 "ofer lagu-strēamas lēofne mannan  
 "wudu wunden-hals tō Weder-mearce.  
 "Gūð-fremmendra swylcum gifeðe bið,  
 300 "þæt þone hilde-ræs hāl gedīgeð."  
 Gewiton him þā fēran (flota stille bād,  
 seomode on sāle sīd-fæðmed scyp,  
 on ancre fæst); eofor-līc scionon  
 ofer hlēor-beran gehroden golde  
 305 fāh and fȳr-heard, ferh wearde hēold.  
 Gūðmōde grummon, guman ōnetton,  
 sigon ætsomne, oð þæt hȳ sæl timbred  
 geatolic and gold-fāh ongytan mihton;  
 þæt wæs fore-mærost fold-būendum  
 310 receda under roderum, on þām se rīca bād;  
 līxte se lēoma ofer landa fela.  
 Him þā hilde-dēor hof mōdigra  
 torht getæhte, þæt hīe him tō mihton  
 gegnum gangan; gūð-beorna sum  
 315 wicg gewende, word æfter cwæð:  
 "Mæl is mē tō fēran; fæder alwalda  
 "mid ār-stafum ēowic gehealde  
 "sīða gesunde! ic tō sǣ wille,  
 "wið wrāð werod wearde healdan."



# Bēowulf's Speech

## Fit VI

- 320 Stræt wæs stān-fāh,      stīg wīode  
gumum ætgædere.      Gūð-byrne scān  
heard hond-locen,      hring-īren scīr  
song in searwum,      þā hīe tō sele furðum  
in hyra gryre-geatwum      gangan cwōmon.
- 325 Setton sǣ-mēðe      sīde scyldas,  
rondas regn-hearde      wið þæs recedes weal,  
bugon þā tō bence;      byrnan hringdon,  
gūð-searo gumena;      gāras stōdon,  
sǣ-manna searo,      samod ætgædere,
- 330 æsc-holt ufan græg:      wæs se īren-þrēat  
wæpnum gewurðad.      Þā þær wlonc hæleð  
ōret-mecgas      æfter æðelum frægn:  
"Hwanon ferigeað gē      fætte scyldas,  
"græge syrcan      and grīm-helmas,
- 335 "here-sceafta hēap?—      Ic eom Hrōðgāres  
"ār and ombiht.      Ne seah ic el-þeodige  
"þus manige men      mōdiglīcran.  
"Wēn' ic þæt gē for wlenco,      nalles for wræc-siðum,  
"ac for hige-þrymmum      Hrōðgār sōhton."
- 340 Him þā ellen-rōf      andswarode,  
wlanc Wedera lēod      word æfter spræc,  
heard under helme:      "Wē synt Higelāces  
"bēod-genēatas;      Bēowulf is mīn nama.  
"Wille ic āsecgan      suna Healfdenes,
- 345 "mārum þeodne      mīn ārende,  
"aldre þīnum,      gif hē ūs geunnan wile,  
"þæt wē hine swā gōdne      grētan mōton."

- Wulfgār maðelode    (þæt wæs Wendla lēod,  
 wæs his mōd-sefa    manegum gecyðed,  
 350 wīg and wīs-dōm):    "ic þæs wine Deniga,  
 "frēan Scildinga    frīnan wille,  
 "bēaga bryttan,    swā þū bēna eart,  
 "þēoden mærne    ymb þīnne sīð ;  
 "and þē þā andsware    ædre gecyðan,  
 355 "þē mē se gōda    āgīfan þenceð."  
 Hwearf þā hrædlīce,    þær Hrōðgār sæt,  
 eald and unhār    mid his eorla gedriht;  
 ēode ellen-rōf,    þæt hē for eaxlum gestōd  
 Deniga frēan,    cūðe hē duguðe þēaw.  
 360 Wulfgār maðelode    tō his wine-drihtne:  
 "Hēr syndon geferede    feorran cumene  
 "ofer geofenes begang    Gēata lēode:  
 "þone yldestan    ōret-mecgas  
 "Bēowulf nemnað.    Hȳ bēnan synt,  
 365 "þæt hīe, þēoden mīn,    wið þē mōton  
 "wordum wrixlan;    nō þū him wearne getēoh,  
 "þīnra gegn-cwida    glædnian, Hrōðgār!  
 "Hȳ on wīg-geatwum    wyrðe þinceað  
 "eorla geæhtlan;    hūru se aldor dēah,  
 370 "sē þæm heaðo-rincum    hider wīsade."

# Hrothgar's Welcome

## Fit VII

- Hrōðgār maðelode, helm Scyldinga:  
"Ic hine cūðe cniht-wesende.  
"Wæs his eald-fæder Ecgbēo hāten,  
"þāem tō hām forgeaf Hrēðel Gēata  
375 "āngan dōhtor; is his eafora nū  
"heard hēr cumen, sōhte holdne wine.  
"þonne sægdon þæt sǣ-liðende,  
"þā þe gif-sceattas Gēata fyredon  
"þyder tō þance, þæt hē þrīttiges  
380 "manna mægen-cræft on his mund-grīpe  
"heaðo-rōf hæbbe. Hine hālig god  
"for ār-stafum us onsende,  
"tō West-Denum, þæs ic wēn hæbbe,  
"wið Grendles gryre: ic þāem gōdan sceal  
385 "for his mōd-þræce mādmas bēodan.  
"Bēo þū on ofeste, hāt hig in gān,  
"sēon sibbe-gedriht samod ætgædere;  
"gesaga him ēac wordum, þæt hīe sint wil-cuman  
"Deniga lēodum." þā wið duru healle  
390 Wulfgār ēode, word inne ābēad:  
"Ēow hēt secgan sige-drihten mīn,  
"aldor Ēast-Dena, þæt hē ēower æðelu can  
"and gē him syndon ofer sǣ-wylmas,  
"heard-hicgende, hider wil-cuman.  
395 "Nū gē mōton gangan in ēowrum guð-geatawum,  
"under here-grīman, Hrōðgār gesēon;  
"lætað hilde-bord hēr onbidian,  
"wudu wæl-scaftas, worda geþinges."

- Ārās þā se rīca,      ymb hine rinc manig,  
 400 þrȳðlic þegna hēap;      sume þær bidon,  
 heaðo-rēaf hēoldon,      swā him se hearda bebēad.  
 Snyredon ætsomne,      þā secg wīsoðe  
 under Heorotes hrōf;      hyge-rōf ēode,  
 heard under helme,      þæt hē on heoðe gestōd.  
 405 Bēowulf maðelode      (on him byrne scān,  
 searo-net sēowed      smiðes or-þancum):  
 "Wes þū Hrōðgār hāl!      ic eom Higelāces  
 "mæg and mago-þegn;      hæbbe ic mærdā fela  
 "ongunnen on geogoðe.      Mē wearð Grendles þing  
 410 "on mīnre ēðel-tyrf      undyrne cūð:  
 "secgað sǣ-līðend,      þæt þes sele stande,  
 "reced sēlesta,      rinca gehwylcum  
 "īdel and unnyt,      siððan æfen-lēoht  
 "under heofenes hādor      beholen weorðeð.  
 415 "Þā mē þæt gelærdon      lēode mīne,  
 "þā sēlestan,      snotere ceorlas,  
 "þeoden Hrōðgār,      þæt ic þē sōhte;  
 "forþan hīe mægenes cræft      mīnne cūðon:  
 "selfe ofersāwon,      þā ic of searwum cwōm,  
 420 "fāh from fēondum,      þær ic fīfe geband,  
 "ȳðde eotena cyn,      and on ȳðum slōg  
 "niceras nihtes,      nearo-þearfe drēah,  
 "wræc Wedera nīð      (wēan āhsodon)  
 "forgrand gramum;      and nū wið Grendel sceal,  
 425 "wið þām āglæcan,      āna gehegan  
 "þing wið þyrse.      Ic þē nū þā,  
 "brego Beorht-Dena,      biddan wille,  
 "eodor Scyldinga,      ānre bēne;  
 "þæt þū mē ne forwyrne,      wīgendra hlēo,  
 430 "frēo-wine folca,      nū ic þus feorran cōm,  
 "þæt ic mōte āna      and mīnra eorla gedryht,  
 "þes hearda hēap,      Heorot fǣlsian.  
 "Hæbbe ic ēac geāhsod,      þæt se āglæca  
 "for his won-hȳdum      wǣpna ne rēceð;  
 435 "ic þæt þonne forhicge,      swā mē Higelāc sīe,  
 "mīn mon-drihten,      mōdes blīðe,  
 "þæt ic sweord bere      oððe sīðne scyld

- "geolo-rand tō gūðe;    ac ic mid grāpe sceal  
 "fōn wið fēonde    and ymb feorh sacan,  
 440 "lāð wið lāðum;    þær gelyfan sceal  
 "dryhtnes dōme    sē þe hine dēað nimeð.  
 "Wēn' ic þæt hē wille,    gif hē wealdan mōt,  
 "in þām gūð-sele    Gēatena lēode  
 "etan unforhte,    swā hē oft dyde  
 445 "mægen Hrēðmanna.    Nā þū mīnne þearft  
 "hafalan hȳdan,    ac hē mē habban wile  
 "drēore fāhne,    gif mec dēað nimeð;  
 "byrēð blōdig wæl,    byrgean þenceð,  
 "eteð ān-genga    unmunlīce,  
 450 "mearcað mōr-hopu:    nō þū ymb mīnes ne þearft  
 "līces feorme    leng sorgian.  
 "Onsend Higelāce,    gif mec hild nime,  
 "beadu-scrūda betst,    þæt mīne brēost wereð,  
 "hrægla sēlest;    þæt is Hrēðlan lāf,  
 455 "Wēlandes geweorc.    Gæð ā Wyrð swā hīo scel!"

# Hrothgar Tells of Grendel

## Fit VIII

- Hrōðgār maðelode,    helm Scyldinga:  
"for were-fyhtum þū,    wine mīn Bēowulf,  
"and for ār-stafum    ūsic sōhtest.  
"Geslōh þin fæder    fæhðe mæste,  
460 "wearð hē Heaðolāfe    tō hand-bonan  
"mid Wilfingum;    þā hine Wedera cyn  
"for here-brōgan    habban ne mihte.  
"Panon hē gesōhte    Sūð-Dena folc  
"ofer yða gewealc,    Ār-Scyldinga;  
465 "þā ic furðum wēold    folce Deninga,  
"and on geogoðe hēold    gimme-rīce  
"hord-burh hæleða:    þā wæs Heregār dēad,  
"mīn yldra mæg    unlifigende,  
"bearn Healfdenes.    Sē wæs betera þonne ic!  
470 "Siððan þā fæhðe    fēo þingode;  
"sende ic Wylfingum    ofer wæteres hrycg  
"ealde mādmas:    hē mē āðas swōr.  
"Sorh is mē tō secganne    on sefan mīnum  
"gumena ængum,    hwæt mē Grendel hafað  
475 "hȳnðo on Heorote    mid his hete-þancum,  
"fær-niða gefremed.    Is mīn flet-werod,  
"wīg-hēap gewanod;    hīe Wyrð forswēop  
"on Grendles gryre.    God ēaðe mæg  
"þone dol-scaðan    dæda getwæfan!  
480 "Ful oft gebēotedon    bēore druncne  
"ofer ealo-wæge    ōret-mecgas,  
"þæt hīe in bēor-sele    bīdan woldon  
"Grendles gūðe    mid gryrum ecga.

- "Þonne wæs þēos medo-heal    on morgen-tīd,  
 485 "driht-sele drēor-fāh,    þonne dæg līxte,  
 "eal benc-þelu    blōde bestȳmed,  
 "heall heoru-drēore:    āhte ic holdra þȳ lāes,  
 "dēorre duguðe,    þē þā dēað fornam.  
 "Site nū tō symle    and onsæl meoto,  
 490 "sige-hrēð secgum,    swā þīn sefa hwette!"  
 Þā wæs Gēat-mæcgum    geador ætsomne  
 on bēor-sele    benc gerȳmed;  
 þær swīð-ferhðe    sittan ēodon  
 þrȳðum dealle.    Þegn nytte behēold,  
 495 sē þe on handa bær    hroden ealo-wæge,  
 scencte scīr wered.    Scop hwīlum sang  
 hādor on Heorote;    þær wæs haeleða drēam,  
 duguð unlȳtel    Dena and Wedera.

# Hunferth Objects to Bēowulf

## Fit IX

Unferð maðelode,    Ecglāfes bearn,  
500 þē æt fōtum sæt    frēan Scyldinga;  
onband beadu-rūne    (wæs him Bēowulfes sīð,  
mōdges mere-faran,    micel æf-þunca,  
forþon þe hē ne ūðe,    þæt ænig oðer man  
æfre mærdða þon mā    middan-geardes  
505 gehēdde under heofenum    þonne hē sylfa):  
"Eart þū sē Bēowulf,    sē þe wið Breca wunne,  
"on sīdne sē    ymb sund flite,  
"þær git for wlence    wada cunnedon  
"and for dol-gilpe    on dēop wæter  
510 "aldrum nēðdon?    Nē inc ænig mon,  
"nē lēof nē lāð,    belēan mihte  
"sorh-fullne sīð;    þā git on sund rēon,  
"þær git ēagor-strēam    earmum þehton,  
"mæton mere-stræta,    mundum brugdon,  
515 "glidon ofer gār-secg;    geofon yðum wēol,  
"wintres wylme.    Git on wæteres æht  
"seofon niht swuncon;    hē þē æt sunde oferflāt,  
"hæfde mære mægen.    Þā hine on morgen-tīd  
"on Heaðo-ræmas    holm up ætbær,  
520 "þonon hē gesōhte    swæsne ēðel  
"lēof his lēodum    lond Brondinga,  
"freoðo-burh fægere,    þær hē folc ahte,  
"burg and bēagas.    Bēot eal wið þē



- "sunu Bēanstānes    sōðe gelæste.  
 525 "Ponne wēne ic tō þē    wyrstan geþinges,  
 "þeah þū heaðo-ræsa    gehwær dohte,  
 "grimre gūðe,    gif þū Grendles dearest  
 "niht-longne fyrst    nēan bīdan!"  
 Bēowulf maðelode,    bearn Ecgbēowes:  
 530 "Hwæt! þū worn fela,    wine mīn Unferð,  
 "bēore druncen    ymb Breca spræce,  
 "sægdest from his siðe!    Sōð ic talige,  
 "þæt ic mere-strengo    māran āhte,  
 "earfeðo on yðum,    þonne ænig oðer man.  
 535 "Wit þæt gecwædon    cniht-wesende  
 "and gebēotedon    (wæron bēgen þā gīt  
 "on geogoð-feore)    þæt wit on gār-secg ūt  
 "aldrum nēðdon;    and þæt geæfndon swā.  
 "Hæfdon swurd nacod,    þā wit on sund rēon,  
 540 "heard on handa,    wit unc wið hron-fixas  
 "werian þohton.    Nō hē wiht fram mē  
 "flōd-yðum feor    flēotan meahte,  
 "hraðor on holme,    nō ic fram him wolde.  
 "Þā wit ætsomne    on sǣ wæron  
 545 "fif nihta fyrst,    oð þæt unc flōd tōdrāf,  
 "wado weallende,    wedera cealdost,  
 "nīpende niht    and norðan wind  
 "heaðo-grim andhwearf;    hrēo wæron yða,  
 "Wæs mere-fixa    mōd onhrēred:  
 550 "þær mē wið lāðum    līc-syrce mīn,  
 "heard hond-locen,    helpe gefremede;  
 "beado-hrægl brōden    on brēostum læg,  
 "golde gegyrwed.    Mē tō grunde tēah  
 "fāh fēond-scaða,    fæste hæfde  
 555 "grim on grāpe:    hwæðre mē gyfeðe wearð,  
 "þæt ic āglæcan    orde geræhte,  
 "hilde-bille;    heaðo-ræs fornam  
 "mihtig mere-dēor    þurh mīne hand.

# Bēowulf's Contest with Breca.-The Feast

## Fit X

- "Swā mec gelōme      lāð-getēonan  
560 "prēatedon þearle.      Ic him þenode  
"dēoran sweorde,      swā hit gedēfe wæs;  
"næs hīe þære fülle      gefēan hæfdon,  
"mān-fordædlan,      þæt hīe mē þēgon,  
"symbel ymb-sæton      sǣ-grunde nēah,  
565 "ac on mergenne      mēcum wunde  
"be yð-lāfe      uppe lāgon,  
"sweordum āswefede,      þæt syððan nā  
"ymb brontne ford      brim-liðende  
"lāde ne letton.      Lēoht ēastan cōm,  
570 "beorht bēacen godes;      brimu swaðredon,  
"þæt ic sǣ-næssas      gesēon mihte,  
"windige weallas.      Wyrð oft nereð  
"unfægne eorl,      ðonne his ellen dēah!  
"Hwæðere mē gesǣlde,      þæt ic mid sweorde ofslōh  
575 "niceras nigene.      Nō ic on niht gefrægn  
"under heofones hwealf      heardran feohtan,  
"nē on ēg-strēamum      earmran mannan;  
"hwæðere ic fāra feng      fēore gedīgde,  
"siðes wērig.      Þā mec sǣ oðbær,  
580 "flōd æfter faroðe,      on Finna land,  
"wadu weallendu.      Nō ic wiht fram þē  
"swylcra searo-nīða      secgan hȳrde,  
"billa brōgan:      Breca næfre gīt

- "æt heaðo-lāce,    nē gehwæðer incer  
 585 "swā dēorlice    dæd gefremede  
      "fāgum sweordum    . . . . .  
      " . . . . .    nō ic þæs gylpe;  
      "þēah þū þīnum brōðrum    tō banan wurde,  
      "hēafod-mægum;    þæs þū in helle scealt  
 590 "werhðo drēogan,    þēah þīn wit duge,  
      "Secge ic þē tō sōðe,    sunu Ecglāfes,  
      "þæt næfre Grendel swā fela    gryra gefremede,  
      "atol æglæca    ealdre þīnum,  
      "hȳnðo on Heorote,    gif þīn hige wære,  
 595 "sefa swā searo-grim,    swā þū self talast.  
      "Ac hē hafað onfunden,    þæt hē þā fæhðe ne þearf,  
      "atole ecg-þræce    ēower lēode  
      "swīðe onsittan,    Sige-Scyldinga;  
      "nymeð nȳd-bāde,    nānegum ārað  
 600 "lēode Deniga,    ac hē on lust wīgeð,  
      "swefeð ond sendeð,    secce ne wēneð  
      "tō Gār-Denum.    Ac him Gēata sceal  
      "eafōð and ellen    ungeāra nū  
      "gūðe gebēodan.    Gæð eft sē þe mōt  
 605 "tō medo mōdig,    siððan morgen-lēoht  
      "ofer ylða bearn    oðres dōgores,  
      "sunne swegl-wered    sūðan scīneð!"  
      Þā wæs on sālum    sinces brytta  
      gamol-feax and gūð-rōf,    gēoce gelyfde  
 610 brego Beorht-Dena;    gehȳrde on Bēowulfe  
      folces hyrde    fæst-rædne geþōht.  
      Þær wæs hæleða hleahtor;    hlyn swynsode,  
      word wæron wynsume.    Ēode Wealhþēow forð,  
      cwēn Hrōðgāres,    cynna gemyndig,  
 615 grētte gold-hroden    guman on healle,  
      and þā frēolic wīf    ful gesealde  
      ærest Ēast-Dena    ēðel-wearde,  
      bæd hine bliðne    æt þære bēor-þege,  
      lēodum lēofne;    hē on lust geþeah  
 620 symbel and sele-ful,    sige-rōf kyning.  
      Ymb-ēode þā    ides Helminga  
      duguðe and geogoðe    dæl æghwylcne;

- sinc-fato sealde,      oð þæt sæl ālamp,  
 þæt hīo Bēowulfe,      bēag-hroden cwēn,  
 625 mōde gepungen,      medo-ful ætbær;  
 grētte Gēata lēod,      gode þancode  
 wīs-fæst wordum,      þæs þe hire se willa gelamp,  
 þæt hēo on ænigne      eorl gelyfde  
 fyrena frōfre.      Hē þæt ful geþeah,  
 630 wæl-rēow wiga      æt Wealhþēon,  
 and þā gyddode      gūðe gefýsed,  
 Bēowulf maðelode,      bearn Ecgþēowes:  
 "Ic þæt hogode,      þā ic on holm gestāh,  
 "sæ-bāt gesæt      mid mīnra secga gedriht,  
 635 "þæt ic ānunga      ēowra lēoda  
 "willan geworhte,      oððe on wæl crunge,  
 "fēond-grāpum fæst.      Ic gefremman sceal  
 "eorlic ellen,      oððe ende-dæg  
 "on þisse meodu-healle      mīnne gebīdan."  
 640 Þām wīfe þā word      wēl licodon,  
 gilp-cwide Gēates;      ēode gold-hroden  
 frēolicu folc-cwēn      tō hire frēan sittan.  
 Þā wæs eft swā ær      inne on healle  
 þrȳð-word sprecen,      þēod on sǣlum,  
 645 sige-folca swēg,      oð þæt semninga  
 sunu Healfdenes      sēcean wolde  
 æfen-ræste;      wiste æt þām āhlācan  
 tō þām hēah-sele      hilde gepīnged,  
 siððan hīe sunnan lēoht      gesēon ne meahton,  
 650 oððe nīpende      niht ofer ealle,  
 scadu-helma gesceapu      scrīðan cwōman,  
 wan under wolcnum.      Werod eall ārās.  
 Grētte þā giddum      guma oðerne,  
 Hrōðgār Bēowulf,      and him hæl ābēad,  
 655 wīn-ærnes geweald      and þæt word ācwæð:  
 "Nǣfre ic ænegum men      ær ālyfde,  
 "siððan ic hond and rond      hebban mihte,  
 "þrȳð-ærn Dena      būton þē nū þā.  
 "Hafa nū and geheald      hūsa sēlest;  
 660 "gemyne mǣrðo,      mægen-ellen cȳð,  
 "waca wið wrāðum!      Ne bið þē wilna gād,

”gif þū þæt ellen-weorc     aldre gedīgest.”

# The Watch for Grendel

## Fit XI

Ƣā him Hrōðgār gewāt    mid his hæleða gedryht,  
eodur Scyldinga    ūt of healle;  
665 wolde wīg-fruma    WealhƢeo sēcan,  
cwēn tō gebeddan    Hæfde kyninga wuldor  
Grendle tō-gēanes,    swā guman gefrungon,  
sele-weard āseted,    sundor-nytte behēold  
ymb aldor Dena,    eoton weard ābēad;  
670 hūru Gēata lēod    georne truwode  
mōdgan mægnes,    metodes hylde.  
Ƣā hē him of dyde    īsern-byrnan,  
helm of hafelan,    sealde his hyrsted sweord,  
īrena cyst    ombiht-Ƣegne,  
675 and gehealdan hēt    hilde-geatwe.  
GesƢræc Ƣā se gōda    gylƢ-worda sum  
Bēowulf Gēata,    ær hē on bed stige:  
"Nō ic mē an here-wæsmum    hnāgran talige  
"gūð-geweorca,    Ƣonne Grendel hine;  
680 "forƢan ic hine sweorde    swebban nelle,  
"aldre benēotan,    Ƣēah ic eal mæge.  
"Nāt hē Ƣāra gōda,    Ƣæt hē mē on-gēan slēa,  
"rand gehēawe,    Ƣēah Ƣe hē rōf sīe  
"nīð-geweorca;    ac wit on niht sculon  
685 "secge ofersittan,    gif hē gesēcean dear  
"wīg ofer wæƢen,    and siððan wītig god  
"on swā hwæðere hond    hālig dryhten  
"mærdō dēme,    swā him gemet Ƣince."  
Hylde hine Ƣā heaðo-dēor,    hlēor-bolster onfēng  
690 eorles andwlitan;    and hine ymb monig

snellīc sǣ-rinc      sele-reste gebēah.  
 Nǣnig heora þōhte      þæt hē þanon scolde  
 eft eard-lufan      æfre gesēcean,  
 folc oððe frēo-burh,      þær hē āfēded wæs,  
 695 ac hīe hæfdon gefrūnen,      þæt hīe ær tō fela micles  
 in þām wīn-sele      wæl-dēað fornam,  
 Denigea lēode.      Ac him dryhten forgeaf  
 wīg-spēda gewiofu,      Wedera lēodum  
 frōfor and fultum,      þæt hīe fēond heora  
 700 þurh ānes cræft      ealle ofercōmon,  
 selfes mihtum:      sōð is gecyðed,  
 þæt mihtig god      manna cynnes  
 wēold wīde-ferhð.      Cōm on wanre niht  
 scrīðan sceadu-genga.      Scēotend swæfon,  
 705 þā þæt horn-reced      healdan scoldon,  
 ealle būton ānum.      Þæt wæs yldum cūð,  
 þæt hīe ne mōste,      þā metod nolde,  
 se syn-scaða      under sceadu bregdan;  
 ac hē wæccende      wrāðum on andan  
 710 bād bolgen-mōd      beadwa geþinges.

# Grendel's Raid

## Fit XII

- Þā cōm of mōre     under mist-hleoðum  
Grendel gongan,     godes yrre bær.  
Mynte se mǣn-scaða     manna cynnes  
sumne besyrwan     in sele þām hēan;  
715 wōð under wolcnum,     tō þæs þe hē wīn-reced,  
gold-sele gumena,     gearwost wisse  
fættum fāhne.     Ne wæs þæt forma sīð,  
þæt hē Hrōðgāres     hām gesōhte:  
nǣfre hē on aldor-dagum     ær nē siððan  
720 heardran hæle,     heal-þegnas fand!  
Cōm þā tō recede     rinc sīðian  
drēamum bedæled.     Duru sōna onarn  
fȳr-bendum fæst,     syððan hē hire folmum hrān;  
onbræd þā bealo-hȳdig,     þā hē ābolgen wæs,  
725 recedes mūðan.     Raðe æfter þon  
on fāgne flōr     fēond treddode,  
ēode yrre-mōd;     him of ēagum stōd  
līge gelicost     lēoht unfæger.  
Geseah hē in recede     rinca manige,  
730 swefan sibbe-gedriht     samod ætgædere,  
mago-rinca hēap:     þā his mōd āhlōg,  
mynte þæt hē gedælde,     ær þon dæg cwōme,  
atol āglæca,     ānra gehwylces  
līf wið līce,     þā him ālumpen wæs  
735 wist-fylle wēn.     Ne wæs þæt wyrd þā gēn,  
þæt hē mā mōste     manna cynnes  
þicgean ofer þā niht.     Þrȳð-swȳð behēold  
mæg Higelāces,     hū se mǣn-scaða



- under fār-gripum      gefaran wolde.  
 740 Nē þæt se āglæca      yldan þōhte,  
     ac hē gefēng hraðe      forman siðe  
     slæpendne rinc,      slāt unwearnum,  
     bāt bān-locan,      blōd ēdrum dranc,  
     syn-snædum swealh:      sōna hæfde  
 745 unlyfigendes      eal gefeormod  
     fēt and folma.      Forð nēar ætstōp,  
     nam þā mid handa      hige-þihtigne  
     rinc on ræste;      ræhte ongēan  
     fēond mid folme,      hē onfēng hraðe  
 750 inwit-þancum      and wið earm gesæt.  
     Sōna þæt onfunde      fyrena hyrde,  
     þæt hē ne mētte      middan-geardes  
     eorðan scēata      on elran men  
     mund-gripe māran:      hē on mōde wearð  
 755 forht on ferðe,      nō þȳ ær fram meahte;  
     hyge wæs him hin-fūs,      wolde on heolster flēon,  
     sēcan dēofla gedræg:      ne wæs his drohtoð þær,  
     swylce hē on ealder-dagum      ær gemētte.  
     Gemunde þā se gōda      mæg Higelāces  
 760 æfen-spræce,      up-lang āstōd  
     and him fæste wiðfēng.      Fingras burston;  
     eoten wæs ūt-weard,      eorl furður stōp.  
     Mynte se mæra,      þær hē meahte swā,  
     wīdre gewindan      and on weg þanon  
 765 flēon on fen-hopu;      wiste his fingra geweald  
     on grames grāpum.      Þæt wæs gēocor sið,  
     þæt se hearm-scaða      tō Heorute ātēah:  
     dryht-sele dynede,      Denum eallum wearð,  
     ceaster-būendum,      cēnra gehwylcum,  
 770 eorlum ealu-scerwen.      Yrre wæron bēgen,  
     rēðe rēn-weardas.      Reced hlynsode;  
     þā wæs wundor micel,      þæt se wīn-sele  
     wiðhæfde heaðo-dēorum,      þæt hē on hrūsan ne fēol,  
     fæger fold-bold;      ac hē þæs fæste wæs  
 775 innan and ūtan      īren-bendum  
     searo-þoncum besmiðod.      Þær fram sylle ābēag  
     medu-benc monig      mīne gefræge,

golde geregnad, þær þā graman wunnon;  
þæs ne wēndon ær witan Scyldinga,  
780 þæt hit ā mid gemete manna ænig  
betlic and bān-fāg tōbreca meahte,  
listum tōlūcan, nymðe līges fæðm  
swulge on swaðule. Swēg up āstāg  
nīwe geneahhe; Norð-Denum stōd  
785 atelīc egesa ānra gehwylcum  
þāra þe of wealle wōp gehyrdon,  
gryre-lēoð galan godes andsacan,  
sige-lēasne sang, sār wānigean  
helle hæftan. Hēold hine tō fæste  
790 sē þe manna wæs mægene strengest  
on þām dæge þysses līfes.

# Bēowulf Tears Off Grendel's Arm

## Fit XIII

Nolde eorla hlēo    ænige þinga  
þone cwealm-cuman    cwicne forlætan,  
nē his lif-dagas    lēoda ænigum  
795 nytte tealde.    Þær genehost brægd  
eorl Bēowulfes    ealde lāfe,  
wolde frēa-drihtnes    feorh ealgian  
māeres þēodnes,    þær hīe meahton swā;  
hīe þæt ne wiston,    þā hīe gewin drugon,  
800 heard-hicgende    hilde-mecgas,  
and on healfa gehwone    hēawan þōhton,  
sāwle sēcan,    þæt þone syn-scaðan  
ænig ofer eorðan    irenna cyst,  
gūð-billa nān    grētan nolde;  
805 ac hē sige-wæpnum    forsworen hæfde,  
ecga gehwylcre.    Scolde his aldor-gedāl  
on þāem dæge    þysses lifes  
earmlīc wurðan    and se ellor-gāst  
on fēonda gewæld    feor sīðian.  
810 Þā þæt onfunde    sē þe fela æror  
mōdes myrðe    manna cynne  
fyrene gefremede    (hē wæs fāg wið god)  
þæt him se līc-homa    læstan nolde,  
ac hine se mōdega    mæg Hygelāces  
815 hæfde be honda;    wæs gehwæðer oðrum  
lifigende lāð.    Līc-sār gebād

- atol æglæca,      him on eaxle wearð  
 syn-dolh sweotol,      seonowe onsprungon  
 burston bān-locan.      Bēowulfe wearð  
 820 gūð-hrēð gyfeðe;      scolde Grendel þonan  
 feorh-sēoc flēon      under fen-hleoðu,  
 sēcean wyn-lēas wīc;      wiste þē geornor,  
 þæt his aldres wæs      ende gegongen,  
 dōgera dæg-rīm.      Denum eallum wearð  
 825 æfter þām wæl-ræse      willa gelumpen.  
 Hæfde þā gefælsod,      sē þe ær feorran cōm,  
 snotor and swyð-ferhð      sele Hrōðgāres,  
 genered wið nīðe.      Niht-weorce gefeh,  
 ellen-mærðum;      hæfde Ēast-Denum  
 830 Gēat-mecga lēod      gilp gelæsted,  
 swylce oncȳððe      ealle gebētte,  
 inwid-sorge,      þē hīe ær drugon  
 and for þrēa-nȳdum      þolian scoldon,  
 torn unlȳtel.      Þæt wæs tācen sweotol,  
 835 syððan hilde-dēor      hond ālegde,  
 earm and eaxle      (þær wæs eal geador  
 Grendles grāpe)      under gēapne hrōf.

# The Joy at Heorot

## Fit XIV

Pā wæs on morgen     mīne gefræge  
ymb þā gif-healle     gūð-rinc monig;  
840 fērdon folc-togan     feorran and nēan  
geond wīd-wegas     wundor scēawian,  
lāðes lāstas.     Nō his lif-gedāl  
sārlic þūhte     secga ænegum,  
þāra þe tīr-lēases     trode scēawode,  
845 hū hē wērig-mōd     on weg þanon,  
nīða ofercumen,     on nicera mere  
fæge and geflȳmed     feorh-lāstas bær.  
Þær wæs on blōde     brim weallende,  
atol yða geswing     eal gemenged  
850 hātan heolfre,     heoro-drēore wēol;  
dēað-fæge dēog,     siððan drēama lēas  
in fen-freoðo     feorh ālegde  
hæðene sāwle,     þær him hel onfēng.  
Þanon eft gewiton     eald-gesīðas,  
855 swylce geong manig     of gomen-wāðe,  
fram mere mōdge,     mēarum rīdan,  
beornas on blancum.     Þær wæs Bēowulfes  
mærdō mæned;     monig oft gecwæð,  
þætte sūð nē norð     be sām tweonum  
860 ofer eormen-grund     oðer nænig  
under swegles begong     sēlra nære  
rond-hæbbendra,     rīces wyrðra.  
Nē hīe hūru wine-drihten     wiht ne lōgon,  
glædne Hrōðgār,     ac þæt wæs gōd cyning.

- 865 Hwīlum heaðo-rōfe hlēapan lēton,  
 on geflīt faran fealwe mēaras,  
 þær him fold-wegas fægere þūhton,  
 cystum cūðe; hwīlum cyninges þegn,  
 guma gilp-hlæden gidða gemyndig,  
 870 sē þe eal-fela eald-gesegenā  
 worn gemunde, word oððer fand  
 sōðe gebunden: secg eft ongan  
 sið Bēowulfes snyttrum styrian  
 and on spēd wrecan spel gerāde,  
 875 wordum wrixlan, wēl-hwylc gecwæð,  
 þæt hē fram Sigemunde secgan hȳrde,  
 ellen-dædum, uncūðes fela,  
 Wælsinges gewin, wīde siðas,  
 þāra þe gumena bearn gearwe ne wiston,  
 880 fæhðe and fyrene, būton Fitela mid hine,  
 þonne hē swylces hwæt secgan wolde  
 ēam his nefan, swā hīe ā wæron  
 æt nīða gehwām nȳd-gesteallan:  
 hæfdon eal-fela eotena cynnes  
 885 sweordum gesæged. Sigemunde gesprong  
 æfter dēað-dæge dōm unlȳtel,  
 syððan wīges heard wȳrm ācwealde,  
 hordes hȳrde; hē under hārne stān,  
 æðelinges bearn, āna genēðde  
 890 frēcne dæde; ne wæs him Fitela mid.  
 Hwæðre him gesælde, þæt þæt swurd þurhwōd  
 wrætlicne wȳrm, þæt hit on wealle ætstōd,  
 dryhtlic iren; draca morðre swealt.  
 Hæfde āglæca elne gegongen,  
 895 þæt hē bēah-hordes brūcan mōste  
 selfes dōme: sǣ-bāt gehlōd,  
 bær on bearm scipes beorhte frætwa,  
 Wælses eafera; wȳrm hāt gemealt.  
 Sē wæs wreccena wīde mærost  
 900 ofer wer-þēode, wīgendra hlēo  
 ellen-dædum: hē þæs āron þāh.  
 Siððan Heremōdes hild sweðrode  
 eafoð and ellen. Hē mid eotenum wearð

- on fēonda geweald      forð forlācen,  
 905 snūde forsended.      Hine sorh-wylmas  
 lemede tō lange,      hē his lēodum wearð,  
 eallum æðelingum      tō aldor-ceare;  
 swylce oft bemearn      ærran mælum  
 swið-ferhðes sið      snotor ceorl monig,  
 910 sē þe him bealwa tō      bōte gelyfde,  
 þæt þæt þeodnes bearn      gepēon scolde,  
 fæder-æðelum onfōn,      folc gehealdan,  
 hord and hlēo-burh,      hæleða rīce,  
 ēðel Scyldinga.      Hē þær eallum wearð,  
 915 mæg Higelāces      manna cynne,  
 frēondum gefægra;      hine fyren onwōd.  
 Hwīlum flitende      fealwe stræte  
 mēarum mæton.      Þā wæs morgen-lēoht  
 scofen and scynded.      Ēode scealc monig  
 920 swið-hicgende      tō sele þām hēan,  
 searo-wundor sēon,      swylce self cyning,  
 of brýd-būre      bēah-horda weard,  
 tryddode tīr-fæst      getrume micle,  
 cystum gecyðed,      and his cwēn mid him  
 925 medo-stīg gemæt      mægða hōse.

# Hrothgar's Gratulation

Fit XV

- Hrōðgār maðelode (hē tō healle gēong,  
stōd on stapole, geseah stēapne hrōf  
golde fāhne and Grendles hond):  
"þisse ansýne al-wealdan þanc  
930 "lungre gelimpe! Fela ic lāðes gebād,  
"grynna æt Grendle: ā mæg god wyrcan  
"wunder æfter wundre, wuldres hyrde!  
"Þæt wæs ungeāra, þæt ic ænigra mē  
"wēana ne wēnde tō wīdan feore  
935 "bōte gebīdan þonne blōde fāh  
"hūsa sēlest heoro-drēorig stōd;  
"wēa wīd-scofen witena gehwylcne  
"pāra þe ne wēndon, þæt hīe wīde-ferhð  
"lēoda land-geweorc lāðum beweredon  
940 "scuccum and scinnum. Nū scealc hafað  
"þurh drihtnes miht dæd gefremede,  
"þē wē ealle ær ne meahton  
"snyttrum besyrwan. Hwæt! þæt secgan mæg  
"efne swā hwylc mægða, swā þone magan cende  
945 "æfter gum-cynnum, gyf hēo gýt lyfað,  
"þæt hyre eald-metod ēste wære  
"bearn-gebyrdo. Nū ic Bēowulf  
"þec, secg betsta, mē for sunu wylle  
"frēogan on ferhðe; heald forð tela  
950 "nīwe sibbe. Ne bið þē nænigra gād  
"worolde wilna, þē ic geweald hæbbe.  
"Ful-oft ic for læssan lēan teohhode



- "hord-weorðunge    hnāhran rince,  
 "sæmran æt sæcce.    Þū þē self hafast  
 955 "dǣdum gefremed,    þæt þīn dōm lyfað  
 "āwa tō aldre.    Alwalda þec  
 "gōde forgyld,    swā hē nū gýt dyde!"  
 Bēowulf maðelode,    bearn Ecgþēowes:  
 "Wē þæt ellen-weorc    ēstum miclum,  
 960 "feohtan fremedon,    frēcne genēðdon  
 "eafōð uncūðes;    ūðe ic swīðor,  
 "þæt þū hinc selfne    gesēon mōste,  
 "fēond on frætewum    fyl-wērigne!  
 "Ic hine hrædlīce    heardan clammmum  
 965 "on wæl-bedde    wrīðan þōhte,  
 "þæt hē for mund-gripe    mīnum scolde  
 "licgean lif-bysig,    būtan his līc swice;  
 "ic hine ne mihte,    þā metod nolde,  
 "ganges getwæman,    nō ic him þæs georne ætfealh,  
 970 "feorh-genīðlan;    wæs tō fore-mihtig  
 "fēond on fēðe.    Hwæðere hē his folme forlēt  
 "tō lif-wraðe    lāst weardian,  
 "earm and eaxle;    nō þær ænige swā þēah  
 "fēa-sceaft guma    frōfre gebohte:  
 975 "nō þý leng leofað    lāð-getēona  
 "synnum geswenced,    ac hyne sār hafað  
 "in nýd-gripe    nearwe befongen,  
 "balwon bendum:    þær ābīdan sceal  
 "maga māne fāh    miclan dōmes,  
 980 "hū him scīr metod    scrīfan wille."  
 Þā wæs swīgra secg,    sunu Ecglāfes,  
 on gylp-spræce    gūð-geweorca,  
 siððan æðelingas    eorles cræfte  
 ofer hēahne hrōf    hand scēawedon,  
 985 fēondes fingras,    foran æghwylc;  
 wæs stēde nægla gehwylc,    stýle gelicost,  
 hāðenes hand-sporu    hilde-rinces  
 egle unhēoru;    æg-hwylc gecwæð,  
 þæt him heardra nān    hrīnan wolde  
 990 īren ær-gōd,    þæt þæs āhlæcan  
 blōdge beadu-folme    onberan wolde.

# The Banquet and the Gifts

## Fit XVI

- Þā wæs hāten hreðe      Heort innan-weard  
folmum gefrætwod:      fela þæra wæs  
wera and wīfa,      þē þæt wīn-reced,  
995 gest-sele gyredon.      Gold-fāg scinon  
web æfter wāgum,      wundor-sīona fela  
secga gehwylcum      þāra þe on swylc starað  
Wæs þæt beorhte bold      tōbrocen swiðe  
eal inne-weard      ĭren-bendum fæst,  
1000 heorras tōhlidene;      hrōf āna genæs  
ealles ansund,      þā se āglæca  
fyren-dædum fāg      on flēam gewand,  
aldres or-wēna.      Nō þæt yðe byð  
tō beflēonne      (fremme sē þe wille!)
- 1005 ac gesacan sceal      sāwl-berendra  
nȳde genȳdde      niðða bearna  
grund-būendra      gearwe stōwe,  
þær his līc-homa      leger-bedde fæst  
swefeð æfter symle.      Þā wæs sāl and mæl,  
1010 þæt tō healle gang      Healfdenes sunu;  
wolde self cyning      symbol þicgan.  
Ne gefrægen ic þā mægðe      mārān weorode  
ymb hyra sinc-gyfan      sēl gebæran.  
Bugon þā tō bence      blæd-āgende,  
1015 fülle gefægon.      Fægere geþægon  
medo-ful manig      māgas þāra  
swið-hicgende      on sele þām hēan,  
Hrōðgār and Hrōðulf.      Heorot innan wæs  
frēondum āfyllled;      nalles fācen-stafas

- 1020 Pēod-Scyldingas    þenden fremedon.  
      Forgeaf þā Bēowulfe    bearn Healfdenes  
      segen gylденne    sigores tō lēane,  
      hroden hilde-cumbor,    helm and byrnan;  
      mære māððum-sweord    manige gesāwon  
 1025 beforan beorn beran.    Bēowulf gepah  
      ful on flette;    nō hē þære feoh-gyfte  
      for scēotendum    scamigan þorfte,  
      ne gefrægn ic frēondlicor    fēower mādmas  
      golde gegyrede    gum-manna fela  
 1030 in ealo-bence    ððrum gesellan.  
      Ymb þæs helmes hrōf    hēafod-beorge  
      wīrum bewunden    walan ūtan hēold,  
      þæt him fēla lāfe    frēcne ne meahton  
      scūr-heard sceððan,    þonne scyld-freca  
 1035 ongēan gramum    gangan scolde.  
      Heht þā eorla hlēo    eahta mēaras,  
      fæted-hlēore,    on flet tēon  
      in under eoderas;    þāra ānum stōd  
      sadol searwum fāh    since gewurðad,  
 1040 þæt wæs hilde-setl    hēah-cyninges,  
      þonne sweorda gelāc    sunu Healfdenes  
      efnan wolde;    nāfre on ōre læg  
      wīd-cūðes wīg,    þonne walu fēollon.  
      And þā Bēowulfe    bēga gehwæðres  
 1045 eodor Ingwina    onweald getēah,  
      wicga and wæpna;    hēt hine wēl brūcan.  
      Swā manlice    mære þēoden,  
      hord-weard hæleða    heaðo-ræsas geald  
      mēarum and mādnum,    swā hȳ nāfre man lyhð,  
 1050 sē þe secgan wile    sōð æfter rihte.

# Song of Hrothgar's Poet-The Lay of Hnaef and Hengest

## Fit XVII

- þā gýt æghwylcum    eorla drihten  
þāra þe mid Bēowulfe    brim-lāde tēah,  
on þære medu-bence    māððum gesealde,  
yrfe-lāfe,    and þone ænne heht  
1055 golde forgyldan,    þone þe Grendel ær  
māne ācwealde,    swā hē hyra mā wolde,  
nefne him wītig god    wyrd forstōde  
and þæs mannes mōd:    metod eallum wēold  
gumena cynnes,    swā hē nū gīt dēð;  
1060 forþan bið andgit    æghwær sēlest,  
ferhðes fore-þanc!    fela sceal gebīdan  
lēofes and lāðes,    sē þe longe hēr  
on þyssum win-dagum    worolde brūceð.  
þær wæs sang and swēg    samod ætgædere  
1065 fore Healfdenes    hilde-wīsan,  
gomen-wudu grēted,    gid oft wrecen,  
þonne heal-gamen    Hrōðgāres scop  
æfter medo-bence    mænan scolde  
Finnes eaferum,    þā hīe se fæx befeat:  
1070 "Hæleð Healfdenes,    Hnæf Scyldinga,  
"in Fr.es wæle    feallan scolde.  
"Nē hūru Hildeburh    herian þorfte  
"Eotena trēowe:    unsynnum wearð  
"beloren lēofum    æt þām lind-plegan  
1075 "bearnum and brōðrum;    hīe on gebyrd hruron

- "gāre wunde;    þæt wæs geōmuru ides.  
 "Nalles hōlinga    Hōces dōhtor  
 "meotod-sceaft bemearn,    syððan morgen cōm,  
 "þā hēo under swegle    gesēon meahte  
 1080 "morðor-bealo māga,    þær hēo ær mæste hēold  
 "worolde wynne:    wīg ealle fornam  
 "Finnes þegnas,    nemne fēaum ānum,  
 "þæt hē ne mehte    on þām meðel-stede  
 "wīg Hengeste    wiht gefeohtan,  
 1085 "nē þā wēa-lāfe    wīge forþringan  
 "þōodnes þegne;    ac hig him geþingo budon,  
 "þæt hīe him oðer flet    eal gerȳmdon,  
 "healle and hēah-setl,    þæt hīe healfre geweald  
 "wið Eotena bearn    āgan mōston,  
 1090 "and æt feoh-gyftum    Folcwaldan sunu  
 "dōgra gehwylce    Dene weorðode,  
 "Hengestes hēap    hringum wenede,  
 "efne swā swīðe    sinc-gestrēonum  
 "fættan goldes,    swā hē Frēsena cyn  
 1095 "on bēor-sele    byldan wolde.  
 "Þā hīe getruwedon    on twā healfa  
 "fæste frioðu-wære;    Fin Hengeste  
 "elne unflitme    āðum benemde,  
 "þæt hē þā wēa-lāfe    weotena dōme  
 1100 "ārum heolde,    þæt þær ænig mon  
 "wordum nē worcum    wære ne bræce,  
 "nē þurh inwit-searo    æfre gemāenden,  
 "þēah hīe hira bēag-gyfan    banan folgedon  
 "þēoden-lēase,    þā him swā geþearfod wæs:  
 1105 "gyf þonne Frȳsna hwylc    frēcnan spræce  
 "þæs morðor-hetes    myndgiend wære,  
 "þonne hit sweordes ecg    syððan scolde.  
 "Åð wæs geæfned    and icge gold  
 "āhæfen of horde.    Here-Scyldinga  
 1110 "betst beado-rinca    wæs on bæl gearu;  
 "æt þām āde wæs    ēð-gesȳne  
 "swāt-fāh syrce,    swȳn eal-gylden,  
 "eofer īren-heard,    æðeling manig  
 "wundum āwyrded;    sume on wæle crungon.

- 1115 "Hēt þā Hildeburh      æt Hnæfes āde  
       "hire selfre sunu      sweoloðe befæstan,  
       "bān-fatu bærnan      and on bæl dōn.  
       "Earme on eaxle      ides gnornode,  
       "geōmrode giddum;      gūð-rinc āstāh.  
 1120 "Wand tō wolcnum      wæl-fýra mæst,  
       "hlynnode for hlāwe;      hafelan multon,  
       "ben-geato burston,      þonne blōd ætspranc  
       "lāð-bite līces.      Līg ealle forswealg,  
       "gæsta gīfrost,      þāra þe þær gūð fornam  
 1125 "bēga folces;      wæs hira blæd scacen.

# The Gleeman's Tale Is Ended

## Fit XVIII

- "Gewiton him þā wīgend    wīca nēosian,  
"frēondum befeallen    Frȳsland gesēon,  
"hāmas and hēa-burh.    Hengest þā gýt  
"wæl-fāgne winter    wunode mid Finne  
1130 "ealles unhlitme;    eard gemunde,  
"þeah þe hē ne meahte    on mere drīfan  
"hringed-stefnan;    holm storme wēol,  
"won wið winde;    winter ȳðe belēac  
"īs-gebinde    oð þæt oðer cōm  
1135 "geār in geardas,    swā nū gýt dēð,  
"þā þe syngales    sēle bewitiað,  
"wuldor-torhtan weder.    Þā wæs winter scacen,  
"fæger foldan bearm;    fundode wrecca,  
"gist of geardum;    hē tō gyrn-wræce  
1140 "swiðor þōhte,    þonne tō sǣ-lāde,  
"gif hē torn-gemōt    þurhtēon mihte,  
"þæt hē Eotena bearn    inne gemunde.  
"Swā hē ne forwyrnde    worold-rǣdenne,  
"þonne him Hūnlāfing    hilde-lēoman,  
1145 "billa sēlest,    on bearm dyde:  
"þæs wæron mid Eotenum    ecge cūðe.  
"Swylce ferhð-freca    Fin eft beget  
"sweord-bealo slīðen    æt his selfes hām,  
"siððan grimne gripe    Gūðlaf ond Ōslāf  
1150 "æfter sǣ-siðe    sorge mǣndon,

- "æt witon wēana dæl;    ne meahte wæfre mōd  
 "forhabban in hreðre.    Þā wæs heal hroden  
 "fēonda fēorum,    swilce Fin slægen,  
 "cyning on corðre,    and sēo cwēn numen.  
 1155 "Scēotend Scyldinga    tō scypum feredon  
 "eal in-gesteald    eorð-cyninges,  
 "swylce hīe æt Finnes hām    findan meahton  
 "sigla searo-gimma.    Hīe on sǣ-lāde  
 "drihtlice wīf    tō Denum feredon,  
 1160 "læddon tō lēodum."    Lēoð wæs āsungen,  
 glēo-mannes gyd.    Gamen eft āstāh,  
 beorhtode benc-swēg,    byrelas sealdon  
 wīn of wunder-fatum.    Þā cwōm Wealhþeo forð  
 gān under gyldnum bēage,    þær þā gōðan twēgen  
 1165 sǣton suhter-gefæderan;    þā gýt wæs hiera sib ætgædere  
 æghwylc oðrum trýwe.    Swylce þær Unferð pyle  
 æt fōtum sæt frēan Scyldinga:    gehwylc hiora his ferhðe  
 trēowde,  
 þæt hē hæfde mōd micel,    þēah þe hē his mǣgum nǣre  
 ārfæst æt ecga gelācum.    Spræc þā ides Scyldinga:  
 1170 "Onfōh þissum fulle,    frēo-drihten mīn,  
 "sinces brytta;    þū on sǣlum wes,  
 "gold-wine gumena,    and tō Gēatum sprec  
 "mildum wordum!    Swā sceal man dōn.  
 "Bēo wið Gēatas glæd,    geofena gemyndig;  
 1175 "nēan and feorran    þū nū friðu hafast.  
 "Mē man sægde,    þæt þū þē for sunu wolde  
 "here-rinc habban.    Heorot is gefǣlsod,  
 "bēah-sele beorhta;    brūc þenden þū mōte  
 "manigra mēda    and þīnum mǣgum lǣf  
 1180 "folc and rīce,    þonne þū forð scyle  
 "metod-scaft sēon.    Ic mīnne can  
 "glædne Hrōðulf,    þæt hē þā geogoðe wile  
 "ārum healdan,    gyf þū ær þonne hē,  
 "wine Scildinga,    worold oflǣtest;  
 1185 "wēne ic, þæt hē mid gōde    gyldan wille  
 "uncran eaferan,    gif hē þæt eal gemon,  
 "hwæt wit tō willan    and tō worð-myndum  
 "umbor wesendum ær    ārna gefremedon."



Hwearf þā bī bence,    þær hyre byre wæron,  
1190 Hrēðrīc and Hrōðmund,    and hæleða bearn,  
giogoð ætgædere;    þær se gōda sæt  
Bēowulf Gēata    be þæm gebrōðrum twæm.

# Bēowulf's Jewelled Collar. the Heroes Rest

## Fit XIX

- Him wæs ful boren      and frēond-laðu  
wordum bewægned      and wunden gold  
1195 ēstum geēawed,      earm-hrēade twā,  
hraegl and hringas,      heals-bēaga mæst  
þāra þe ic on foldan      gefrægen hæbbe.  
Nænigne ic under swegle      sēlran hýrde  
hord-māððum hæleða,      syððan Hāma ætwæg  
1200 tō þære byrhtan byrig      Brōsinga mene,  
sigle and sinc-fæt,      searo-nīðas fealh  
Eormenrīces,      gecēas ēcne ræd.  
Þone hring hæfde      Higelāc Gēata,  
nefa Swertinges,      nýhstan sīðe,  
1205 siððan hē under segne      sinc ealgode,  
wæl-rēaf werede;      hyne Wyrð fornam,  
syððan hē for wlenco      wēan āhsode,  
fæhðe tō Frýsum;      hē þā frætwe wæg,  
eorclan-stānas      ofer yða ful,  
1210 rīce þeoden,      hē under rande gecranc;  
gehwearf þā in Francna fæðm      feorh cyninges,  
brēost-gewædu      and se bēah somod:  
wyrsan wīg-frecan      wæl rēafedon  
æfter gūð-sceare,      Gēata lēode  
1215 hreā-wīc hēoldon.      Heal swēge onfēng.  
Wealhþeo maðelode,      hēo fore þāem werede spræc:  
"Brūc þisses bēages,      Bēowulf, lēofa

- "hyse, mid hæle, and þisses hrægles nēot  
 "þēod-gestrēona, and geþēoh tela,  
 1220 "cen þec mid cræfte and þyssum cnýhtum wes  
 "lāra liðe! ic þē þæs lēan geman.  
 "Hafast þū gefēred, þæt þē feor and nēah  
 "ealne wīde-ferhð weras ehtigað,  
 "efne swā sīde swā sǣ bebūgeð  
 1225 "windige weallas. Wes, þenden þū lifige,  
 "æðeling ēadig! ic þē an tela  
 "sinc-gestrēona. Bēo þū suna mīnum  
 "dǣdum gedēfe drēam healdende!  
 "Hēr is æghwylc eorl ōðrum getrýwe,  
 1230 "mōdes milde, man-drihtne hold,  
 "þegnas syndon geþwære, þēod eal gearo:  
 "druncne dryht-guman, dōð swā ic bidde!"  
 Ēode þā tō setle. Þær wæs symbla cyst,  
 druncon wīn weras: wyrd ne cūðon,  
 1235 geō-sceaft grimme, swā hit āgangen wearð  
 eorla manegum, syððan æfen cwōm  
 and him Hrōðgār gewāt tō hofe sīnum,  
 rīce tō ræste. Reced weardode  
 unrīm eorla, swā hīe oft ær dydon:  
 1240 benc-þelu beredon, hit geond-bræded wearð  
 beddum and bolstrum. Bēor-scealca sum  
 fūs and fāge flet-ræste gebēag.  
 Setton him tō hēafdum hilde-randas,  
 bord-wudu beorhtan; þær on bence wæs  
 1245 ofer æðelinge ŷð-gesēne  
 heaðo-stēapa helm, hringed byrne,  
 þrec-wudu þrymlīc. Wæs þēaw hyra,  
 þæt hīe oft wæron an wīg gearwe,  
 gē æt hām gē on herge, gē gehwæðer þāra  
 1250 efne swylce mæla, swylce hira man-dryhtne  
 þearf gesælde; wæs sēo þēod tilu.

# Grendel's Mother Attacks the Ring-Danes

Fit XX

- Sigon þā tō slæpe.      Sum sære angeald  
æfen-ræste,      swā him ful-oft gelamp,  
siððan gold-sele      Grendel warode,  
1255 unriht æfnde,      oð þæt ende becwōm,  
swylt æfter synnum.      Þæt gesȳne wearð,  
wīd-cūð werum,      þætte wrecend þā gýt  
lifde æfter lāðum,      lange þrāge  
æfter gūð-ceare;      Grendles mōdor,  
1260 ides āglæc-wīf      yrmðe gemunde,  
sē þe wæter-egesan      wunian scolde,  
cealde strēamas,      siððan Cain wearð  
tō ecg-banan      āngan brēðer,  
fæderen-mæge;      hē þā fāg gewāt,  
1265 morðre gemearcod      man-drēam flēon,  
wēsten warode.      Þanon wōc fela  
geōscaft-gāsta;      wæs þæra Grendel sum,  
heoro-wearh hetelīc,      sē æt Heorote fand  
wæccendne wer      wīges bīdan,  
1270 þær him āglæca      æt-græpe wearð;  
hwæðre hē gemunde      mægenes strenge,  
gim-fæste gife,      þē him god sealde,  
and him tō anwaldan      āre gelyfde,  
frōfre and fultum:      þȳ hē þone fēond ofercwōm,  
1275 gehnægde helle gāst:      þā hē hēan gewāt,  
drēame bedæled      dēað-wīc sēon,

- man-cynnes fēond. And his mōdor þā gýt  
 gīfre and galg-mōd gegān wolde  
 sorh-fulne sīð, suna dēað wrecan.
- 1280 Cōm þā tō Heorote, þær Hring-Dene  
 geond þæt sæld swāfun. Þā þær sōna wearð  
 ed-hwyrft eorlum, siððan inne fealh  
 Grendles mōdor; wæs se gryre læssa  
 efne swā micle, swā bið mægða cræft,
- 1285 wīg-gryre wīfes be wæpned-men,  
 þonne heoru bunden, hamere gepuren,  
 sweord swāte fāh swīn ofer helme,  
 ecgum dyhtig andweard scireð.  
 Þā wæs on healle heard-ecg togen,
- 1290 sweord ofer setlum, sīd-rand manig  
 hafen handa fæst; helm ne gemunde,  
 byrnan sīde, þe hine se brōga angeat.  
 Hēo wæs on ofste, wolde út þanon  
 fēore beorgan, þā hēo onfunden wæs;
- 1295 hraðe hēo æðelinga ānne hæfde  
 fæste befangen, þā hēo tō fenne gang;  
 sē wæs Hrōðgāre hæleða lēofost  
 on gesīðes hād be sām tweonum,  
 rice rand-wiga, þone þe hēo on ræste ābrēat,
- 1300 blæd-fæstne beorn. Næs Bēowulf þær,  
 ac wæs oðer in ær geteohhod  
 æfter mādðum-gife mærum Gēate.  
 Hrēam wearð on Heorote. Hēo under heolfre genam  
 cūðe folme; cearu wæs genīwod
- 1305 geworden in wīcum: ne wæs þæt gewrixle til,  
 þæt hīe on bā healfa bicgan scoldon  
 frēonda fēorum. Þā wæs frōd cyning,  
 hār hilde-rinc, on hrēon mōde,  
 syððan hē aldor-þegn unlyfigendne,
- 1310 þone dēorestan dēadne wisse.  
 Hraðe wæs tō būre Bēowulf fetod,  
 sigor-ēadig secg. Samod ær-dæge  
 ēode eorla sum, æðele cempa  
 self mid gesīðum, þær se snottra bād,
- 1315 hwæðre him al-walda æfre wille

æfter wēa-spelle    wyrpe gefremman.  
Gang þā æfter flōre    fyrd-wyrðe man  
mid his hand-scale    (heal-wudu dynede)  
þæt hē þone wīsan    wordum hnægde  
1320 frēan Ingwina;    frægn gif him wære  
æfter nēod-laðu    niht getæse.

# Sorrow at Heorot: Aeschere's Death

## Fit XXI

- Hrōðgār maðelode, helm Scildinga:  
"Ne frīn þū æfter sælum! Sorh is genīwod  
"Denigea lēodum. Dēad is Æsc-here,  
1325 "Yrmenlāfes yldra brōðor,  
"mīn rūn-wita and mīn ræd-bora,  
"eaxl-gestealla, þonne wē on orlege  
"hafelan weredon, þonne hniton fēðan,  
"eoferas cnysedan; swylc scolde eorl wesan  
1330 "æðeling ær-gōd, swylc Æsc-here wæs.  
"Wearð him on Heorote tō hand-banan  
"wæl-gæst wæfre; ic ne wāt hwæder  
"atol æse wlanc eft-sīðas tēah,  
"fylle gefrægnod. Hēo þā fæhðe wræc,  
1335 "þē þū gystran niht Grendel cwealdest  
"þurh hæstne hād heardum clammum,  
"forþan hē tō lange lēode mīne  
"wanode and wyrde. Hē æt wīge gecrang  
"ealdres scyldig, and nū oðer cwōm  
1340 "mihtig mǣn-scaða, wolde hyre mæg wrecan,  
"gē feor hafað fæhðe gestæled,  
"þæs þe þincean mæg þegne monegum,  
"sē þe æfter sinc-gyfan on sefan grēoteð,  
"hreðer-bealo hearde; nū sēo hand ligeð,  
1345 "sē þe ēow wēl-hwylcra wilna dohte.  
"Ic þæt lond-būend lēode mīne

- "sele-rædende      secgan hȳrde,  
 "þæt hīe gesāwon      swylce twēgen  
 "micle mearc-stapan      mōras healdan,  
 1350 "ellor-gæstas:      þāera oðer wæs,  
 "þæs þe hīe gewislīcost      gewitan meahton,  
 "idese onlīcnes,      oðer earm-sceapen  
 "on weres wæstmum      wræc-lāstas træd,  
 "næfne hē wæs māra      þonne ænig man oðer,  
 1355 "þone on geār-dagum      Grendel nemdon  
 "fold-būende:      nō hīe fæder cunnon,  
 "hwæðer him ænig wæs      ær ācenned  
 "dyrnra gāsta.      Hīe dȳgel lond  
 "warigeað, wulf-hleoðu,      windige næssas,  
 1360 "frēcne fen-gelād,      þær fyr-gen-strēam  
 "under næssa genipu      niðer gewīteð,  
 "flōd under foldan;      nis þæt feor heonon  
 "mīl-gemearces,      þæt se mere standeð,  
 "ofer þāem hongiað      hrīmge bearwas,  
 1365 "wudu wyrtum fæst,      wæter oferhelmað.  
 "Þær mæg nihta gehwæm      nið-wundor sēon,  
 "fȳr on flōde;      nō þæs frōd leofað  
 "gumena bearna,      þæt þone grund wite;  
 "pēah þe hāð-stapa      hundum geswenced,  
 1370 "heorot hornum trum      holt-wudu sēce,  
 "feorran geflȳmed,      ær hē feorh seleð,  
 "aldor on ōfre,      ær hē in wille,  
 "hafelan hȳdan.      Nis þæt hēoru stōw:  
 "þonon ȳð-geblond      up āstīgeð  
 1375 "won tō wolcnum,      þonne wind styreð  
 "lāð gewidru,      oð þæt lyft drysmað,  
 "roderas rēotað.      Nū is ræd gelang  
 "eft æt þē ānum!      Eard gīt ne const,  
 "frēcne stōwe,      þær þū findan miht  
 1380 "sinnigne secg:      sēc gif þū dyrre!  
 "Ic þe þā fæhðe      fēo lēanige,  
 "eald-gestrēonum,      swā ic ær dyde,  
 "wundnum golde,      gȳf þū on weg cymest."



# Bēowulf Seeks the Monster in the Haunts of the Nixies

## Fit XXII

- Bēowulf maðelode,    bearn Ecgþēowes:  
1385 "Ne sorga, snotor guma!    sēlre bið æghwæm,  
"þæt hē his frēond wrece,    þonne hē fela murne;  
"ūre æghwylc sceal    ende gebīdan  
"worolde līfes;    wyrce sē þe mōte  
"dōmes ær dēaðe!    þæt bið driht-guman  
1390 "unlifgendum    æfter sēlest.  
"Ārīs, rīces weard;    uton hraðe fēran,  
"Grendles māgan    gang scēawigan!  
"Ic hit þē gehāte:    nō hē on helm losað,  
"nē on foldan fæðm,    nē on fyrgen-holt,  
1395 "nē on gyfenes grund,    gā þær hē wille.  
"Þys dōgor þū    geþyld hafa  
"wēana gehwylces,    swā ic þē wēne tō!"  
Āhlēop þā se gomela,    gode þancode,  
mihtigan drihtne,    þæs se man gespræc.  
1400 Þā wæs Hrōðgāre    hors gebæted,  
wicg wunden-feax.    Wīsa fengel  
geatolīc gengde;    gum-fēða stōp  
lind-hæbbendra.    Lāstas wæron  
æfter wald-swaðum    wīde gesýne,  
1405 gang ofer grundas;    gegnum fōr þā  
ofer myrcan mōr,    mago-þegna bær  
þone sēlestan    sāwol-lēasne,  
þāra þe mid Hrōðgāre    hām eahtode.

- Ofer-ēode þā æðelinga bearn  
 1410 stēap stān-hliðo, stige nearwe,  
 enge ān-paðas, un-cūð gelād,  
 neowle næssas, nicor-hūsa fela;  
 hē fēara sum beforan gengde  
 wīsra monna, wong scēawian,  
 1415 oð þæt hē færinga fyr-gen-bēamas  
 ofer hārne stān hleonian funde,  
 wyn-lēasne wudu; wæter under stōd  
 drēorig and gedrēfed. Denum eallum wæs,  
 winum Scyldinga, weorce on mōde,  
 1420 tō gepolianne þegne monegum,  
 oncyð eorla gehwām, syððan Æsc-heres  
 on þām holm-clife hafelan mētton.  
 Flōd blōde wēol (folc tō sǣgon)  
 hātan heolfre. Horn stundum song  
 1425 fūslīc fyrd-lēoð. Fēða eal gesæt;  
 gesāwon þā æfter wætere wyrm-cynnes fela,  
 sellīce sǣ-dracan sund cunnian,  
 swylce on næs-hleoðum nicras licgean,  
 þā on undern-mæl oft bewitigað  
 1430 sorh-fulne sīð on segl-rāde,  
 wyrmas and wil-dēor; hīe on weg hruron  
 bitere and gebolgne, bearhtm ongeāton,  
 gūð-horn galan. Sumne Gēata lēod  
 of flān-bogan fēores getwǣfde,  
 1435 yð-gewinnes, þæt him on aldre stōd  
 here-strǣl hearda; hē on holme wæs  
 sundes þē sǣnra, þē hyne swylt fornam.  
 Hræðe wearð on yðum mid eofer-sprēotum  
 heoro-hōcȳhtum hearde genearwod,  
 1440 nīða genǣged and on næs togen  
 wundorlīc wæg-bora; weras scēawedon  
 gryrelīcne gist. Gyrede hine Bēowulf  
 eorl-gewǣdum, nalles for ealdre mearn:  
 scolde here-byrne hondum gebrōden,  
 1445 sīd and searo-fāh, sund cunnian,  
 sēo þe bān-cofan beorgan cūðe,  
 þæt him hilde-grāp hreðre ne mihte,

- eorres inwit-feng,    aldre gesceððan;  
 ac se hwīta helm    hafelan werede,  
 1450 sē þe mere-grundas    mengan scolde,  
       sēcan sund-gebland    since geweorðad,  
       befongen frēa-wrāsnum,    swā hine fyrn-dagum  
       worhte wæpna smið,    wundrum tēode,  
       besette swīn-līcum,    þæt hine syððan nō  
 1455 brond nē beado-mēcas    bītan ne meahton.  
       Næs þæt þonne mætoost    mægen-fultuma,  
       þæt him on þearfe lāh    þyle Hrōðgāres;  
       wæs þæm hæft-mēce    Hrunting nama,  
       þæt wæs ān foran    eald-gestrēona;  
 1460 ecg wæs īren    āter-tēarum fāh,  
       āhyrded heaðo-swāte;    nāfre hit æt hilde ne swāc  
       manna ængum    þāra þe hit mid mundum bewand,  
       sē þe gryre-siðas    gegān dorste,  
       folc-stede fāra;    næs þæt forma sið,  
 1465 þæt hit ellen-weorc    æfnan scolde.  
       Hūru ne gemunde    mago Ecglāfes  
       eafodes cræftig,    þæt hē ær gespræc  
       wīne druncen,    þā hē þæs wæpnes onlāh  
       sēlran sweord-frecan:    selfa ne dorste  
 1470 under yðā gewin    aldre genēðan,  
       driht-scype drēogan;    þær hē dōme forlēas,  
       ellen-mārðum.    Ne wæs þæm oðrum swā,  
       syððan hē hine tō gūðe    gegyred hæfde.

# The Battle with the Water-Drake

## Fit XXIII

- Bēowulf maðelode,    bearn Ecgþēowes:  
1475 "geþenc nū, se mæra    maga Healfdenes,  
"snottra fengel,    nū ic eom sīðes fūs,  
"gold-wine gumena,    hwæt wit geō spræcon,  
"gif ic æt þearfe    þīnre scolde  
"aldre linnan,    þæt þū mē ā wære  
1480 "forð-gewitenum    on fæder stæle;  
"wes þū mund-bora mīnum    mago-þegnum,  
"hond-gesellum,    gif mec hild nime:  
"swylce þū þā mādmas,    þē þū mē sealdest,  
"Hrōðgār lēofa,    Higelāce onsend.  
1485 "Mæg þonne on þām golde ongitan    Gēata dryhten,  
"gesēon sunu Hrēðles,    þonne hē on þæt sinc starað,  
"þæt ic gum-cystum    gōdne funde  
"bēaga bryttan,    brēac þonne mōste.  
"And þū Unferð læt    ealde lāfe,  
1490 "wrætlic wæg-sweord    wīd-cūðne man  
"heard-ecg habban;    ic mē mid Hruntinge  
"dōm gewyrce,    oððe mec dēað nimeð."  
Æfter þām wordum    Weder-Gēata lēod  
efste mid elne,    nalas andsware  
1495 bīdan wolde;    brim-wylm onfēng  
hilde-rince.    Þā wæs hwīl dæges,  
ær hē þone grund-wong    ongytan mehte.  
Sōna þæt onfunde,    sē þe flōda begong

- heoro-gīfre behēold    hund missēra,  
 1500 grim and grædig,    þæt þær gumena sum  
     æl-wihta eard    ufan cunnode.  
 Grāp þā tōgēanes,    gūð-rinc gefēng  
     atolan clommum;    nō þȳ ær in gescōd  
     hālan lice:    hring ūtan ymb-bearh,  
 1505 þæt hēo þone fyrd-hom    þurh-fōn ne mihte,  
     locene leoðo-syrca    lāðan fingrum.  
     Bær þā sēo brim-wylf,    þā hēo tō botme cōm,  
     hringa þengel    tō hofe sīnum,  
     swā hē ne mihte nō    (hē þæs mōdig wæs)  
 1510 wæpna gewealdan,    ac hine wundra þæs fela  
     swencte on sunde,    sǣ-dēor monig  
     hilde-tūxum    here-syrca bræc,  
     ēhton āglæcan.    Þā se eorl ongeat,  
     þæt hē in nið-sele    nāt-hwylcum wæs,  
 1515 þær him nǣnig wæter    wihte ne sceðede,  
     nē him for hrōf-sele    hrīnan ne mehte  
     fær-gripe flōdes:    fȳr-lēoht geseah,  
     blācne lēoman    beorhte scīnan.  
     Ongeat þā se gōda    grund-wyrgerne,  
 1520 mere-wīf mihtig;    mægen-ræs forgeaf  
     hilde-bille,    hond swenge ne oftēah,  
     þæt hire on hafelan    hring-mǣl āgōl  
     grædig gūð-lēoð.    Þā se gist onfand,  
     þæt se beado-lēoma    bītan nolde,  
 1525 aldre sceððan,    ac sēo ecg geswāc  
     þēodne æt þearfe:    þolode ær fela  
     hond-gemōta,    helm oft gescær,  
     fāges fyrd-hrægl:    þæt wæs forma sīð  
     dēorum māðme,    þæt his dōm ālæg.  
 1530 Eft wæs ān-ræd,    nalas elnes læt,  
     mǣrða gemyndig    mæg Hygelāces;  
     wearp þā wunden-mǣl    wrættum gebunden  
     yrre ōretta,    þæt hit on eorðan læg,  
     stīð and stȳl-ecg;    strenge getruwode,  
 1535 mund-gripe mægenes.    Swā sceal man dōn,  
     þonne hē æt gūðe    gegān þenceð  
     longsumne lof,    nā ymb his lif cearað.

- Gefēng þā be eaxle     (nalas for fæhðe mearn)  
 Gūð-Gēata lēod     Grendles mōdor;  
 1540 brægd þā beadwe heard,     þā hē gebolgen wæs,  
   feorh-genīðlan,     þæt hēo on flet gebēah.  
   Hēo him eft hraðe     and-lēan forgeald  
   grimman grāpum     and him tōgēanes fēng;  
   oferwearp þā wērig-mōd     wigena strengest,  
 1545 fēðe-cempa,     þæt hē on fylle wearð.  
   Ofsæt þā þone sele-gyst     and hyre seaxe getēah,  
   brād and brūn-ecg     wolde hire bearn wrecan,  
   āngan eaferan.     Him on eaxle læg  
   brēost-net brōden;     þæt gebearh fēore,  
 1550 wið ord and wið ecge     ingang forstōd.  
   Hæfde þā forsīðod     sunu Ecgþēowes  
   under gynne grund,     Gēata cempa,  
   nemne him heaðo-byrne     helpe gefremede,  
   here-net hearde,     and hālig god  
 1555 gewēold wīg-sigor,     wītig drihten;  
   rodera rædend     hit on ryht gescēd,  
   yðelīce     syððan hē eft āstōd.

# Bēowulf Slays the Sprite

## Fit XXIV

- Geseah þā on searwum    sige-ēadig bil,  
eald sweord eotenisc    ecgum þȳhtig,  
1560 wigena weorð-mynd:    þæt wæs wæpna cyst,  
būton hit wæs mære    þonne ænig mon oðer  
tō beadu-lāce    ætberan meahte  
gōd and geatolīc    gīganta geweorc.  
Hē gefēng þā fetel-hilt,    freca Scildinga,  
1565 hrēoh and heoro-grim    hring-mæl gebrægd,  
aldres orwēna,    yrringa slōh,  
þæt hire wið halse    heard grāpode,  
bān-hringas bræc,    bil eal þurh-wōd  
fægne flæsc-homan,    hēo on flet gecrong;  
1570 sweord wæs swātig,    secg weorce gefeh.  
Līxte se lēoma,    lēoht inne stōd,  
efne swā of hefene    hādre scīneð  
rodores candel.    Hē æfter recede wlāt,  
hwearf þā be wealle,    wæpen hafenade  
1575 heard be hiltum    Higelāces þegn,  
yrre and ān-ræd.    Næs sēo ecg fracod  
hilde-rince,    ac hē hraðe wolde  
Grendle forgyldan    gūð-ræsa fela  
þāra þe hē geworhte    tō West-Denum  
1580 oftor micle    þonne on ænne sīð,  
þonne hē Hrōðgāres    heorð-genēatas  
slōh on sweofote,    slæpende fræt  
folces Denigea    fȳf-tȳne men  
and oðer swylc    ūt of-ferede,

- 1585 lāðlicu lāc.      Hē him þæs lēan forgeald,  
       rēðe cempa,      tō þæs þe hē on ræste geseah  
       gūð-wērigne      Grendel licgan,  
       aldor-lēasne,      swā him ær gescōd  
       hild æt Heorote;      hrā wīde sprong,  
 1590 syððan hē æfter dēaðe      drepe þrowade,  
       heoro-swing heardne,      and hine þā hēafde becearf,  
       Sōna þæt gesāwon      snottre ceorlas,  
       þā þe mid Hrōðgāre      on holm wliton,  
       þæt wæs yð-geblond      eal gemenged,  
 1595 brim blōde fāh:      blonden-feaxe  
       gomele ymb gōdne      ongeador spræcon,  
       þæt hig þæs æðelinges      eft ne wēndon,  
       þæt hē sige-hrēðig      sēcean cōme  
       mærne þēoden;      þā þæs monige gewearð,  
 1600 þæt hine sēo brim-wylf      ābroten hæfde.  
       Þā cōm nōn dāges.      Næs ofgēafon  
       hwate Scyldingas; gewāt him hām þonon  
       gold-wine gumena.      Gistas sētan,  
       mōdes sēoce,      and on mere staredon,  
 1605 wiston and ne wēndon,      þæt hīe heora wine-drihten  
       selfne gesāwon.      Þā þæt sweord ongan  
       æfter heaðo-swāte      hilde-gicelum  
       wīg-bil wanian;      þæt wæs wundra sum,  
       þæt hit eal gemealt      īse gelīcost,  
 1610 þonne forstes bend      fæder onlæteð,  
       onwindeð wæl-rāpas,      sē þe geweald hafað  
       sæla and mæla;      þæt is sōð metod.  
       Ne nom hē in þāem wīcum,      Weder-Gēata lēod,  
       māðm-æhta mā,      þēh hē þær monige geseah,  
 1615 būton þone hafelan      and þā hilt somod,  
       since fāge;      sweord ær gemealt,  
       forbarn brōden mæl:      wæs þæt blōd tō þæs hāt,  
       ættren ellor-gæst,      sē þær inne swealt.  
       Sōna wæs on sunde,      sē þe ær æt sæcce gebād  
 1620 wīg-hryre wrāðra,      wæter up þurh-dēaf;  
       wæron yð-gebland      eal gefælsod,  
       ēacne eardas,      þā se ellor-gāst  
       oflēt lif-dagas      and þās lēanan gesceaft.



- Cōm þā tō lande      lid-manna helm  
 1625 swīð-mōd swymmman,      sǣ-lāce gefeah,  
     mægen-byrðenne      þāra þe hē him mid hæfde.  
     Ēodon him þā tōgēanes,      gode þancodon,  
     þrȳðlic þegna hēap,      þēodnes gefēgon,  
     þæs þe hī hyne gesundne      gesēon mōston.  
 1630 Þā wæs of þǣm hrōran      helm and byrne  
     lungre ālȳsed:      lagu drūsade,  
     wæter under wolcnum,      wæl-drēore fāg.  
     Fērdon forð þonon      fēðe-lāstum  
     ferhðum fægne,      fold-weg mæton,  
 1635 cūðe stræte;      cyning-balde men  
     from þǣm holm-clife      hafelan bāeron  
     earfoðlice      heora æghwæðrum  
     fela-mōdigra:      fēower scoldon  
     on ðǣm wæl-stenge      weorcum geferian  
 1640 tō þǣm gold-sele      Grendles hēafod,  
     oð þæt semninga      tō sele cōmon  
     frome fyrd-hwate      fēower-tȳne  
     Gēata gongan;      gum-dryhten mid  
     mōdig on gemonge      meodo-wongas træd.  
 1645 Þā cōm in gān      ealdor þegna,  
     dǣd-cēne mon      dōme gewurðad,  
     hæle hilde-dēor.      Hrōðgār grētan:  
     Þā wæs be feaxe      on flet boren  
     Grendles hēafod,      þær guman druncon,  
 1650 egeslic for eorlum      and þære idese mid:  
     wlite-sēon wrætlic      weras onsāwon.

# Hrothgar's Gratitude: He Discourses

Fit XXV

- Bēowulf maðelode,    bearn Ecgþēowes:  
"Hwæt! wē þē þās sǣ-lāc,    sunu Healfdenes,  
"lēod Scyldinga,    lustum brōhton,  
1655 "tīres tō tǣcne,    þē þū hēr tō lōcast.  
"Ic þæt unsōfte    ealdre gedīgde:  
"wigge under wætere    weorc genēðde  
"earfoðlice,    æt-rihte wæs  
"gūð getwāfed,    nymðe mec god scylde.  
1660 "Ne meahte ic æt hilde    mid Hruntinge  
"wiht gewyrcan,    þēah þæt wāpen dūge,  
"ac mē geūðe    ylða waldend,  
"þæt ic on wāge geseah    wlitig hangian  
"eald sweord ēacen    (oftost wīsode  
1665 "winigea lēasum)    þæt ic þȳ wāpne gebræ.  
"Ofslōh þā æt þære sǣcce    (þā mē sǣl āgeald)  
"hūses hyrdas.    Þā þæt hilde-bil  
"forbarn, brogden mǣl,    swā þæt blōd gesprang,  
"hātost heaðo-swāta:    ic þæt hilt þanan  
1670 "fēondum ætferede;    fyren-dæda wræc,  
"dēað-cwealm Denigea,    swā hit gedēfe wæs.  
"Ic hit þē þonne gehāte,    þæt þū on Heorote mōst  
"sorh-lēas swefan    mid þīnra secga gedryht,  
"and þegna gehwylc    þīnra lēoda,  
1675 "duguðe and ioguðe,    þæt þū him ondrædan ne þearft,  
"pēoden Scyldinga,    on þā healfe,

- "aldor-bealu eorlum, swā þū ær dydest."  
 Pā wæs gylden hilt gamelum rince.  
 hārum hild-fruman, on hand gyfen,  
 1680 enta ær-geweorc, hit on æht gehwearf  
 æfter dēofla hryre Denigea frēan,  
 wundor-smiða geweorc, and pā pās worold ofgeaf  
 grom-heort guma, godes andsaca,  
 morðres scyldig, and his mōdor ēac;  
 1685 on geweald gehwearf worold-cyninga  
 þāem sēlestan be sām twēonum  
 þāra þe on Sceden-igge sceattas dælde.  
 Hrōðgār maðelode, hylt scēawode,  
 ealde lāfe, on þāem wæs ōr writen  
 1690 fyrn-gewinnes: syððan flōd ofslōh,  
 gifen gēotende, gīganta cyn,  
 frēcne gefērdon: þæt wæs fremde þēod  
 ēcean dryhtne, him þæs ende-lēan  
 þurh wæteres wylm waldend sealde.  
 1695 Swā wæs on þāem scennum scīran goldes  
 þurh rūn-stafas rihte gemearcod,  
 geseted and gesæd, hwām þæt sweord geworht,  
 irena cyst ærest wære,  
 wreoðen-hilt and wyrm-fāh. pā se wīsa spræc  
 1700 sunu Healfdenes (swīgedon ealle):  
 "Þæt lā mæg secgan, sē þe sōð and riht  
 "fremeð on folce, (feor eal gemon  
 "eald ēðel-weard), þæt þes eorl wære  
 "geboren betera! Blæd is āræred  
 1705 "geond wīd-wegas, wine mīn Bēowulf,  
 "þīn ofer þēoda gehwylce. Eal þū hit geþyldum healdest,  
 "mægen mid mōdes snyttrum. Ic þē sceal mīne gelæstan  
 "frēode, swā wit furðum spræcon; þū scealt tō frōfre we-  
 orðan  
 "eal lang-twidig lēodum þīnum,  
 1710 "hæleðum tō helpe. Ne wearð Heremōd swā  
 "eaforum Ecgwelan, Ār-Scyldingum;  
 "ne gewēox hē him tō willan, ac tō wæl-fealle  
 "and tō dēað-cwalum Deniga lēodum;  
 "brēat bolgen-mōd bēod-genēatas,

- 1715 "eaxl-gesteallan,    oð þæt hē āna hwearf,  
       "mære þēoden.    mon-drēamum from:  
       "þeah þe hine mihtig god    mægenes wynnum,  
       "eafeðum stēpte,    ofer ealle men  
       "forð gefremede,    hwæðere him on ferhðe grēow  
 1720 "brēost-hord blōd-rēow:    nallas bēagas geaf  
       "Denum æfter dōme;    drēam-lēas gebād,  
       "þæt hē þæs gewinnes    weorc þrowade,  
       "lēod-bealo longsum.    Þū þē lār be þon,  
       " gum-cyste ongit!    ic þis gid be þē  
 1725 "āwræc wintrum frōd.    Wundor is tō secganne,  
       "hū mihtig god    manna cynne  
       "þurh sīdne sefan    snyttru bryttað,  
       "eard and eorl-scipe,    hē āh ealra geweald.  
       "Hwīlum hē on lufan    lāteð hworfan  
 1730 "monnes mōd-geþonc    mæran cynnes,  
       "seleð him on ēðle    eorðan wynne,  
       "tō healdanne    hlēo-burh wera,  
       "gedēð him swā gewealdene    worolde dælas,  
       "sīde rīce,    þæt hē his selfa ne mæg  
 1735 "for his un-snyttrum    ende gepencean;  
       "wunað hē on wiste,    nō hine wiht dweleð,  
       "ādī nē ylde,    nē him inwit-sorh  
       "on sefan sweorceð,    nē gesacu ōhwær,  
       "ecg-hete ēoweð,    ac him eal worold  
 1740 "wendeð on willan;    hē þæt wyrse ne con,  
       "oð þæt him on innan    ofer-hygda dæl  
       "weaxeð and wridað,    þonne se weard swefeð,  
       "sāwele hyrde:    bið se slāp tō fæst,  
       "bisgum gebunden,    bona swīðe nēah,  
 1745 "sē þe of flān-bogan    fyrenum scēoteð.

# The Discourse Is Ended.-Bēowulf Prepares to Leave

Fit XXVI

- "Ponne bið on hreðre    under helm drepn  
"biteran stræle:    him bebeorgan ne con  
"wom wundor-bebodum    wergan gāstes;  
"þinceð him tō lýtēl,    þæt hē tō lange hēold,  
1750 "gȳtsað grom-hȳdig,    nallas on gylp seleð  
"fætte bēagas    and hē þā forð-gesceaft  
"forgyteð and forgȳmeð,    þæs þe him ær god sealde  
"wuldres waldend,    weorð-mynda dæl.  
"Hit on ende-stæf    eft gelimpeð,  
1755 "þæt se līc-homa    læne gedrēoseð,  
"fæge gefealleð;    fēhð oððer tō,  
"sē þe unmunlice    mādmas dæleð,  
"eorles ær-gestrēon,    egesan ne gȳmeð.  
"Bebeorh þē þone bealo-nið,    Bēowulf lēofa,  
1760 "secg se betsta,    and þē þæt sēlre gecēos,  
"ēce rēdas;    oferhȳða ne gȳm,  
"mære cempa!    Nū is þīnes mægnes blæd  
"āne hwile;    eft sōna bið,  
"þæt þec ādl oððe ecg    eafoðes getwæfeð,  
1765 "oððe fȳres feng    oððe flōdes wylm,  
"oððe gripe mēces    oððe gāres fliht,  
"oððe atol ylðo,    oððe ēagena bearhtm  
"forsiteð and forsworced;    semninga bið,

- "þæt þec, dryht-guma,      dēað oferswýðeð.  
 1770 "Swā ic Hring-Dena      hund missēra  
     "wēold under wolcnum,      and hig wigge belēac  
     "manigum mægða      geond þysne middan-geard,  
     "æscum and ecgum,      þæt ic mē ænigne  
     "under swegles begong      gesacan ne tealde.  
 1775 "Hwæt! mē þæs on ēðle      edwenden cwōm,  
     "gyrn æfter gomene,      seoððan Grendel wearð,  
     "eald-gewinna,      in-genga mīn:  
     "ic þære sōcne      singāles wæg  
     "mōd-ceare micle.      Þæs sig metode þanc,  
 1780 "ēcean drihtne,      þæs þe ic on aldre gebād,  
     "þæt ic on þone hafelan      heoro-drēorigne  
     "ofer eald gewin      ēagum starige!  
     "Gā nū tō setle,      symbel-wynne drēoh  
     "wīgge weorðad:      unc sceal worn fela  
 1785 "māðma gemænra,      siððan morgen bið."  
     Gēat wæs glæd-mōd,      gēong sōna tō,  
     setles nēosan,      swā se snottra heht.  
     Þā wæs eft swā ær      ellen-rōfum,  
     flet-sittendum      fægere gereorded  
 1790 nīowan stefne.      Niht-helm geswearc  
     deorc ofer dryht-gumum.      Duguð eal ārās;  
     wolde blonden-feax      beddes nēosan,  
     gamela Scylding.      Gēat ungemetes wēl,  
     rōfne rand-wigan      restan lyste:  
 1795 sōna him sele-þegn      sīðes wērgum,  
     feorran-cundum      forð wīsade,  
     se for andrysum      ealle beweotede  
     þegnes þearfe,      swylce þȳ dōgore  
     hēaðo-liðende      habban scoldon.  
 1800 Reste hine þā rūm-heort;      reced hlīfade  
     gēap and gold-fāh,      gæst inne swæf,  
     oð þæt hrefn blaca      heofones wynne  
     blið-heort bodode.      Þā cōm beorht sunne  
     scacan ofer grundas;      scaðan ōnetton,  
 1805 wæron æðelingas      eft tō lēodum  
     fūse tō farenne,      wolde feor þanon  
     cuma collen-ferhð      cēoles nēosan.

Heht þā se hearda     Hrunting beran,  
sunu Ecglāfes,     heht his sweord niman,  
1810 lēoflīc īren;     sægde him þæs lēanes þanc,  
cwæð hē þone gūð-wine     gōdne tealde,  
wīg-cræftigne,     nales wordum lōg  
mēces ecge:     þæt wæs mōdig secg.  
And þā sīð-frome     searwum gearwe  
1815 wīgend wæron,     ēode weorð Denum  
æðeling tō yppan,     þær se ōðer wæs  
hæle hilde-dēor,     Hrōðgār grētte.

# The Parting Words

## Fit XXVII

- Bēowulf maðelode,      bearn Ecgbēowes:  
"Nū wē sǣ-līðend      secgan wyllað  
1820 "feorran cumene,      þæt wē fundiað  
"Higelāc sēcan.      Wæron hēr tela  
"willum bewenede;      þū ūs wēl dohtest.  
"Gif ic þonne on eorðan      ōwihte mæg  
"þinre mōd-lufan      māran tilian,  
1825 "gumena dryhten,      þonne ic gýt dyde,  
"gūð-geweorca      ic bēo gearo sōna.  
"Gif ic þæt gefricge      ofer flōda begang,  
"þæt þec ymbe-sittend      egesan þýwað,  
"swā þec hetende      hwīlum dydon,  
1830 "ic þē þūsenda      þegna bringe,  
"hæleða tō helpe.      Ic on Higelāce wāt,  
"Gēata dryhten,      þēah þe hē geong sý,  
"folces hyrde,      þæt hē mec fremman wile  
"wordum and worcum,      þæt ic þē wēl herige,  
1835 "and þē tō gēoce      gār-holt bere  
"mægenes fultum,      þær þē bið manna þearf;  
"gif him þonne Hrēðric      tō hofum Gēata  
"geþingeð, þēodnes bearn,      hē mæg þær fela  
"frēonda findan:      feor-cýððe bēoð  
1840 "sēlran gesōhte      þām þe him selfa dēah."  
Hrōðgār maðelode      him on andsware:  
"Þē þā word-cwydas      wittig drihten  
"on sefan sende!      ne hýrde ic snotorlīcor  
"on swā geongum feore      guman þingian:



- 1845 "þū eart mægenes strang and on mōde frōd,  
 "wīs word-cwida. Wēn ic talige,  
 "gif þæt gegangeð, þæt þe gār nymeð,  
 "hild heoru-grimme Hrēðles eaferan,  
 "ādī oððe īren ealdor þīnne,  
 1850 "folces hyrde, and þū þīn feorh hafast,  
 "þæt þe Sæ-Gēatas sēlran næbben  
 "tō gecēosenne cyning ænigne,  
 "hord-weard hāleða, gif þū healdan wylt  
 "māga rīce. Mē þīn mōd-sefa  
 1855 "līcað leng swā wēl, lēofa Bēowulf:  
 "hafast þū gefēred, þæt þām folcum sceal,  
 "Gēata lēodum and Gār-Denum  
 "sib gemānum and sacu restan,  
 "inwit-nīðas, þē hīe ær drugon;  
 1860 "wesan, þenden ic wealde wīdan rīces,  
 "māðmas gemāne, manig oðerne  
 "gōdum gegrētan ofer ganotes bæð;  
 "sceal hring-naca ofer hēaðu bringan  
 "lāc and luf-tācen. Ic þā lēode wāt  
 1865 "gē wið fēond gē wið frēond fæste geworhte  
 "æghwæs untāle ealde wīsan."  
 Þā gīt him eorla hlēo inne gesealde,  
 mago Healfdenes māðmas twelfe,  
 hēt hine mid þāem lācum lēode swāse  
 1870 sēcean on gesyntum, snūde eft cuman.  
 Gecyste þā cyning æðelum gōd,  
 þēoden Scildinga, þegen betstan  
 and be healse genam; hruron him tēaras,  
 blonden-feaxum: him wæs bēga wēn,  
 1875 ealdum infrōdum, oðres swiðor,  
 þæt hī seoððan gesēon mōston  
 mōdige on meðle. Wæs him se man tō þon lēof,  
 þæt hē þone brēost-wylm forberan ne mehte,  
 ac him on hreðre hyge-bendum fæst  
 1880 æfter dēorum men dyrne langað  
 beorn wið blōde. Him Bēowulf þanan,  
 gūð-rinc gold-wlanc græs-moldan træd,  
 since hrēmig: sǣ-genga bād

āgend-frēan,    sē þe on ancre rād.  
1885 Þā wæs on gange    gifu Hrōðgāres  
oft geæhted:    þæt wæs ān cyning  
æghwæs orleahtrē,    oð þæt hine ylðo benam  
mægenes wynnum,    sē þe oft manegum scōð.

# Bēowulf Returns to Geatland.-The Queens Hygd and Thrytho

Fit XXVIII

- Cwōm þā tō flōde    fela-mōdigra  
1890 hæg-stealdra hēap;    hring-net bāeron,  
locene leoðo-syrca.    Land-weard onfand  
eft-sið eorla,    swā hē ær dyde;  
nō hē mid hearme    of hlīðes nosan  
gæstas grētte,    ac him tōgēanes rād;  
1895 cwæð þæt wilcuman    Wedera lēodum  
scawan scīr-hame    tō scipe fōron.  
Þā wæs on sande    sǣ-gēap naca  
hladen here-wædum,    hringed-stefna  
mēarum and mǣðmum:    mæst hlīfade  
1900 ofer Hrōðgāres    hord-gestrēonum.  
Hē þām bāt-wearde    bunden golde  
swurd gesealde,    þæt hē syððan wæs  
on meodu-bence    mǣðme þȳ weorðra,  
yrfe-lāfe.    Gewāt him on ȳð-nacan,  
1905 drēfan dēop wæter,    Dena land ofgeaf.  
Þā wæs be mæste    mere-hrægla sum,  
segl sǣle fæst.    Sund-wudu þunede,  
nō þær wēg-flotan    wind ofer ȳðum  
siðes getwæfde;    sǣ-genga fōr,  
1910 flēat fāmig-heals    forð ofer ȳðe,  
bunden-stefna    ofer brim-strēamas,

- þæt hīe Gēata clifu    ongitan meahton,  
 cūðe næssas.    Cēol up geþrang,  
 lyft-geswenced    on lande stōd.  
 1915 Hraðe wæs æt holme    hȳð-weard gearo,  
   sē þe ær lange tīd,    lēofra manna  
   fūs, æt faroðe    feor wlātode;  
   sælde tō sande    sīd-fæðme scip  
   oncer-bendum fæst,    þȳ læs hym ȳða þrym  
 1920 wudu wynsuman    forwrecan meahte.  
   Hēt þā up beran    æðelinga gestrēon,  
   frætwe and fæt-gold;    næs him feor þanon  
   tō gesēcanne    sinces bryttan:  
   Higelāc Hrēðling    þær æt hām wunað,  
 1925 selfa mid gesīðum    sǣ-wealle nēah;  
   bold wæs betlīc,    brego-rōf cyning,  
   hēa on healle,    Hygd swīðe geong,  
   wīs, wēl-þungen,    þēah þe wintra lȳt  
   under burh-locan    gebiden hǣbbe  
 1930 Hæreðes dōhtor:    næs hīo hnāh swā þēah,  
   nē tō gnēað gifa    Gēata lēodum,  
   māðm-gestrēona.    Mod Þrȳðo wæg,  
   fremu folces cwēn,    firen ondrysne:  
   nāenig þæt dorste    dēor genēðan  
 1935 swǣsra gesīða,    nefne sin-frēa,  
   þæt hire an dāges    ēagum starede;  
   ac him wæl-bende    weotode tealde,  
   hand-gewriðene:    hraðe seoððan wæs  
   æfter mund-gripe    mēce gepinged,  
 1940 þæt hit sceaðen-mǣl    scȳran mōste,  
   cwealm-bealu cȳðan.    Ne bið swylc cwēnlīc þēaw  
   idese tō efnanne,    þēah þe hīo ænlīcu sȳ,  
   þætte freoðu-webbe    fēores onsæce  
   æfter līge-torne    lēofne mannan.  
 1945 Hūru þæt onhōhsnode    Heminges mæg;  
   ealo drincende    oððer sǣðan,  
   þæt hīo lēod-bealewa    lǣs gefremede,  
   inwit-nīða,    syððan ærest wearð  
   gyfen gold-hroden    geongum cēman,  
 1950 æðelum dīore,    syððan hīo Offan flet

ofer fealone flōd      be fæder lāre  
 sīðe gesōhte,      þær hīo syððan wēl  
 in gum-stōle,      gōde mære,  
 līf-gesceafta      lifigende brēc,  
 1955 hīold hēah-lufan      wið hæleða brego,  
 ealles mon-cynnes      mīne gefræge  
 þone sēlestan      bī sām twēonum  
 eormen-cynnes;      forþām Offa wæs  
 geofum and gūðum      gār-cēne man,  
 1960 wīde geweorðod;      wīsdōme hēold  
 ēðel sīnne,      þonon Ēomær wōc  
 hæleðum tō helpe,      Heminges mæg,  
 nefa Gārmundes,      nīða cræftig.

# His Arrival. Hygelac's Reception

Fit XXIX

- Gewāt him þā se hearda    mid his hond-scole  
1965 sylf æfter sande    sǣ-wong tredan,  
wīde waroðas.    Woruld-candel scān,  
sigel sūðan fūs:    hī sīð drugon,  
elne geēodon,    tō þæs þe eorla hlēo,  
bonan Ongenþēowes    burgum on innan,  
1970 geongne gūð-cyning    gōdne gefrūnon  
hringas dælan.    Higelāce wæs  
sīð Bēowulfes    snūde gecyðed,  
þæt þær on worðig    wīgendra hlēo,  
lind-gestealla    lifigende cwōm,  
1975 heaðo-lāces hāl    tō hofe gongan.  
Hraðe wæs gerȳmed,    swā se rīca bebēad,  
fēðe-gestum    flet innan-weard.  
Gesæt þā wið sylfne,    sē þā sæcce genæs,  
mæg wið mæge,    syððan man-dryhten  
1980 þurh hlēoðor-cwyde    holdne gegrette  
mēaglum wordum.    Meodu-scencum  
hwearf geond þæt reced    Hæreðes dōhtor:  
lufode þā lēode,    līð-wæge bær  
hælum tō handa.    Higelāc ongan  
1985 sīnne geseldan    in sele þām hēan  
fægre fricgean,    hyne fyrwet bræc,  
hwylce Sæ-Gēata    sīðas wæron:  
"Hū lomp ēow on lāde,    lēofa Bīowulf,

- "þā þū færinga feorr gehogodest,  
 1990 "sæcce sēcean ofer sealt wæter,  
 "hilde tō Hiorote? Ac þū Hrōðgāre  
 "wīd-cūðne wēan wihte gebēttest,  
 "mærum þeodne? Ic þæs mōd-ceare  
 "sorh-wylmum sēað, sīðe ne truwode  
 1995 "lēofes mannes; ic þē lange bæd,  
 "þæt þū þone wæl-gæst wihte ne grētte,  
 "lēte Sūð-Dene sylfe geweorðan  
 "gūðe wið Grendel. Gode ic þanc secge,  
 "þæs þe ic þē gesundne gesēon mōste."  
 2000 Bīowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgbīowes:  
 "Þæt is undyrne, dryhten Higelāc,  
 "mære gemēting monegum fira,  
 "hwylc orleg-hwīl uncer Grendles  
 "wearð on þām wange, þær hē worna fela  
 2005 "Sige-Scildingum sorge gefremede,  
 "yrmðe tō aldre; ic þæt eal gewræc,  
 "swā ne gylpan þearf Grendeles māga  
 "ænig ofer eorðan ūht-hlem þone,  
 "sē þe lengest leofað lāðan cynnes,  
 2010 "fenne bifongen. Ic þær furðum cwōm,  
 "tō þām hring-sele Hrōðgār grētan:  
 "sōna mē se mæra mago Healfdenes,  
 "syððan hē mōd-sefan mīnne cūðe,  
 "wið his sylfes sunu setl getæhte.  
 2015 "Weorod wæs on wynne; ne seah ic wīdan feorh  
 "under heofenes hwealf heal-sittendra  
 "medu-drēam mārān. Hwīlum mæru cwēn,  
 "friðu-sibb folca flet eall geond-hwearf,  
 "bædde byre geonge; oft hīo bēah-wriðan  
 2020 "secge sealde, ær hīo tō setle gēong.  
 "Hwīlum for duguðe dōhtor Hrōðgāres  
 "eorlum on ende ealu-wæge bær,  
 "þā ic Frēaware flet-sittende  
 "nemnan hýrde, þær hīo nægled sinc  
 2025 "hæleðum sealde: sīo gehāten wæs,  
 "geong gold-hroden, gladum suna Frōdan;  
 "hafað þæs geworden wine Scyldinga

"rīces hyrde and þæt ræd talað,  
"þæt hē mid þȳ wīfe wæl-fæhðā dæl,  
2030 "sæcca gesette. Oft nō seldan hwær  
"æfter lēod-hryre lȳtle hwīle  
"bon-gār būgeð, þēah sēo brȳd duge!



# Bēowulf's Story of the Slayings

Fit XXX

- "Mæg þæs þonne ofþyncan    þēoden Heaðobeardna  
"and þegna gehwām    þāra lēoda,  
2035 "þonne hē mid fāmnan    on flett gæð,  
"dryht-bearn Dena    duguða biwenede:  
"on him gladiað    gomeþra lāfe  
"heard and hring-mæl,    Heaðobeardna gestrēon,  
"þenden hīe þām wæpnum    wealdan mōston,  
2040 "oð þæt hīe forlæddan    tō þām lind-plegan  
"swæse gesiðas    ond hyra sylfra feorh.  
"Þonne cwið æt bēore,    sē þe bēah gesyhð,  
"eald æsc-wiga,    sē þe eall geman  
"gār-cwealm gumena    (him bið grim sefa),  
2045 "onginneð geōmor-mōd    geongne ceman  
"þurh hreðra gehygd    higes cunnian,  
"wīg-bealu weccēan    and þæt word ācwyð:  
"Meaht þū, mīn wine,    mēce gecnāwan,  
"þone þin fæder    tō gefeohte bær  
2050 "'under here-grīman    hindeman siðe,  
"dýre īren,    þær hyne Dene slōgon,  
"wēoldon wæl-stōwe,    syððan wiðer-gyld læg,  
"æfter hāleða hryre,    hwate Scyldungas?  
"Nu hēr þāra banena    byre nāt-hwylces,  
2055 "'frætsum hrēmig    on flet gæð,  
"morðres gylpeð    and þone māððum byreð,  
"þone þe þū mid rihte    rædan sceoldest!"

- "Manað swā and myndgað    mæla gehwylce  
 "sārum wordum,    oð þæt sæl cymeð,  
 2060 "þæt se fæmnan þegn    fore fæder dædum  
 "æfter billes bite    blōd-fāg swefeð,  
 "ealdres scyldig;    him se oðer þonan  
 "losað lifigende,    con him land geara.  
 "Þonne bīoð brocene    on bā healfe  
 2065 "āð-sweord eorla;    syððan Ingelde  
 "weallað wæl-nīðas    and him wīf-lufan  
 "æfter cear-wælmum    cōlran weorðað.  
 "Þy ic Heaðobeardna    hylde ne telge,  
 "dryht-sibbe dæl    Denum unfæcne,  
 2070 "frēond-scipe fæstne.    Ic sceal forð sprecan  
 "gēn ymbe Grendel,    þæt þū geara cunne,  
 "sinces brytta,    tō hwan syððan wearð  
 "hond-ræs hæleða.    Syððan heofones gim  
 "glād ofer grundas,    gæst yrre cwōm,  
 2075 "eatol æfen-grom,    ūser nēosan,  
 "pær wē gesunde    sæl weardodon;  
 "pær wæs Hondscīo    hild onsæge,  
 "feorh-bealu fægum,    hē fyrrest læg,  
 "gyrdeð cempa;    him Grendel wearð,  
 2080 "mærum magu-þegne    tō mūð-bonan,  
 "lēofes mannes    līc eall forswealg.  
 "Nō þy ær ūt þā gēn    īdel-hende  
 "bona blōdig-tōð    bealewa gemyndig,  
 "of þām gold-sele    gongan wolde,  
 2085 "ac hē mægnes rōf    mīn costode,  
 "grāpode gearo-folm.    Glōf hangode  
 "sīd and syllic    searo-bendum fæst,  
 "sīo wæs orþoncum    eall gegyrwed  
 "dēofles cræftum    and dracan fellum:  
 2090 "hē mec pær on innan    unsynnigne,  
 "dīor dæd-fruma,    gedōn wolde,  
 "manigra sumne:    hyt ne mihte swā,  
 "syððan ic on yrre    upp-riht āstōd.  
 "Tō lang ys tō reccenne,    hū ic þām lēod-sceaðan  
 2095 "yfla gehwylces    ond-lēan forgeald;  
 "pær ic, þēoden mīn,    þīne lēode

- "weorðode weorcum.      Hē on weg losade,  
 "lȳtle hwīle      līf-wynna brēac;  
 "hwæðre him sīo swīðre      swaðe weardade  
 2100 "hand on Hiorte      and hē hēan þonan,  
 "mōdes geōmor      mere-grund gefēoll.  
 "Mē þone wæl-ræs      wine Scildunga  
 "fættan golde      fela lēanode,  
 "manegum māðmum,      syððan mergen cōm  
 2105 "and wē tō symble      geseten hæfdon.  
 "Þær wæs gidd and glēo;      gomela Scilding  
 "fela fricgende      feorran rehte;  
 "hwīlum hilde-dēor      hearpan wynne,  
 "gomen-wudu grētte;      hwīlum gyd āwræc  
 2110 "sōð and sārlic;      hwīlum syllic spell  
 "rehte æfter rihte      rūm-heort cyning.  
 "Hwīlum eft ongan      eldo gebunden,  
 "gomel gūð-wiga      gioguðe cwīðan  
 "hilde-strengo;      hreðer inne wēoll,  
 2115 "þonne hē wintrum frōd      worn gemunde.  
 "Swā wē þær inne      andlangne dæg  
 "nīode nāman,      oð þæt niht becwōm  
 "ōðer tō yldum.      Þā wæs eft hraðe  
 "gearo gyrn-wræce      Grendes mōdor,  
 2120 "sīðode sorh-full;      sunu dēað fornam,  
 "wīg-hete Wedra.      Wīf unhȳre  
 "hyre bearn gewræc,      beorn ācwealde  
 "ellenlice;      þær wæs Æsc-here,  
 "frōdan fyrn-witan,      feorh ūðgenge;  
 2125 "nōðer hȳ hine ne mōston,      syððan mergen cwōm,  
 "dēað-wērigne      Denia lēode  
 "bronde forbærnan,      nē on bæl hladan  
 "lēofne mannan:      hīo þæt lic ætbær  
 "fēondes fæðmum      under firgen-strēam.  
 2130 "Þæt wæs Hrōðgāre      hrēowa tornost  
 "þāra þe lēod-fruman      lange begeāte;  
 "þā se þeoden mec      þīne life  
 "healsode hrēoh-mōd,      þæt ic on holma geþring  
 "eorl-scipe efnde,      ealdre genēðde,  
 2135 "mærho fremede:      hē mē mēde gehēt.

"Ic þā þæs wælnes,      þē is wīde cūð,  
 "grimne gryrelīcne      grund-hyrde fond.  
 "Þær unc hwīle wæs      hand gemæne;  
 "holm heolfre wēoll      and ic hēafde becearf  
 2140 "in þām grund-sele      Grendeles mōdor  
 "ēacnum ecgum,      unsōfte þonan  
 "feorh oðferede;      næs ic fæge þā gýt,  
 "ac mē eorla hlēo      eft gesealde  
 "māðma menigeo,      maga Healfdenes.

# He Gives Presents to Hygelac. Hygelac Rewards Him. Hygelac's Death. Bēowulf Reigns

Fit XXXI

- 2145 "Swā se þēod-kyning    þēawum lyfde;  
"nealles ic þām lēanum    forloren hæfde,  
"mægnas mēde,    ac hē mē mādmas geaf,  
"sunu Healfdenes,    on sīnne sylfes dōm;  
"þā ic þē, beorn-cyning,    bringan wylle,  
2150 "ēstum geȝwan.    Gēn is eall æt þē  
"lissa gelong:    ic lȝt hafo  
"hēafod-māga,    nefne Hygelāc þec!"  
Hēt þā in beran    eafor, hēafod-segn,  
heaðo-stēapne helm,    hāre byrnan,  
2155 gūð-sweord geatolīc,    gyd æfter wræc:  
"Mē þis hilde-sceorp    Hrōðgār sealde,  
"snotra fengel,    sume worde hēt,  
"þæt ic his ærest    þē eft gesægde,  
"cwæð þæt hyt hæfde    Hiorogār cyning,  
2160 "lēod Scyldunga    lange hwīle:  
"nō þȝ ær suna sīnum    syllan wolde,  
"hwatum Heorowearde,    þēah hē him hold wære,  
"brēost-gewædu.    Brūc ealles well!"  
Hȝrde ic þæt þām frætwum    fēower mēaras  
2165 lungre gelīce    lāst weardode,

- æppel-fealuwe;    hē him ēst getēah  
 mēara and māðma.    Swā sceal mæg dōn,  
 nealles inwit-net    oðrum bregdan,  
 dyrnum cræfte    dēað rēnian  
 2170 hond-gesteallan.    Hygelāce wæs,  
 nīða heardum,    nefa swyðe hold  
 and gehwæðer oðrum    hrōðra gemyndig.  
 Hȳrde ic þæt hē þone heals-bēah    Hygde gesealde,  
 wrætlicne wundur-māððum,    þone þe him Wealhþeo geaf,  
 2175 þeodnes dōhtor,    þrīo wicg somod  
 swancor and sadol-beorht;    hyre syððan wæs  
 æfter bēah-þege    brēost geweorðod.  
 Swā bealdode    bearn Ecgbēowes,  
 guma gūðum cūð,    gōdum dædum,  
 2180 drēah æfter dōme,    nealles druncne slōg  
 heorð-genēatas;    næs him hrēoh sefa,  
 ac hē man-cynnes    mæste cræfte  
 gin-fæstan gife,    þē him god sealde,  
 hēold hilde-dēor.    Hēan wæs lange,  
 2185 swā hyne Gēata bearn    gōdne ne tealdon,  
 nē hyne on medo-bence    micles wyrðne  
 drihten wereda    gedōn wolde;  
 swyðe oft sægdon,    þæt hē slēac wære,  
 æðeling unfrom:    edwenden cwōm  
 2190 tīr-ēadigum menn    torna gehwylces.  
 Hēt þā eorla hlēo    in gefetian,  
 heaðo-rōf cyning,    Hrēðles lāfe,  
 golde gegyrede;    næs mid Gēatum þā  
 sinc-māððum sēlra    on sweordes hād;  
 2195 þæt hē on Bīowulfes    bearm ālegde,  
 and him gesealde    seofan þūsendo,  
 bold and brego-stōl.    Him wæs bām samod  
 on þām lēod-scipe    lond gecynde,  
 eard ēðel-riht,    oðrum swiðor  
 2200 sīde rīce,    þām þær sēlra wæs.  
 Eft þæt geīode    ufaran dōgrum  
 hilde-hlæmmum,    syððan Hygelāc læg  
 and Heardrēde    hilde-mēceas  
 under bord-hrēoðan    tō bonan wurdon,

- 2205 þā hyne gesōhtan    on sige-þēode  
       hearde hilde-frecan,    Heaðo-Scilfingas,  
       niðra genægdan    nefan Hererīces.  
       Syððan Bēowulfe    brāde rīce  
       on hand gehwearf:    hē gehēold tela  
 2210 fiftig wintru    (wæs þā frōd cyning,  
       eald ēðel-weard),    oð þæt ān ongan  
       deorcum nihtum    draca rīcsian,  
       sē þe on hēare hæðe    hord beweotode,  
       stān-beorh stēapne:    stīg under læg,  
 2215 eldum uncūð.    Þær on innan gīong  
       niðra nāt-hwylces    nēode gefēng  
       hæðnum horde    hond . d . . . geþ . . hwylc  
       since fāhne,    hē þæt syððan . . . . .  
       . . . þ . . . lð . þ . . l . g  
 2220 slæpende be fýre,    fyrena hyrde  
       þeofes cræfte,    þæt sie . . . . ðioð . . . . .  
       . idh . folc-beorn,    þæt hē gebolgen wæs.

# The Fire-Drake. the Hoard

Fit XXXII

- Nealles mid geweoldum    wyrm-horda . . . cræft  
sōhte sylfes willum,    sē þe him sære gesceōd,  
2225 ac for þrēa-nēdlan    þēow nāt-hwylces  
hæleða bearna    hete-swengeas flēah,  
for ofer-þearfe    and þær inne fealh  
secg syn-bysig.    Sōna in þā tīde  
þæt . . . . þām gyste    . . . . br . g . stōd,  
2230 hwæðre earm-sceapen . . . . .  
.. ð . . . sceapen o . . . . i r . . e se fæs begeat,  
sinc-fæt geseah:    þær wæs swylcra fela  
in þām eorð-scræfe    ær-gestrēona,  
swā hȳ on geār-dagum    gumena nāt-hwylc  
2235 eormen-lāfe    æðelan cynnes  
þanc-hycgende    þær gehȳdde,  
deore mǣðmas.    Ealle hīe dēað fornam  
ærran mælum,    and se ān þā gēn  
lēoda duguðe,    sē þær lengest hwearf,  
2240 weard wine-geōmor    wīscste þæs yldan,  
þæt hē lȳtel fæc    long-gestrēona  
brūcan mōste.    Beorh eal gearo  
wunode on wonge    wæter-ȳðum nēah,  
nīwe be næsse    nearo-cræftum fæst:  
2245 þær on innan bær    eorl-gestrēona  
hringa hyrde    hard-fyrdne dæl  
fættan goldes,    fēa worda cwæð:  
"Heald þū nū, hrūse,    nū hæleð ne mōston,  
"eorla æhte.    Hwæt! hit ær on þē  
2250 "gōde begeāton;    gūð-dēað fornam,



- "feorh-bealo frēcne    fȳra gehwylcne,  
 "lēoda mīnra,    þāra þe þis lif ofgeaf,  
 "gesāwon sele-drēam.    Nāh hwā sweord wege  
 "oððe fetige    fæted wæge,  
 2255 "drync-fæt dēore:    duguð ellor scōc.  
 "Sceal se hearda helm    hyrsted golde  
 "fætum befeallen:    feormiend swefað,  
 "þā þe beado-grīman    bȳwan sceoldon,  
 "gē swylce sēo here-pād,    sīo æt hilde gebād  
 2260 "ofer borda gebræc    bite īrena,  
 "brosnað æfter beorne.    Ne mæg byrnan hring  
 "æfter wīg-fruman    wīde fēran  
 "hæleðum be healfe;    næs hearpan wyn,  
 "gomen glēo-bēames,    nē gōd hafoc  
 2265 "geond sæl swingeð,    nē se swifta mearh  
 "burh-stede bēateð.    Bealo-cwealm hafað  
 "fela feorh-cynna    feorr onsended!"  
 Swā giōmor-mōd    gīohðo mænde,  
 ān æfter eallum    unblīðe hwēop,  
 2270 dægēs and nihtes,    oð þæt dēaðes wylm  
 hrān æt heortan.    Hord-wynne fond  
 eald ūht-sceaða    opene standan,  
 sē þe byrnende    biorgas sēceð  
 nacod nīð-draca,    nihtes flēogeð  
 2275 fȳre befangen;    hyne fold-būend  
 wīde gesāwon.    Hē gēwunian sceall  
 hlāw under hrūsan,    þær hē hæðen gold  
 warað wintrum frōd;    ne byð him wihte þē sēl.  
 Swā se þēod-sceaða    þrēo hund wintra  
 2280 hēold on hrūsan    hord-ærna sum  
 ēacen-cræftig,    oð þæt hyne ān ābealh  
 mon on mōde:    man-dryhtne bær  
 fæted wæge,    frioðo-wære bæd  
 hlāford sīnne.    Þā wæs hord rāsod,  
 2285 onboren bēaga hord,    bēne getiðad  
 fēa-sceaftum men.    Frēa scēawode  
 fīra fyrn-geweorc    forman sīðe.  
 Þā se wyrm onwōc,    wrōht wæs genīwad;  
 stonc þā æfter stāne,    stearc-heort onfand

- 2290 fēondes fōt-lāst;    hē tō forð gestōp,  
       dyrnan cræfte,    dracan hēafde nēah.  
 Swā mæg unfæge    ēaðe gedīgan  
       wēan and wræc-sið,    sē þe waldendes  
       hyldo gehealdeð.    Hord-weard sōhte  
 2295 georne æfter grunde,    wolde guman findan,  
       þone þe him on sweofote    sære getēode:  
       hāt and hrēoh-mōd    hlæw oft ymbe hwearf,  
       ealne ūtan-weardne;    nē þær ænig mon  
       wæs on þære wēstenne.    Hwæðre hilde gefeh,  
 2300 beado-weorces:    hwīlum on beorh æthwearf,  
       sinc-fæt sōhte;    hē þæt sōna onfand,  
       þæt hæfde gumena sum    goldes gefandod  
       hēah-gestrēona.    Hord-weard onbād  
       earfoðlice,    oð þæt æfen cwōm;  
 2305 wæs þā gebolgen    beorges hyrde,  
       wolde se lāða    līge forgylðan  
       drinc-fæt dýre.    Þā wæs dæg sceacen  
       wyrme on willan,    nō on wealle leng  
       bīdan wolde,    ac mid bæle fōr,  
 2310 fýre gefýsed.    Wæs se fruma egeslic  
       lēodum on lande,    swā hyt lungre wearð  
       on hyra sinc-gifan    sære geendod.

# Beowulf Resolves to Kill the Fire-Drake

Fit XXXIII

- Pā se gæst ongan     glēdum spīwan,  
    beorht hofu bærnan;     bryne-lēoma stōd  
2315 eldum on andan;     nō þær āht cwices  
    lāð lyft-floga     læfan wolde.  
    Wæs þæs wyrmes wīg     wīde gesyne,  
    nearo-fāges nīð     nēan and feorran,  
    hū se gūð-sceaða     Gēata lēode  
2320 hatode and hýnde:     hord eft gescēat,  
    dryht-sele dyrnne     ær dāges hwīle.  
    Hæfde land-wara     lige befangen,  
    bæle and bronde;     beorges getruwode,  
    wīges and wealles:     him sēo wēn gelēah.  
2325 Pā wæs Bīowulfe     brōga gecyðed  
    snūde tō sōðe,     þæt his sylfes him  
    bolda sēlest     bryne-wylmum mealt,  
    gif-stōl Gēata.     þæt þām gōdan wæs  
    hrēow on hreðre,     hyge-sorga mæst:  
2330 wēnde se wīsa,     þæt hē wealdende,  
    ofer ealde riht,     ēcean dryhtne  
    bitre gebulge:     brēost innan wēoll  
    þeostrum geþoncum,     swā him geþywe ne wæs.  
    Hæfde lig-draca     lēoda fæsten,  
2335 ēa-lond ūtan,     eorð-weard þone  
    glēdum forgrunden.     Him þæs gūð-cyning,  
    Wedera þioden,     wræce leornode.

- Heht him þā gewyrcean    wīgendra hlēo  
 eall-īrenne,    eorla dryhten  
 2340 wīg-bord wrætlic;    wisse hē gearwe,  
 þæt him holt-wudu    helpa ne meahte,  
 lind wið lige.    Sceolde lān-daga  
 æðeling ær-gōd    ende gebīdan  
 worulde lifes    and se wyrm somod;  
 2345 þēah þe hord-welan    hēolde lange.  
 Oferhogode þā    hringa fengel,  
 þæt hē þone wīd-flogan    weorode gesōhte,  
 sīdan herge;    nō hē him þā sæcce ondrēd,  
 nē him þæs wyrmes wīg    for wiht dyde,  
 2350 eafōð and ellen;    forþon hē ær fela  
 nearo nēðende    nīða gedīgde,  
 hilde-hlemma,    syððan hē Hrōðgāres,  
 sigor-ēadig secg,    sele fælsode  
 and æt gūðe forgrāp    Grendeles mægum,  
 2355 lāðan cynnes.    Nō þæt læsest wæs  
 hond-gemota,    þær mon Hygelāc slōh,  
 syððan Gēata cyning    gūðe ræsum,  
 frēa-wine folces    Frēslondum on,  
 Hrēðles eafora    hioro-dryncum swealt,  
 2360 bille gebēaten;    þonan Bīowulf cōm  
 sylfes cræfte,    sund-nytte drēah;  
 hæfde him on earme    ... XXX  
 hilde-geatwa,    þā hē tō holme stāg.  
 Nealles Hetware    hrēmge þorfton  
 2365 fēðe-wīges,    þē him foran ongēan  
 linde bāron:    lýt eft becwōm  
 fram þām hild-frecan    hāmes nīosan.  
 Oferswam þā sioleða bigong    sunu Ecgbēowes,  
 earm ān-haga    eft tō lēodum,  
 2370 þær him Hygd gebēad    hord and rīce,  
 bēagas and brego-stōl:    bearne ne truwode,  
 þæt hē wið æl-fylcum    ēðel-stōlas  
 healdan cūðe,    þā wæs Hygelāc dēad.  
 Nō þy ær fēa-scafte    findan meahton  
 2375 æt þām æðelinge    ænige þinga,  
 þæt hē Heardrēde    hlāford wære,

- oððe þone cyne-dōm      cīosan wolde;  
 hwæðre hē him on folce      frēond-lārum hēold,  
 ēstum mid āre,      oð þæt hē yldra wearð,  
 2380 Weder-Gēatum wēold.      Hyne wræc-mæcgas  
 ofer sǣ sōhtan,      suna Ōhteres:  
 hæfdon hȳ forhealden      helm Scylfinga,  
 þone sēlestan      sǣ-cyninga,  
 þāra þe in Swīo-rīce      sinc brytnade,  
 2385 mǣrne þēoden.      Him þæt tō mearce wearð;  
 hē þær orfeorme      feorh-wunde hlēat  
 sweordes swengum,      sunu Hygelāces;  
 and him eft gewāt      Ongenþīowes bearn  
 hāmes nīosan,      syððan Heardrēd læg;  
 2390 lēt þone brego-stōl      Bīowulf healdan,  
 Gēatum wealdan:      þæt wæs gōd cyning.

# Retrospect of Bēowulf.—Strife Between Sweonas and Geatas

Fit XXXIV

Sē þæs lēod-hryres    lēan gemunde  
uferan dōgrum,    Ēadgilse wearð  
fēa-sceaftum fēond.    Folce gesteppe  
2395 ofer sǣ sīde    sunu Ōhteres  
wigum and wǣpnum:    hē gewræc syððan  
cealdum cear-siðum,    cyning ealdre binēat.  
Swā hē nīða gehwane    genesen hæfde,  
slīðra geslyhta,    sunu Ecgþīowes,  
2400 ellen-weorca,    oð þone ānne dæg,  
þē hē wið þām wyrme    gewegan sceolde.  
Gewāt þā twelfa sum    torne gebolgen  
dryhten Gēata    dracan scēawian;  
hæfde þā gefrūnen,    hwanan sīo fæhð ārās,  
2405 bealo-nið biorna;    him tō bearme cwōm  
māððum-fæt mære    þurh þæs meldan hond,  
Sē wæs on þām prēate    þreotteoða secg,  
sē þæs orleges    ōr onstealde,  
hæft hyge-giōmor,    sceolde hēan þonon  
2410 wong wīsian:    hē ofer willan gīong  
tō þæs þe hē eorð-sele    ānne wisse,  
hlæw under hrūsan    holm-wylme nēh,  
yð-gewinne,    sē wæs innan full  
wrætta and wīra:    weard unhīore,

- 2415 gearo gūð-freca, gold-māðmas hēold,  
eald under eorðan; næs þæt yðe cēap,  
tō gegangenne gumena ænigum.  
Gesæt þā on næsse nīð-heard cyning,  
þenden hælo ābēad heorð-genēatum
- 2420 gold-wine Gēata: him wæs geōmor sefa,  
wæfre and wæl-fūs, Wyrð ungemete nēah,  
sē þone gomelan grētan sceolde,  
sēcean sǣwle hord, sundur gedālan  
lif wið līce: nō þon lange wæs
- 2425 feorh æðelinges flæsce bewunden.  
Bīowulf maðelade, bearn Ecgbēowes:  
"Fela ic on giogoðe guð-ræsa genæs,  
"orleg-hwīla: ic þæt eall gemon.  
"Ic wæs syfan-wintre, þā mec sinca baldor,
- 2430 "frēa-wine folca æt mīnum fæder genam,  
"hēold mec and hæfde Hrēðel cyning,  
"geaf mē sinc and symbel, sibbe gemunde;  
"næs ic him tō līfe lāðra ōwihte  
"beorn in burgum, þonne his bearna hwylc,
- 2435 "Herebeald and Hæðcyn, oððe Hygelāc mīn.  
"Wæs þām yldestan ungedēfelīce  
"māges dædum morðor-bed strēd,  
"syððan hyne Hæðcyn of horn-bogan,  
"his frēa-wine flāne geswencte,
- 2440 "miste mercelses and his mæg ofscēt,  
"brōðor oðerne, blōdigan gāre:  
"þæt wæs feoh-lēas gefeoht, fyrenum gesyngad  
"hreðre hyge-mēðe; sceolde hwæðre swā þēah  
"æðeling unwrecen ealdres linnan.
- 2445 "Swā bið geōmorlīc gomelum ceorle  
"tō gebīdanne, þæt his byre rīde  
"giong on galgan, þonne hē gyd wrece,  
"sārigne sang, þonne his sunu hangað  
"hrefne tō hrōðre and hē him helpe ne mæg,
- 2450 "eald and in-frōd, ænige gefremman.  
"Symble bið gemyndgad morna gehwylce  
"eaforan ellor-sīð; oðres ne gýmeð  
"tō gebīdanne burgum on innan

"yrfe-weardes, þonne se ān hafað  
2455 "þurh dēaðes nȳd dāda gefondad.  
"Gesyhð sorh-cearig on his suna būre  
"wīn-sele wēstne, wind-gereste,  
"rēote berofene; rīdend swefað  
"hæleð in hoðman; nis þær hearpan swēg,  
2460 "gomen in geardum, swylce þær iū wæron.



# Memories of Past Time.-The Feud with the Fire-Drake

Fit XXXV

- "Gewīteð þonne on sealman, sorh-lēoð gæleð  
"ān æfter ānum: þūhte him eall tō rūm,  
"wongas and wīc-stede. Swā Wedra helm  
"æfter Herebealde heortan sorge  
2465 "weallende wæg, wihte ne meahte  
"on þām feorh-bonan fæhðe gebētan:  
"nō þȳ ær hē þone heaðo-rinc hatian ne meahte  
"lāðum dædum, þēah him lēof ne wæs.  
"Hē þā mid þære sorge, þē him sīo sār belamp,  
2470 "gum-drēam ofgeaf, godes lēoht gecēas;  
"eaferum læfde, swā dēð ēadig mon,  
"lond and lēod-byrig, þā hē of life gewāt.  
"Þā wæs synn and sacu Swēona and Gēata,  
"ofer wīd wæter wrōht gemæne,  
2475 "here-nīð hearda, syððan Hrēðel swealt,  
"oððe him Ongenþēowes eaferan wēran  
"frome fyrd-hwate, frēode ne woldon  
"ofer heafo healdan, ac ymb Hrēosna-beorh  
"eatolne inwit-scear oft gefremedon.  
2480 "Þæt mæg-wine mīne gewræcan,  
"fæhðe and fyrene, swā hyt gefræge wæs,  
"þēah þe oðer hit ealdre gebohte,  
"heardan cēape: Hæðcynne wearð,  
"Gēata dryhtne, gūð onsæge.  
2485 "Þā ic on morgne gefrægn mæg oðerne

- "billes ecgum      on bonan stælan,  
 "þær Ongenþēow      Eofores nīosade:  
 "gūð-helm tōglād,      gomela Scylfing  
 "hrēas heoro-blāc;      hond gemunde  
 2490 "fæhðo genōge,      feorh-sweng ne oftēah.  
 "Ic him þā māðmas,      þē hē mē sealde,  
 "geald æt gūðe,      swā mē gifeðe wæs,  
 "lēohtan sweorde:      hē mē lond forgeaf,  
 "eard ēðel-wyn.      Næs him ænig þearf,  
 2495 "þæt hē tō Gifðum      oððe tō Gār-Denum  
 "oððe in Swīo-rīce      sēcean þurfe  
 "wyrsan wīg-frecan,      weorðe gecypan;  
 "symle ic him on fēðan      beforan wolde,  
 "āna on orde,      and swā tō aldre sceall  
 2500 "sæcce fremman,      þenden þis sweord þolað,  
 "þæt mec ær and sīð      oft gelæste,  
 "syððan ic for dugeðum      Dæghrefne wearð  
 "tō hand-bonan,      Hūga cempan:  
 "nalles hē þā frætwe      Frēs-cyninge,  
 2505 "brēost-weorðunge      bringan mōste,  
 "ac in campe gecrong      cumbles hyrde,  
 "æðeling on elne.      Ne wæs ecg bona,  
 "ac him hilde-grāp      heortan wylmas,  
 "bān-hūs gebræc.      Nū sceall billes ecg,  
 2510 "hond and heard sweord      ymb hord wīgan."  
 Bēowulf maðelode,      bēot-wordum spræc  
 nīehstan sīðe:      "Ic genēðde fela  
 "gūða on geogoðe;      gýt ic wylle,  
 "frōd folces weard,      fæhðe sēcan,  
 2515 "mærdum fremman,      gif mec se mǣn-sceaða  
 "of eorð-sele      ūt gesēceð!"  
 Gegrētte þā      gumena gehwylcne,  
 hwate helm-berend      hindeman sīðe,  
 swæse gesīðas:      "Nolde ic sweord beran,  
 2520 "wæpen tō wyrme,      gif ic wiste hū  
 "wið þām āglæcean      elles meahte  
 "gylpe wiðgrīpan,      swā ic gið wið Grendle dyde;  
 "ac ic þær heaðu-fýres      hātes wēne,  
 "rēðes and-hāttres:      forþon ic mē on hafu

- 2525 "bord and byrnan.      Nelle ic beorges weard  
 "oferflēon fōtes trem,      fēond unhýre,  
 "ac unc sceal weorðan æt wealle,      swā unc Wyrð getēoð,  
 "metod manna gehwæs.      Ic eom on mōde from,  
 "þæt ic wið þone gūð-flogan      gylp ofersitte.
- 2530 "Gebīde gē on beorge      byrnum werede,  
 "secgas on searwum,      hwæðer sēl mæge  
 "æfter wæl-ræse      wunde gedýgan  
 "uncer twēga.      Nis þæt ēower sīð,  
 "nē gemet mannes,      nefne mīn ānes,  
 2535 "þæt hē wið āglæcean      efoðo dæle,  
 "eorl-scype efne.      Ic mid elne sceall  
 "gold gegangan      oððe gūð nimeð,  
 "feorh-bealu frēcne,      frēan ēowerne!"  
 Ārās þā bī ronde      rōf ōretta,
- 2540 heard under helm,      hioro-sercean bær  
 under stān-cleofu,      strengo getruwode  
 ānes mannes:      ne bið swylc earges sīð.  
 Geseah þā be wealle,      sē þe worna fela,  
 gum-cystum gōd,      gūða gedigde,
- 2545 hilde-hlemma,      þonne hnitan fēðan,  
 (stōd on stān-bogan)      strēam ūt þonan  
 brecan of beorge;      wæs þære burnan wælm  
 heaðo-fýrum hāt:      ne meahte horde nēah  
 unbyrnende      ænige hwīle
- 2550 dēop gedýgan      for dracan lēge.  
 Lēt þā of brēostum,      þā hē gebolgen wæs,  
 Weder-Gēata lēod      word ūt faran,  
 stearc-heort styrnde;      stefn in becōm  
 heaðo-torht hlynnan      under hārne stān.
- 2555 Hete wæs onhrēred,      hord-weard oncnīow  
 mannes reorde;      næs þær māra fyrst,  
 frēode tō friclan.      From ārest cwōm  
 oruð āglæcean      ūt of stāne,  
 hāt hilde-swāt;      hrūse dynede.
- 2560 Biorn under beorge      bord-rand onswāf  
 wið þām gryre-gieste,      Gēata dryhten:  
 þā wæs hring-bogan      heorte gefýsed  
 sæcce tō sēceanne.      Sweord ær gebræ

- gōd gūð-cyning      gomele lāfe,  
 2565 ecgum unglēaw,      æghwæðrum wæs  
 bealo-hycgendra      brōga fram oðrum.  
 Stīð-mōd gestōd      wið stēapne rond  
 winia bealdor,      þā se wyrm gebēah  
 snūde tōsomne:      hē on searwum bād.  
 2570 Gewāt þā byrnende      gebogen scriðan tō,  
 gescīfe scyndan.      Scyld wēl gebearg  
 life and līce      lāssan hwīle  
 mærum þēodne,      þonne his myne sōhte,  
 þær hē þȳ fyrste      forman dōgore  
 2575 wealdan mōste,      swā him Wyrð ne gescrāf  
 hrēð æt hilde.      Hond up ābræd  
 Gēata dryhten,      gryre-fāhne slōh  
 incge lāfe,      þæt sīo ecg gewāc  
 brūn on bāne,      bāt unswīðor,  
 2580 þonne his þīod-cyning      þearfe hæfde,  
 bysigum gebæded.      Þā wæs beorges weard  
 æfter heaðu-swenge      on hrēoum mōde,  
 wearp wæl-fȳre,      wīde sprungon  
 hilde-lēoman:      hrēð-sigora ne gealp  
 2585 gold-wine Gēata,      gūð-bill geswāc  
 nacod æt nīðe,      swā hyt nō sceolde,  
 īren ær-gōd.      Ne wæs þæt ēðe sīð,  
 þæt se mæra      maga Ecgbēowes  
 grund-wong þone      ofgyfan wolde;  
 2590 sceolde wyrmes willan      wīc eardian  
 elles hwergen,      swā sceal æghwylc mon  
 ālāetan lān-dagas.      Næs þā long tō þon,  
 þæt þā āglācean      hȳ eft gemēttan.  
 Hyrte hyne hord-weard,      hreðer æðme wēoll,  
 2595 nīwan stefne:      nearo þrowode  
 fȳre befangen      sē þe ær folce wēold.  
 Nealles him on hēape      hand-gesteallan,  
 æðelinga bearn      ymbe gestōdon  
 hilde-cystum,      ac hȳ on holt bugon,  
 2600 ealdre burgan.      Hiora in ānum wēoll  
 sefa wið sorgum:      sibb æfre ne mæg  
 wiht onwendan,      þām þe wēl þenceð.

# Wiglaf Helps Bēowulf in the Feud

Fit XXXVI

Wiglāf wæs hāten      Wēoxstānes sunu,  
lēoflīc lind-wiga,      lēod Scylfinga,  
2605 mæg Ælfheres:      geseah his mon-dryhten  
under here-grīman      hāt þrowian.  
Gemunde þā þā āre,      þē hē him ær forgeaf  
wīc-stede weligne      Wægmundinga,  
folc-rihta gehwylc,      swā his fæder āhte;  
2610 ne mihte þā forhabban,      hond rond gefēng,  
geolwe linde,      gomel swyrd getēah,  
þæt wæs mid eldum      Ēanmundes lāf,  
suna Ōhteres,      þām æt sæcce wearð  
wra cu wine-lēasum      Wēohstānes bana  
2615 mēces ecgum,      and his mægum ætbær  
brūn-fāgne helm,      hringde byrnan,  
eald sweord eotonisc,      þæt him Onela forgeaf,  
his gædelinges      gūð-gewædu,  
fyrd-searo fūslic:      nō ymbe þā fæhðe spræc,  
2620 þēah þe hē his brōðor      bearn ābredwade.  
Hē frætwe gehēold      fela missēra,  
bill and byrnan,      oð þæt his byre mihte  
eorl-scipe efnan,      swā his ær-fæder;  
geaf him þā mid Gēatum      gūð-gewæda  
2625 æghwæs unrīm;      þā hē of ealdre gewāt,  
frōd on forð-weg.      Þā wæs forma sīð  
geongan cempan,      þæt hē gūðe ræs

- mid his frēo-dryhtne    fremman sceolde;  
 ne gemealt him se mōd-sefa,    nē his mæges lāf  
 2630 gewāc æt wīge:    þæt se wyrm onfand,  
      syððan hīe tōgædre    gegān hæfdon.  
      Wīglāf maðelode    word-rihta fela,  
      sægde gesiðum,    him wæs sefa geōmor:  
      "Ic þæt mæl geman,    þær wē medu þēgun,  
 2635 "þonne wē gehēton    ūssum hlāforde  
      "in bīor-sele,    þē ūs þās bēagas geaf,  
      "þæt wē him þā gūð-geatwa    gyldan woldon,  
      "gif him þyslicu    þearf gelumpe,  
      "helmas and heard sweord:    þē hē ūsic on herge gecēas  
 2640 "tō þyssum sið-fate    sylfes willum,  
      "onmunde ūsic mærrða    and mē þās māðmas geaf,  
      "þē hē ūsic gār-wīgend    gōde tealde,  
      "hwate helm-berend,    þēah þe hlāford ūs  
      "þis ellen-weorc    āna āþōhte  
 2645 "tō gefremmanne,    folces hyrde,  
      "forþām hē manna mæst    mærrða gefremede,  
      "dæda dollicra.    Nū is sē dæg cumen,  
      "þæt ūre man-dryhten    mægenes behōfað  
      "gōdra gūð-rinca:    wutun gangan tō,  
 2650 "helpan hild-fruman,    þenden hyt sý,  
      "glēd-egesa grim!    God wāt on mec,  
      "þæt mē is micle lēofre,    þæt mīnne lic-haman  
      "mid mīnne gold-gyfan    glēd fæðmie.  
      "Ne þynceð mē gerysne,    þæt wē rondas beren  
 2655 "eft tō earde,    nemne wē æror mægen  
      "fāne gefyllan,    feorh ealgian  
      "Wedra þīodnes.    Ic wāt geare,  
      "þæt næron eald-gewyrht,    þæt hē āna scyle  
      "Gēata duguðe    gnorn þrowian,  
 2660 "gesīgan æt sæcce:    sceal ūrum þæt sweord and helm,  
      "byrne and byrdu-scrūd    bām gemæne."  
      Wōd þā þurh þone wæl-rēc,    wīg-heafolan bær  
      frēan on fultum,    fēa worda cwæð:  
      "Lēofa Bīowulf,    læst eall tela,  
 2665 "swā þū on geoguð-fēore    geāra gecwæde,  
      "þæt þū ne ālæte    be þē lifigendum

- "dōm gedrēosan:      scealt nū dædum rōf,  
 "æðeling ān-hȳdig,      ealle mægene  
 "feorh ealgian;      ic þē fullæstu!"
- 2670 Æfter þām wordum      wȳrm yrre cwōm,  
 atol inwit-gæst      ōðre sīðe,  
 fȳr-wylmum fāh      fīonda nīosan,  
 lāðra manna;      līg-ȳðum forborn  
 bord wið ronde:      byrne ne meahte
- 2675 geongum gār-wigan      gēoce gefremman:  
 ac se maga geonga      under his mæges scyld  
 elne geēode,      þā his āgen wæs  
 glēdum forgrunden.      Þā gēn gūð-cyning  
 mærdā gemunde,      mægen-strengo,
- 2680 slōh hilde-bille,      þæt hyt on heafolan stōd  
 nīðe genȳded:      Nægling forbærst,  
 geswāc æt sæcce      sweord Bīowulfes  
 gomol and græg-mæl.      Him þæt gifeðe ne wæs,  
 þæt him irenna      ecge mihton
- 2685 helpan æt hilde;      wæs sīo hond tō strong,  
 sē þe mēca gehwane      mīne gefræge  
 swenge ofersōhte,      þonne hē tō sæcce bær  
 wæpen wundrum heard,      næs him wihte þē sēl.  
 Þā wæs þēod-sceaða      þriddan sīðe,
- 2690 frēcne fȳr-draca      fæhðā gemyndig,  
 ræsdē on þone rōfan,      þā him rūm āgeald,  
 hāt and heaðo-grim,      heals ealne ymbefēng  
 biteran bānum;      hē geblōdegod wearð  
 sāwul-drīore;      swāt ȳðum wēoll.

# Bēowulf Wounded to Death

Fit XXXVII

- 2695 Ðā ic æt þearfe gefrægn    þēod-cyninges  
and-longne eorl    ellen cȳðan,  
cræft and cēnðu,    swā him gecynde wæs;  
ne hēdde hē þæs heafolan,    ac sīo hand gebarn  
mōdiges mannes,    þær hē his mæges healp,  
2700 þæt hē þone nīð-gæst    nioðor hwēne slōh,  
secg on searwum,    þæt þæt sweord gedēaf  
fāh and fāted,    þæt þæt fȳr ongon  
sweðrian syððan.    Ðā gēn sylf cyning  
gewēold his gewitte,    wæll-seaxe gebræ,  
2705 biter and beadu-scearp,    þæt hē on byrnan wæg:  
forwrat Wedra helm    wȳrm on middan.  
Fēond gefyldan    (ferh ellen wræc),  
and hī hyne þā bēgen    ābroten hæfdon,  
sib-æðelingas:    swȳlc sceolde secg wesana,  
2710 þegn æt þearfe.    Þæt þām þēodne wæs  
sīðast sīge-hwīle    sylfes dædum,  
worlde geweorces.    Ðā sīo wund ongon,  
þē him se eorð-draca    ær geworhte,  
swelan and swellan.    Hē þæt sōna onfand,  
2715 þæt him on brēostum    bealo-nīð wēoll,  
attor on innan.    Ðā se æðeling gīong,  
þæt hē bī wealle,    wīs-hycgende,  
gesæt on sesse;    seah on enta geweorc,  
hū þā stān-bogan    stapulum fæste  
2720 ēce eorð-reced    innan hēoldon.  
Hyne þā mid handa    heoro-drēorigne  
þēoden mærne    þegn ungemete till,



- wine-dryhten his      wætere gelafede,  
 hilde-sædne      and his helm onspēon.
- 2725 Bīowulf maðelode,      hē ofer benne spræc,  
 wunde wæl-blēate      (wisse hē gearwe,  
 þæt hē dæg-hwīla      gedrogen hæfde  
 eorðan wynne;      þā wæs eall sceacen  
 dōgor-gerīmes,      dēað ungemete nēah):
- 2730 "Nū ic suna mīnum      syllan wolde  
 "gūð-gewædu,      þær mē gifeðe swā  
 "ænig yrfe-weard      æfter wurde,  
 "lice gelenge.      Ic þās lēode hēold  
 "fiftig wintra:      næs se folc-cyning
- 2735 "ymbe-sittendra      ænig þāra,  
 "þē mec gūð-winum      grētan dorste,  
 "egesan þeon.      Ic on earde bād  
 "mæl-gesceafta,      hēold mīn tela,  
 "ne sōhte searo-nīðas,      nē mē swōr fela
- 2740 "āða on unriht.      Ic þæs ealles mæg,  
 "feorh-bennum sēoc,      gefēan habban:  
 "forþām mē wītan ne þearf      waldend fīra  
 "morðor-bealo māga,      þonne mīn sceaceð  
 "līf of līce.      Nū þū lungre
- 2745 "geong, hord scēawian      under hārne stān,  
 "Wīglāf lēofa,      nū se wyrm ligeð,  
 "swefeð sāre wund,      since berēafod.  
 "Bīo nū on ofoste,      þæt ic ær-welan,  
 "gold-æht ongite,      gearo scēawige
- 2750 "swegle searo-gimmas,      þæt ic þy sēft mæge  
 "æfter māððum-welan      mīn ālāetan  
 "līf and lēod-scipe,      þone ic longe hēold."

# The Jewel-Hoard. the Passing of Beowulf

Fit XXXVIII

Þā ic snūde gefrægn      sunu Wīlstānes  
æfter word-cwydum      wundum dryhtne  
2755 hȳran heaðo-sīocum,      hring-net beran,  
brogdne beadu-sercean      under beorges hrōf.  
Geseah þā sige-hrēðig,      þā hē bī sesse gēong,  
mago-þegn mōdig      māððum-sigla fela,  
gold glitinian      grunde getenge,  
2760 wundur on wealle      and þæs wyrmes denn,  
ealdes ūht-flogan,      orcas stondan,  
fyrn-manna fatu      feormend-lēase,  
hyrstum behrorene:      þær wæs helm monig,  
eald and ōmig,      earm-bēaga fela,  
2765 searwum gesæled.      Sinc ēaðe mæg,  
gold on grunde,      gumena cynnes  
gehwone ofer-hīgian,      hȳde sē þe wylle!  
Swylce hē siomian geseah      segn eall-gylden  
hēah ofer horde,      hond-wundra mæst,  
2770 gelocen leoðo-cræftum:      of þām lēoma stōd,  
þæt hē þone grund-wong      ongitan meahte,  
wræte giond-wlītan.      Næs þæs wyrmes þær  
onsȳn ænig,      ac hyne ecg fornam.  
Þā ic on hlāewe      gefrægn hord rēafian,  
2775 eald enta geweorc      ānne mannan,  
him on bearm hladan      bunan and discas  
sylfes dōme,      segn ēac genom,

- bēacna beorhtost; bill ær-gescōd  
 (ecg wæs īren) eald-hlāfordes  
 2780 þām þāra mǣðma mund-bora wæs  
 longe hwīle, līg-egesan wæg  
 hātne for horde, hioro-weallende,  
 middel-nihtum, oð þæt hē morðre swealt.  
 Ār wæs on ofoste eft-sīðes georn,  
 2785 frætsum gefyrðred: hyne fyrwet bræc,  
 hwæðer collen-ferð cwicne gemette  
 in þām wong-stede Wedra þēoden,  
 ellen-sīocne, þær hē hine ær forlēt.  
 Hē þā mid þām mǣðmum mārne þīoden,  
 2790 dryhten sīnne drīorigne fand  
 ealdres æt ende: hē hine eft ongon  
 wæteres weorpan, oð þæt wordes ord  
 brēost-hord þurhbræc. Bēowulf mǣdelode,  
 gomel on gιοhðe (gold scēawode):  
 2795 "Ic þāra frætwa frēan ealles þanc  
 "wuldur-cyninge wordum secge,  
 "ēcum dryhtne, þē ic hēr on starie,  
 "þæs þe ic mōste mīnum lēodum  
 "ær swylt-dæge swylc gestrȳnan.  
 2800 "Nū ic on mǣðma hord mīne bebohte  
 "frōde feorh-lege, fremmað gē nū  
 "lēoda þearfe; ne mæg ic hēr leng wesan.  
 "Hātað heaðo-mære hlāw gewyrcean,  
 "beorhtne æfter bæle æt brimes nosan;  
 2805 "se scel tō gemyndum mīnum lēodum  
 "hēah hlīfian on Hrones næsse,  
 "þæt hit sǣ-līðend syððan hātan  
 "Bīowulfes biorh, þā þe brentingas  
 "ofer flōda genipu feorran drifað."  
 2810 Dyde him of healse hring gyldenne  
 þīoden þrīst-hȳdig, þegne gesealde,  
 geongum gār-wigan, gold-fāhne helm,  
 bēah and byrnan, hēt hyne brūcan well:  
 "Pū eart ende-lāf ūsses cynnes,  
 2815 "Wægmundinga; ealle Wȳrd forswēof,  
 "mīne māgas tō metod-sceafte,

“eorlas on elne:      ic him æfter sceal.”  
Þæt wæs þām gomelan      gingeste word  
brēost-gehygdum,      ær hē bæl cure,  
2820 hāte heaðo-wylmas:      him of hreðre gewāt  
sāwol sēcean      sōð-fæstra dōm.

# The Coward-Thanes

Fit XXXIX

- Pā wæs gegongen    guman unfrōdum  
earfoðlice,    þæt hē on eorðan geseah  
þone lēofestan    līfes æt ende  
2825 blēate gebāran.    Bona swylce læg,  
egeslic eorð-draca,    ealdre berēafod,  
bealwe gebæded:    bēah-hordum leng  
wyrn wōh-bogen    wealdan ne mōste,  
ac him irenna    ecga fornāmon,  
2830 hearde heaðo-scearpe    homera lāfe,  
þæt se wīd-floga    wundum stille  
hrēas on hrūsan    hord-ærne nēah,  
nalles æfter lyfte    lācende hwearf  
middel-nihtum,    mǣðm-æhta wlonc  
2835 ansyn ywde:    ac hē eorðan gefēoll  
for þæs hild-fruman    hond-geweorce.  
Hūru þæt on lande    lýt manna þāh  
mægen-āgendra    mīne gefræge,  
þēah þe hē dæda gehwæs    dystig wære,  
2840 þæt hē wið attor-sceaðan    oreðe geræsde,  
oððe hring-sele    hondum styrede,  
gif hē wæccende    weard onfunde  
būan on beorge.    Bīowulfe wearð  
dryht-mǣðma dæl    dēaðe forgolden;  
2845 hæfde æghwæðer    ende gefēred  
lāenan līfes.    Næs þā lang tō þon,  
þæt þā hild-latan    holt ofgēfan,  
týdre trēow-logan    týne ætsomne,  
þā ne dorston ær    dareðum lācan

- 2850 on hyra man-dryhtnes    miclan þearfe;  
 ac hȳ scamende    scyldas bāeran,  
 gūð-gewædu,    þær se gomela læg:  
 wlitan on Wīglāf.    Hē gewērgad sæt,  
 fēðe-cempa    frēan eaxlum nēah,  
 2855 wehte hyne wætre;    him wiht ne spēow;  
 ne meahte hē on eorðan,    þēah hē ūðe wēl,  
 on þām frum-gāre    feorh gehealdan,  
 nē þæs wealdendes willan    wiht oncirran;  
 wolde dōm godes    dædum rædan  
 2860 gumena gehwylcum,    swā hē nū gēn dēð.  
 Þā wæs æt þām geongan    grim andswaru  
 ēð-begēte þām þe ær    his elne forlēas.  
 Wīglāf maðelode,    Wēohstānes sunu,  
 secg sārīg-ferð    seah on unlēofe:  
 2865 "Þæt lā mæg secgan,    sē þe wyle sōð sprecan,  
 "þæt se mon-dryhten,    se ēow þā māðmas geaf,  
 "ēored-geatwe,    þē gē þær on standað,  
 "þonne hē on ealu-bence    oft gesealde  
 "heal-sittendum    helm and byrnan,  
 2870 "þēoden his þegnum,    swylce hē þrȳðlicost  
 "ōhwær feor oððe nēah    findan meahte,  
 "þæt hē gēnunga    gūð-gewædu  
 "wrāðe forwurpe.    Þā hyne wīg beget,  
 "nealles folc-cyning    fyrd-gesteallum  
 2875 "gylpan þorfte;    hwæðre him god ūðe,  
 "sigora waldend,    þæt hē hyne sylfne gewræc  
 "āna mid ecge,    þā him wæs elnes þearf,  
 "Ic him lif-wraðe    lȳtle meahte  
 "ætgifan æt gūðe    and ongan swā þēah  
 2880 "ofer mīn gemet    mæges helpa:  
 "symle wæs þȳ sāmra,    þonne ic sweorde drep  
 "ferð-genīðlan,    fȳr unswīðor  
 "wēoll of gewitte.    Wergendra tō lȳt  
 "þrong ymbe þēoden,    þā hyne sīo þrāg becwōm.  
 2885 "Nū sceal sinc-þego    and swyrd-gifu  
 "eall ēðel-wyn    ēowrum cynne,  
 "lufen ālicgean:    lond-rihtes mōt  
 "þære mæg-burge    monna æghwylc

"īdel hweorfan,      syððan æðelingas  
2890 "feorran gefricgean      flēam ēowerne,  
"dōm-lēasan dæd.      Dēað bið sēlla  
"eorla gehwylcum      þonne edwīt-līf!"

# The Soldier's Dirge and Prophecy

Fit XL

Heht þā þæt heaðo-weorc    tō hagan bīodan  
up ofer ēg-clif,    þær þæt eorl-weorod  
2895 morgen-longne dæg    mōd-giōmor sæt,  
bord-hæbbende,    bēga on wēnum  
ende-dōgores    and eft-cymes  
lēofes monnes.    Lȳt swīgode  
nīwra spella,    sē þe næs gerād,  
2900 ac hē sōðlice    sægde ofer ealle;  
"Nū is wil-geofa    Wedra lēoda,  
"dryhten Gēata    dēað-bedde fæst,  
"wunað wæl-reste    wyrmes dædum;  
"him on efn ligeð    ealdor-gewinna,  
2905 "siex-bennum sēoc:    sweorde ne meahte  
"on þām āglæcean    ænige þinga  
"wunde gewyrcean.    Wīglāf siteð  
"ofer Bīowulfe,    byre Wīhstānes,  
"eorl ofer ōðrum    unlifigendum,  
2910 "healdeð hige-mēðum    hēafod-wearde  
"lēofes and lāðes.    Nū ys lēodum wēn  
"orleg-hwīle,    syððan underne  
"Froncum and Frȳsum    fyll cyninges  
"wīde weorðeð.    Wæs sīo wrōht scepen  
2915 "heard wið Hūgas,    syððan Higelāc cwōm  
"faran flot-herge    on Frēsna land,  
"þær hyne Hetware    hilde gehnægdon,



- "elne geēodon      mid ofer-mægene,  
 "þæt se byrn-wiga      būgan sceolde,  
 2920 "fēoll on fēðan:      nalles frætwe geaf  
 "ealdor dugoðe;      ūs wæs ā syððan  
 "Merewīoinga      milts ungyfeðe.  
 "Nē ic tō Swēo-þēode      sibbe oððe trēowe  
 "wihte ne wēne;      ac wæs wīde cūð,  
 2925 "þætte Ongenþīo      ealdre besnyðede  
 "Hæðcyn Hrēðling      wið Hrefna-wudu,  
 "þā for on-mēðlan      ærest gesōhton  
 "Gēata lēode      Gūð-scilfingas.  
 "Sōna him se frōda      fæder Ōhtheres,  
 2930 "eald and eges-full      ond-slyht āgeaf,  
 "ābrēot brim-wīsan,      brȳd āhēorde,  
 "gomela īo-meowlan      golde berofene,  
 "Onelan mōdor      and Ōhtheres,  
 "and þā folgode      feorh-genīðlan  
 2935 "oð þæt hī oðēodon      earfoðlice  
 "in Hrefnes-holt      hlāford-lēase.  
 "Besæt þā sin-herge      sweorda lāfe  
 "wundum wērges,      wēan oft gehēt  
 "earmre teohhe      andlonge niht:  
 2940 "cwæð hē on mergenne      mēces ecgum  
 "gētan wolde,      sume on galg-trēowum  
 "fuglum tō gamene.      Frōfor eft gelamp  
 "sārig-mōdum      somod ær-dæge,  
 "syððan hīe Hygelāces      horn and bȳman  
 2945 "gealdor ongeāton.      Þā se gōða cōm  
 "lēoda dugoðe      on lāst faran.

# He Tells of the Swedes and the Geatas

## Fit XLI

- "Wæs sīo swāt-swaðu    Swēona and Gēata,  
"wæl-ræs wera    wīde gesȳne,  
"hū þā folc mid him    fæhðe tōwehton.  
2950 "Gewāt him þā se gōda    mid his gædelingum,  
"frōd fela geōmor    fæsten sēcean,  
"eorl Ongenþīo    ufor oncirde;  
"hæfde Higelāces    hilde gefrūnen,  
"wlonces wīg-cræft,    wiðres ne truwode,  
2955 "þæt hē sǣ-mannum    onsacan mihte,  
"hēaðo-liðendum    hord forstandan,  
"bearn and brýde;    bēah eft þonan  
"eald under eorð-weall.    Þā wæs æht boden  
"Swēona lēodum,    segn Higelāce.  
2960 "Freoðo-wong þone    forð oferēodon,  
"syððan Hrēðlingas    tō hagan þrungon.  
"Þær wearð Ongenþīo    ecgum sweorda,  
"blonden-fexa    on bīd wrecen,  
"þæt se þēod-cyning    þafian sceolde  
2965 "Eofores ānne dōm:    hyne yrringa  
"Wulf Wonrēding    wǣpne gerǣhte,  
"þæt him for swenge    swāt æðdrum sprong  
"forð under fexe.    Næs hē forht swā þēh,  
"gomela Scilfing,    ac forgeald hraðe  
2970 "wyrsan wrixle    wæl-hlem þone,  
"syððan þēod-cyning    þyder oncirde:

- "ne meahte se snella      sunu Wonrēdes  
 "ealdum ceorle      ond-slyht giofan,  
 "ac hē him on hēafde      helm ær gescer,  
 2975 "þæt hē blōde fāh      būgan sceolde,  
 "fēoll on foldan;      næs hē fæge þā gīt,  
 "ac hē hyne gewyrpte,      þēah þe him wund hrīne,  
 "Lēt se hearda      Higelāces þegn  
 "brādne mēce,      þā his brōðor læg,  
 2980 "eald sweord eotonisc,      entiscne helm,  
 "brecan ofer bord-weal:      þā gebēah cyning,  
 "folces hyrde,      wæs in feorh dropen.  
 "Þā wæron monige,      þē his mæg wriðon,  
 "ricone ārærdon,      þā him gerȳmed wearð,  
 2985 "þæt hīe wæl-stōwe      wealdan mōston.  
 "Þenden rēafode      rinc oðerne,  
 "nam on Ongenþīo      īren-byrnan,  
 "heard swyrd hilted      and his helm somod;  
 "hāres hyrste      Higelāce bær.  
 2990 "Hē þām frætsum fēng      and him fægre gehēt  
 "lēana fore lēodum      and gelæste swā:  
 "geald þone gūð-ræs      Gēata dryhten,  
 "Hrēðles eafora,      þā hē tō hām becōm,  
 "Jofore and Wulfe      mid ofer-māðmum,  
 2995 "sealde hiora gehwæðrum      hund þūsenda  
 "landes and locenra bēaga;      ne þorfte him þā lēan oðwītan  
 "mon on middan-gearde,      syððan hīe þā mæra geslōgon;  
 "and þā Jofore forgeaf      āngan dōhtor,  
 "hām-weorðunge,      hylde tō wedde.  
 3000 "Þæt ys sīo fāhðo      and se fēond-scipe,  
 "wæl-nīð wera,      þæs þe ic wēn hafo,  
 "þē ūs sēceað tō      Swēona lēode,  
 "syððan hīe gefricgeað      frēan ūserne  
 "ealdor-lēasne,      þone þe ær gehēold  
 3005 "wið hettendum      hord and rice,  
 "æfter hāleða hryre      hwate Scylfingas,  
 "folc-ræd fremede      oððe furður gēn  
 "eorl-scipe efnde.      Nū is ofost betost,  
 "þæt wē þēod-cyning      þær scēawian  
 3010 "and þone gebringan,      þē ūs bēagas geaf,

- "on ād-fære. Ne scel ānes hwæt  
 "meltan mid þām mōdigan, ac þær is māðma hord.  
 "gold unrīme grimme gecēapod  
 "and nū æt sīðestan sylfes fēore  
 3015 "bēagas gebohte; þā sceal brond fretan,  
 "æled þeccean, nalles eorl wegan  
 "māððum tō gemyndum, nē mægð scýne  
 "habban on healse hring-weorðunge,  
 "ac sceall geōmor-mōd golde berēafod  
 3020 "oft nalles æne el-land tredan,  
 "nū se here-wīsa hleahtor ālegde,  
 "gamen and glēo-drēam. Forþon sceall gār wesan  
 "monig morgen-ceald mundum bewunden,  
 "hæfen on handa, nalles hearpan swēg  
 3025 "wīgend wecccean, ac se wonna hrefn  
 "fūs ofer fægum, fela reordian,  
 "earne secgan, hū him æt æte spēow,  
 "þenden hē wið wulf wæl rēafode."  
 Swā se secg hwata secgende wæs  
 3030 lāðra spella; hē ne lēag fela  
 wyrda nē worda. Weorod eall ārās,  
 ēodon unblīðe under Earna næs  
 wollen-tēare wundur scēawian.  
 Fundon þā on sande sāwul-lēasne  
 3035 hlim-bed healdan, þone þe him hringas geaf  
 ærran mælum: þā wæs ende-dæg  
 gōdum gegongen, þæt se gūð-cyning,  
 Wedra þēoden, wundor-dēaðe swealt.  
 Ær hī gesēgan syllicran wiht,  
 3040 wyrm on wonge wiðer-ræhtes þær  
 lāðne licgean: wæs se lēg-draca,  
 grimlic gryre-gæst, glēdum beswæled,  
 sē wæs fiftiges fōt-gemearces.  
 lang on legere, lyft-wynne hēold  
 3045 nihtes hwīlum, nyðer eft gewāt  
 dennes nīosian; wæs þā dēaðe fæst,  
 hæfde eorð-scrafa ende genyttod.  
 Him big stōdan bunan and orcas,  
 discas lāgon and dýre swyrd,

- 3050 ðmige þurh-etone,      swā hīe wið eorðan fæðm  
    þūsend wintra      þær eardodon:  
    þonne wæs þæt yrfe      ēacen-cræftig,  
    iū-monna gold      galdre bewunden,  
    þæt þām hring-sele      hrīnan ne mōste  
3055 gumena ænig,      nefne god sylfa,  
    sigora sōð-cyning,      sealde þām þe hē wolde  
    (hē is manna gehyld)      hord openian,  
    efne swā hwylcum manna,      swā him gemet þūhte.

# Wīglaf Speaks. the Building of the Bale-Fire

Fit XLII

- 3060      Þā wæs gesȳne,      þæt se sīð ne þāh  
         þām þe unrihte      inne gehȳdde  
         wræte under wealle.      Weard ær ofslōh  
         fēara sumne;      þā sīo fāhð gewearð  
         gewrecen wrāðlice.      Wundur hwār, þonne  
         eorl ellen-rōf      ende gefēre  
3065      līf-gesceafta,      þonne leng ne mæg  
         mon mid his māgum      medu-seld būan.  
         Swā wæs Bīowulfe,      þā hē biorges weard  
         sōhte, searo-nīðas:      seolfa ne cūðe,  
         þurh hwæt his worulde gedāl      weorðan sceolde;  
3070      swā hit oð dōmes dæg      dīope benemdon  
         þēodnas mære,      þā þæt þær dydon,  
         þæt se secg wære      synnum scildig,  
         hergum geheaðerod,      hell-bendum fæst,  
         wommum gewītnad,      sē þone wong strāde.  
3075      Næs hē gold-hwæt:      gearwor hæfde  
         āgendes ēst      ær gescēawod.  
         Wīglāf maðelode,      Wīhstānes sunu:  
         "Oft sceall eorl monig      ānes willan  
         "wræc ādrēogan,      swā ūs geworden is.  
3080      "Ne meahton wē gelæran      lēofne þēoden,  
         "rīces hyrde      ræd ænigne,  
         "þæt hē ne grētte      gold-weard þone,  
         "lēte hyne licgean,      þær hē longe wæs,

- "wīcum wunian    oð woruld-ende.  
 3085 "Hēoldon hēah gesceap:    hord ys gescēawod,  
 "grimme gegongen;    wæs þæt gifeðe tō swīð,  
 "þē þone þēoden    þyder ontyhte.  
 "Ic wæs þær inne    and þæt eall geond-seh,  
 "recedes geatwa,    þā mē gerȳmed wæs,  
 3090 "nealles swæslice    sið ālȳfed  
 "inn under eorð-weall.    Ic on ofoste gefēng  
 "micle mid mundum    mægen-byrðenne  
 "hord-gestrēona,    hider ūt ætbær  
 "cyninge mīnum:    cwico wæs þā gēna,  
 3095 "wīs and gewittig;    worn eall gespræc  
 "gomol on gehðo    and ēowic grētan hēt,  
 "bæd þæt gē geworhton    æfter wines dædum  
 "in bæl-stede    beorh þone hēan  
 "micelne and mærne,    swā hē manna wæs  
 3100 "wīgend weorð-fullost    wīde geond eorðan,  
 "þenden hē burh-welan    brūcan mōste.  
 "Uton nū efstan    oðre siðe  
 "sēon and sēcean    searo-geþræc,  
 "wundur under wealle!    ic ēow wīsigē,  
 3105 "þæt gē genōge    nēan scēawiað  
 "bēagas and brād gold.    Sīe sīo bær gearo  
 "ædre geæfned,    þonne wē ūt cymen,  
 "and þonne geferian    frēan ūserne,  
 "lēofne mannan,    þær hē longe sceal  
 3110 "on þæs waldendes    wære geþolian."  
 Hēt þā gebēodan    byre Wīhstānes,  
 hæle hilde-dīor,    hæleða monegum  
 bold-āgendra,    þæt hīe bæl-wudu  
 feorran feredon,    folc-āgende  
 3115 gōdum tōgēnes:    "Nū sceal glēd fretan  
 "(weaxan wonna lēg)    wigena strengel,  
 "þone þe oft gebād    īsern-scūre,  
 "þonne stræla storm,    strengum gebæded,  
 "scōc ofer scild-weall,    sceft nytte hēold,  
 3120 "feðer-gearwum fūs    flāne full-ēode."  
 Hūru se snotra    sunu Wīhstānes  
 ācīgde of corðre    cyninges þegnæs

- syfone tōsomne      þā sēlestan,  
 ēode eahta sum      under inwit-hrōf;  
 3125 hilde-rinc sum      on handa bær  
 æled-lēoman,      sē þe on orde gēong.  
 Næs þā on hlytme,      hwā þæt hord strude,  
 syððan or-wearde      ænigne dæl  
 secgas gesēgon      on sele wunian,  
 3130 lāne licgan:      lýt ænig mearn,  
 þæt hī ofostlice      ūt geferedon  
 dýre mǣðmas;      dracan ēc scufun,  
 wýrm ofer weall-clif,      lēton wæg niman,  
 flōd fæðmian      frætwa hyrde.  
 3135 Þær wæs wunden gold      on wæn hladen,  
 æghwæs unrīm,      æðeling boren,  
 hār hilde-rinc      tō Hrones næsse.



# Bēowulf's Funeral Pyre

## Fit XLIII

- Him þā gegiredan    Gēata lēode  
āð on eorðan    un-wāclīcne,  
3140 helmum behongen,    hilde-bordum,  
    beorhtum byrnum,    swā hē bēna wæs;  
    ālegdon þā tō-middes    mǣrne þēoden  
    hæleð hīofende,    hlāford lēofne.  
    Ongunnon þā on beorge    bæl-fȳra mǣst  
3145 wīgend weccan:    wudu-rēc āstāh  
    sweart ofer swioðole,    swōgende lēg,  
    wōpe bewunden    (wind-blond gelæg)  
    oð þæt hē þā bān-hūs    gebrocen hæfde,  
    hāt on hreðre.    Higum unrōte  
3150 mōd-ceare mǣndon    mon-dryhtnes cwealm;  
    swylce giōmor-gyd    lat . con meowle  
    . . . . . wunden heorde . . .  
    serg (?) cearig sælde    geneahhe  
    þæt hīo hyre . . . . gas hearde  
3155 . . . . . ede    wælfylla wonn . .  
    hildes egesan    hyðo  
    haf mid    heofon rēce swealh (?)  
    Geworhton þā    Wedra lēode  
    hlāw on hlīðe,    sē wæs hēah and brād,  
3160 wæg-līðendum    wīde gesȳne,  
    and betimbredon    on tȳn dagum  
    beadu-rōfes bēcn:    bronda betost  
    wealle beworhton,    swā hyt weorðlicost  
    fore-snotre men    findan mihton.

- 3165 Hī on beorg dydon      bēg and siglu,  
      eall swylce hyrsta,      swylce on horde ær  
      nīð-hȳdige men      genumen hæfdon;  
      forlēton eorla gestreōn      eorðan healdan,  
      gold on grēote,      þær hit nū gēn lifað  
 3170 eldum swā unnyt,      swā hit æror wæs.  
      Þā ymbe hlæw riodan      hilde-dēore,  
      æðelinga bearn      ealra twelfa,  
      woldon ceare cwīðan,      kyning mænan,  
      word-gyd wrecan      and ymb wer sprecan,  
 3175 eahtodan eorl-scipe      and his ellen-weorc  
      duguðum dēmdon,      swā hit ge-dēfe bið,  
      þæt mon his wine-dryhten      wordum herge,  
      ferhðum frēoge,      þonne hē forð scile  
      of līc-haman      lāne weorðan.  
 3180 Swā begnornodon      Gēata lēode  
      hlāfordes hryre,      heorð-genēatas,  
      cwædon þæt hē wære      woruld-cyning  
      mannum mildust      and mon-þwærust,  
      lēodum līðost      and lof-geornost.

# The Fight at Finnsburg

## Appendix

- “ . . . . . næs byrnað næfre.”  
Hleoðrode þā heaðo-geong cyning:  
“Ne þis ne dagað ēastan, ne hēr draca ne flēogeð,  
“ne hēr þisse healle hornas ne byrnað,  
5 “ac fēr forð berað fugelas singað,  
“gylleð græg-hama, gūð-wudu hlynneð,  
“scyld scefte oncwýð. Nū scýneð þes mōna  
“waðol under wolcnum; nū ārišað wēa-dæda,  
“þē þisne folces nīð fremman willað.  
10 “Ac onwacnigeað nū, wīgend mīne,  
“hebbað ēowre handa, hicgeað on ellen,  
“winnað on orde, wesað on mōde!”  
þā ārās monig gold-hladen þegn, gyrde hine his swurde;  
þā tō dura ēodon drihtlice ceman,  
15 Sigeferð and Eaha, hyra sweord getugon,  
and æt oðrum durum Ordlāf and Gūðlāf,  
and Hengest sylf; hwearf him on lāste.  
þā gīt Gārulf Gūðere styrode,  
þæt hīe swā frēolic feorh forman sīðe  
20 tō þære healle durum hyrsta ne bēran,  
nū hyt nīða heard ānyman wolde:  
ac hē frægn ofer eal undearninga,  
dēor-mōd hæleð, hwā þā duru hēolde.  
“Sigeferð is mīn nama (cwæð hē), ic eom Secgena lēod,  
25 “wrecca wīde cūð. Fela ic wēana gebād,  
“heardra hilda; þē is gýt hēr witod,  
“swæðer þū sylf tō mē sēcean wylle.”

- Ðā wæs on wealle      wæl-slihta gehlyn,  
 sceolde cēlod bord      cēnum on handa  
 30 bān-helm berstan.      Buruh-þelu dynede,  
 oð þæt æt þære gūðe      Gārulf gecrang,  
 ealra ærest      eorð-būendra,  
 Gūðlāfes sunu;      ymbe hine gōdra fela.  
 Hwearf flacra hræw      hræfn, wandrode  
 35 sweart and sealo-brūn;      swurd-lēoma stōd  
 swylce eal Finns-buruh      fýrenu wære.  
 Ne gefrægn ic næfre wurðlicor      æt wera hilde  
 sixtig sige-beorna      sēl gebæran,  
 ne næfre swānas swētne      medo sēl forgyldan,  
 40 þonne Hnæfe guldon      his hæg-stealdas.  
 Hig fuhton fíf dagas,      swā hyra nān ne fēol  
 driht-gesīða,      ac hig þā duru hēoldon.  
 Ðā gewāt him wund hæleð      on wæg gangan,  
 sæde þæt his byrne      ābrocen wære,  
 45 here-sceorpum hrōr,      and ēac wæs his helm þyrl.  
 Ðā hine sōna frægn      folces hyrde,  
 hū þā wīgend      hyra wunda genæson  
 oððe hwæðer þæra hyssa . . . . .

# The Old English Physiologus: The Panther

Original Old English Poem

Monge sindon      geond middangeard  
unrīmu cynn,      [pāra] þe wē æþelu ne magon  
ryhte āreccan      nē rīm witan;  
þæs wīde sind      geond wor[u]l[d] innan  
5 fugla and dēora      foldhrērendra  
wornas widsceope,      swā wæter bibūgeð  
þisne beorhtan bōsm,      brim grymetende,  
sealtȳpa geswing.  
Wē bi sumum hȳrdon  
wrætlīc[um] gecynd[e]      wildra secgan,  
10 fīrum frēamærne,      feorlondum on,  
eard weardian,      ēðles nēotan,  
æfter dūnscefum.      Is þæt dēor Pandher  
bi noman hāten,      þæs þe niþpa bear[n],  
wīsfæste weras,      on gewritum cȳpa[ð]  
15 bi þām ānstapan.  
Sē is æ[g]hwām frēond,  
duguða ēstig,      būtan dracan ānum;  
þām hē in ealle tīd      andwrāð leofaþ,  
þurh yfla gehwylc      þe hē geæfnan mæg.  
Ðæt is wrætlīc dēor,      wundrum scȳne,

- 20 hīwa gehwylces. Swā hæleð secgað,  
 gæsthālge guman, þætte Iōsēphes  
 tunece wære telga gehwylces  
 blēom bregdende, þāra beorhtra gehwylc,  
 æghwæs ænlicra, oþrum līxte  
 25 dryhta bearnum, swā þæs dēores hīw,  
 blæc, brigda gehwæs, beorhtra and scýnra  
 wundrum līxeð, þætte wrætlicra  
 æghwylc oþrum, ænlicra gīen  
 and fægerra, frætwum blīceð,  
 30 symle sellicra.  
 Hē hafað sundorgecynd,  
 milde, gemetfæst. Hē is monþwære,  
 lufsum and lēoftæl: nele lāþes wiht  
 æ[ng]um geæfnan būtan þām āttorsceaþan,  
 his fyrngeflitan, þe ic ær fore sægde.  
 35 Symle, fylle fægen, þonne fōddor þigeð,  
 æfter þām gereordum ræste sēceð,  
 dýgle stōwe under dūnscafum;  
 ðær se þeo[d]wiga þrēonihta fæc  
 swifeð on swe[o]fote, slæpe gebiesga[d].  
 40 Þonne ellenrōf ūp āstondeð,  
 þrymme gewelga[d], on þone þridan dæg,  
 snēome of slæpe. Swēghlēoþor cymeð,  
 wōþa wynsumast, þurh þæs wildres mūd;  
 æfter pære stefne stenc ūt cymeð  
 45 of þām wongstede— wynsumra stēam,  
 swētttra and swīþra, swæcca gehwylcum,  
 wyrta blōstmum and wudublēdum,  
 eallum æpelicra eorþan frætw[um].  
 Þonne of ceastrum and cynestōlum  
 50 and of burgsalum beornþrēat monig

- farað foldwegum    folca þrȳþum;  
 ēoredcystum,    ofestum gefȳsde,  
 dareðlācende    –dēor [s]wā some–  
 æfter þære stefne    on þone stenc farað.
- 55 Swā is Dryhten God,    drēama Rædend,  
 eallum ēaðmēde    ōþrum gesceaftum,  
 duguða gehwylcre,    būtan dracan ānum,  
 āttres ordfruman–    þæt is se ealda fēond  
 þone hē gesælde    in sūsla grund,
- 60 and gefetrade    fȳrnum tēagum,  
 biþeahte þrēanȳdum;    and þȳ þridan dæge  
 of dīgle ārās,    þæs þe hē dēað fore ūs  
 þrēo niht þolade,    þēoden engla,  
 sigora Sellend.    Þæt wæs swēte stenc,
- 65 wlitig and wynsum,    geond woruld ealle.  
 Siþþan tō þām swicce    sōðfæste men,  
 on healfa gehwone,    hēapum þrungon  
 geond ealne ymbhwyrft    eorþan scēat[a].  
 Swā se snottra gecwæð    Sanctus Paulus:
- 70 'Monigfealde sind    geond middangeard  
 gōd ungnȳðe    þe ūs tō giefе dæleð  
 and tō feorhnere    Fæder ælmihtig,  
 and se ānga Hyht    ealra gesceafta  
 uppe ge niþre.'    Þæt is æþele stenc.

# The Old English Physiologus: The Whale (Asp-Turtle)

Original Old English Poem

- Nū ic fitte gēn    ymb fisca cynn  
wille wōðcræfte    wordum cȳpan  
þurh mōdgemynd,    bi þām miclan hwale.  
Sē bið unwillum    oft gemēted,  
5 frēcne and fer[h]ōgrim,    fareðlācendum,  
niþþa gehwylcum;    þām is noma cenned,  
fyr[ge]nstrēama geflotan,    Fastitocalon.  
Is þæs hīw gelīc    hrēofum stāne,  
swylce wōrie    bi wædes ofre,  
10 sondbeorgum ymbseald,    sǣrȳrica mǣst,  
swā þæt wēnaþ    wægliþende  
þæt hȳ on ēalond sum    ēagum wliten;  
and þonne gehȳd[i]að    hēahstefn scipu  
tō þām unlonde    oncyrrāpum,  
15 s[ǣ]laþ sǣmearas    sundes æt ende,  
and þonne in þæt ēglond    ūp gewītað  
collenfer[h]pe;    cēolas stondað  
bi staþe fæste    strēame biwunden.  
Ðonne gewīciað    wērigfer[h]ðe,



- 20 faroðlācende, frēcnes ne wēnað.  
 On þām ēalonde æled weccað,  
 hēah fyr ælað. Hæleþ bēoþ on wynnum,  
 rēonigmōde, ræste gel[y]ste.  
 Ponne gefēleð fācnes cræftig  
 25 þæt him þā fērend on fæste wuniaþ,  
 wīc weardiað, wedres on luste,  
 ðonne semninga on sealtne wæg  
 mid þā nōþe niþer gewīteþ,  
 gārsecges gæst, grund gesēceð,  
 30 and þonne in dēaðsele drence bifæsteð  
 scipu mid scealcum.  
 Swā bið scinn[en]a þēaw,  
 dēofla wīse, þæt hī droht[i]ende  
 þurh dyrne meahht duguðe beswīcað,  
 and on teosu tyhtaþ tilra dæda,  
 35 wēmað on willan, þæt hī wraþe sēcen,  
 frōfre tō fēondum, oþþæt hy fæste ðær  
 æt þām wærlogan wīc gecēosað.  
 Ponne þæt gecnāweð of cwicsūsle  
 flāh fēond gemāh, þætte fīra gehwylc  
 40 hæleþa cynnes on his hringe biþ  
 fæste gefēged, hē him feorgbona,  
 þurh slīpen searo, siþþan weorþeð,  
 wloncum and hēanum þe his willan hēr  
 firenum fremmað; mid þām hē fāringa,  
 45 heolophelme biþeaht, helle sēceð,  
 gōða gēasne, grundlēasne wylm  
 under mistglōme, swā se micla hwæl  
 se þe bisenceð sālīpende  
 eorlas and yðmearas.  
 Hē hafað oþre gecynd,

- 50 wæterþisa wlonc,      wrætlicran gien.  
     Þonne hine on holme      hunger bysgað,  
 and þone āglæcan      ætes lystþ,  
     ðonne se merewearð      mūð ontýneð,  
     wīde weleras;      cymeð wynsum stenc  
 55 of his innoþe,      þætte oþre þurh þone,  
     sǣfisca cynn,      beswicen weorðap.  
     Swimmað sundhwate      þær se swēta stenc  
     ūt gewīt[e]ð.      Hī þær in farað,  
     unware weorude,      oþþæt se wīda ceaf  
 60 gefylled bið;      þonne færinga  
     ymbe þā herehūpe      hlemmeð tōgædre  
     grimme gōman.  
     Swā biþ gumena gehwām  
     se þe oftost his      unwærlice,  
     on þās lænan tid,      lif biscēawað:  
 65 læteð hine beswīcan      þurh swētnes stenc,  
     lēasne willan,      þæt hē biþ leahtrum fāh  
     wið Wuldorcýning.      Him se āwyrġda ongēan  
     æfter hinsīpe      helle ontýneð,  
     þām þe lēaslice      lices wynne  
 70 ofer ferh[ð]gereiht      fremedon on unræd.  
     Þonne se fæcna      in þām fæstenne  
     gebrōht hafað,      bealwes cræftig,  
     æt þām [ā]dwylme,      þā þe him on cleofiað,  
     gyltum gehrodene,      and ær georne his  
 75 in hira lifdagum      lārum hýrdon,  
     þonne he þā grimman      gōman bihlemmeð,  
     æfter feorhcwale,      fæste tōgædre,  
     helle hlinduru.      Nāgon hwyrft nē swice,  
     ūtsīp æfre,      þā [þe] þær in cumað,  
 80 þon mā þe þā fiscas,      faraðlācende,

of þæs hwæles fenge      hweorfan mōtan.

Forþon is ealliga . . . . .

. . . . .

dryhtna Dryhtne, and ā dēoflum wiðsace

85 wordum and weorcum,      þæt wē Wuldorcýning

gesēon mōton.      Uton ā sibbe tō him,

on þās hwīlnan tīd,      hælu sēcan,

þæt wē mid swā lēofne      in lofe mōtan

tō wīdan feore      wuldres nēotan.

# The Old English Physiologus: The Partridge

Original Old English Poem

Hȳrde ic secgan gēn    bi sumum fugle  
wundorlīcne<sup>1</sup> . . . . .

. . . . .

. . . . .

. . . . .

. . . . . fæger

þæt word þe gecwæð    wuldres Ealdor:

5 'In swā hwylce tiid    swā gē mid trēowe tō mē

on hyge hweorfað,    and gē hellfirena

sweartra geswīcað,    swā ic symle tō ēow

mid siblufan    sōna gecyrre

þurh milde mōd;    gē bēoð mē sibþan

10 torhte, tīrēadge,    talade and rīmdē,

beorhte gebrōþor    on bearna stæl.'

Uton wē þȳ geornor    Gode ōliccan,

firene fēogan,    friþes earnian,

duguðe tō Dryhtne,    þenden ūs dæg scīne,

15 þæt swā æþelne    eardwīca cyst

in wuldres wlite    wunian mōtan.

Finit.

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<sup>1</sup>Gap in the manuscript, probably of considerable length.

*Editorial note: The partridge (like the cuckoo) broods the eggs of other birds. When they are hatched and grown, they fly off to their true parents. So men may turn from the devil, who has wrongfully gained possession of them, to their heavenly Father, who will receive them as his children.*

# The Battle of Ashdown

Old English Reader

871. Hêr cuôm sê here tô Rêadingum on Westseaxe, ond þæs ymb iii niht ridon ii eorlas ûp. Þa gemêtte hîe

Æþelwulf aldorman on Englafelda, ond him þær wiþ gefeaht, ond sige nam. Þæs ymb ii niht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur þær micle fierd tô Rêadingum gelæddon, ond wiþ þone here gefuhton; ond þær wæs micel wæl geslægen on gehwæpre hond, ond Æþelwulf aldorman wearþ ofslægen; ond þa Deniscan âhton wælstôwe gewald.

On þæs ymb ii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ alne þone here on Æscesdûne. Ond hîe wærun on twæm gefylcum: on ôþrum wæs Bâchsecg ond Halfdene þa hæþnan cyningas, ond on ôþrum wæron þa eorlas. Ond þa gefeaht sê cyning Æþered wiþ þara cyninga getruman, ond þær wearþ sê cyning Bâgsecg ofslægen; ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ þara eorla getruman, ond þær wearþ Sidroc eorl ofslægen sê alda, ond Sidroc eorl sê gioncga, ond Ôsbearn eorl, ond Fræna eorl, ond Hareld eorl; ond þa hergas bēgen gefliemde, ond fela þûsenda ofslægenra, ond onfeohende wæron oþ niht.

On þæs ymb xiiii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôður wiþ þone here æt Basengum, ond þær þa Deniscan sige nâmon.

On þæs ymb ii mōnaþ gefeaht Æþered cyning ond Ælfred his brôþur wiþ þone here æt Meretûne, ond hîe wærun on tuæm gefylcum, ond hîe bûtû gefliemdon, ond longe on dæg sige âhton; ond þær wearþ micel wælsliht on gehwæpere hond; ond þa Deniscan âhton wælstôwe

gewald; ond þær wearþ Hêahmund bisceop ofslægen, ond fela gôdra monna. Ond æfter þissum gefeohte cuôm micel sumorlida.

Onð þæs ofer Êastron gefôr Æþered cyning; onð hê rîcsode v gêar; onð his lîc lîþ æt Wînburnan.

Þâ fêng Ælfred Æþelwulfing his brôþur tô Wesseaxna rîce. Onð þæs ymb ânne mônað gefeaht Ælfred cyning wiþ alne þone here lȳtle werede æt Wiltûne, onð hine longe on dæg gefliemde, onð þâ Deniscan âhton wælstôwe gewald.

Onð þæs gêares wurdon viiii folcgefeohht gefohten wiþ þone here on þȳ cynerîce be sūþan Temese, bûtan þâm þe him Ælfred þæs cyninges brôþur onð ânlîpig aldormon onð cyninges þegnas oft råde onridon þe mon nâ ne rîmde; onð þæs gêares wærun ofslægene viiii eorlas onð ân cyning. Onð þȳ gêare nâmon Westseaxe friþ wiþ þone here.

# A Prayer of King Alfred

Old English Reader

Dryhten, ælmihtiga God, Wyrhta and Wealdend ealra gesceafta, ic bidde ðê for ðînre miclan mildheortnesse, and for ðære hâlgan rôde tâcne, and for Sanctæ Marian mægðhåde, and for Sancti Michaelles gehîersumnesse, and for ealra ðînra hâlgena lufan and hîera ear-nungum, ðæt ðû mê gewissie bet ðonne ic âworhte tô ðê; and gewissa mê tô ðinum willan, and tô mînre sâwle ðearfe, bet ðonne ic self cunne; and gestaðela mîn môd tô ðinum willan and tô mînre sâwle ðearfe; and gestranga mê wið ðæs dêofles costnungum; and âfierr fram mê ðâ fûlan gâlnesse and ælce unrihtwîsnesse; and gescield mê wið mînum wiðerwinnum, gesewenlîcum and ungesewenlîcum; and tæc mê ðînnne willan tô wyrceanne; ðæt ic mæge ðê inweardlice lufian tôforan eallum ðingum, mid clænum geðance and mid clænum lîchaman. For ðon ðe ðû eart mîn Scieppend, and mîn Alîesend, mîn Fultum, mîn Frôfor, mîn Trêownes, and mîn Tôhopa. Sîe ðê lof and wuldor nû and â â â, tô worulde bûtan æghwîlcum ende. Amen.



# The Voyages of Ohthere and Wulfstan

Old English Reader

## Ohthere's First Voyage

Ôthere sǣde his hlāforde, Ælfrede cyninge, þæt hē ealra Norðmonna norþmest būde. Hē cwæð þæt hē būde on þǣm lande norþweardum wiþ þā Westsæ. Hē sǣde þeah þæt þæt land sīe swīpe lang norþ þonan; ac hit is eal wēste, būton on fēawum stōwum styc-cemælum wīciað Finnas, on huntoðe on wintra, ond on sumera on fiscape be þære sǣ. Hē sǣde þæt hē æt sumum cirre wolde fandian hū longe þæt land norþryhte læge, oþþe hwæðer ænig mon be norðan þǣm wēstenne būde. Þā fōr hē norþryhte be þǣm lande lēt him ealne weg þæt wēste land on ðæt stēorbord, ond þā wīdsǣ on ðæt bæcbord þrīe dagas. Þā wæs hē swā feor norþ swā þā hwælhuntan firrest faraþ. Þā fōr hē þā gīet norþryhte swā feor swā hē meahte on þǣm oþrum þrīm dagum gesiglan. Þā bæag þæt land þær ēastryhte, oþþe sēo sǣ in on ðæt lond, hē nysse hwæðer, būton hē wisse ðæt hē ðær bād westanwindes ond hwōn norþan, ond siglde ðā east be lande swā swā hē meahte on fēower dagum gesiglan. Þā sceolde hē ðær bīdan ryhtnorþanwindes, for ðæm þæt land bæag þær sūþryhte, oþþe sēo sǣ in on ðæt land, hē nysse hwæper. Þā siglde hē þonan sūðryhte be lande

swā swā hē mehte on fīf dagum gesiglan. Ðā læg þær ān micel ēa ūp in on þæt land. Þā cirdon hīe ūp in on ðā ēa, for þǣm hīe ne dorston forþ bī þære ēa siglan for unfriþe; for þǣm ðæt land wæs eall gebūn on oþre healfe þære ēas. Ne mētte hē ær nān gebūn land, siþþan hē from his āgnum hām fōr; ac him wæs ealne weg wēste land

on þæt stēorbord, būtan fiscerum ond fugelerum ônd huntum, ond þæt wæron eall Finnas; ond him wæs â wīdsæ on ðæt bæcbord. Þā Beormas hæfdon swīpe wel gebūð hira land: ac hīe ne dorston þær on cuman. Ac þāra Terfinna land wæs eal wēste, būton ðær huntan gewīcodon, oþpe fisceras, oþpe fugeleras.

Hē wæs swyðe spēdig man on þæm æhtum þe heora spēda on bēoð, þæt is, on wilddrum. Hē hæfde þā gýt, ðā hē þone cyningc sôhte, tamra dêora unbebohtra syx hund. Þā dêor hī hâtað 'hrânas'; þāra wæron syx stælhânas; ðā bēoð swyðe dýre mid Finnum, for ðæm hý fôð þā wildan hrânas mid. Hē wæs mid þæm fyrstum mannum on þæm lande næfde hē þeah mǎ ðonne twēntig hrýðera, and twēntig scēapa, and twēntig swýna; and þæt lýtle þæt hē erede, hē erede mid horsan. Ac hyra âr is mǣst on þæm gafole þe ðā Finnas him gyldað. Þæt gafol bið on dêora fellum, and on fugela feðerum, and hwales bāne, and on þæm sciprāpum þe bēoð of hwæles hýde geworht and of sēoles. Æghwīlc gylt be hys gebyrdum. Sē byrdesta sceall gyldan fiftýne mearðes fell, and fīf hrânes, and ân beren fel, and tyn ambra feðra, and berenne kyrtel oððe yterenne, and twēgen sciprāpas; ægþer sý syxtig elna lang, oþer sý of hwæles hýde geworht, oþer of sēoles.

stôwum, swâ brâð swâ man mæg on twām wucum oferfêran; and on sumum stôwum swâ brâð swâ man mæg on syx dagum oferfêran.

### Ohthere's Second Voyage

Ôhthere sǣde þæt sîo scîr hâtte Hâlgoland, þe hē on bûde. Hē cwæð þæt nân man ne bûde be norðan him. Þonne is ân port on sūðewardum þæm lande, þone man hæť Sciringeshêal. Þyder hē cwæð þæt man ne mihte geseglian on ânum mônðe, gyf man on niht wícode, and ælce dæge hæfde ambyrne wind; and ealle ðā hwíle hē sceal seglian be lande. And on þæt stēorbord him bið ærest Íra-land, and þonne ðā ígland þe synd betux Íralande and þissum lande. Þonne is þis land, oð hē cymð tô Sciringcgeshêale, and ealne weg on þæt bæcbord Norðweg.

Wið sūðan þone Sciringeshêal fylð swyðe mycel sǣ ûp in on ðæt land; sêo is brâðre þonne ænig man ofer sêon mæge. And is Gotland on ôðre healfe ongêan, and siððan Sillende. Sêo sǣ lið mænig hund mîla ûp in on þæt land.

**Wulfstan's Voyage**

Wulfstân sæde þæt hê gefôre of Hæðum, þæt hê wære on Trûsô on syfan dagum and nihtum, þæt þæt scip wæs ealne weg yrnende under segle. Weonodland him wæs

on stêorbord, and on bæcbord him wæs Langaland, and Læland, and Falster, and Scônêg; and þâs land eall hýrað tō Denemearcan. And þonne Burgenda land wæs ûs on bæcbord, and þâ habbað him sylfe cyning. Ponne æfter Burgenda lande wæron ûs þâs land, þâ synd hâtene ærest Blêcinga-êg, and Mêore, and Êowland, and Gotland on bæcbord; and þâs land hýrað tō Swêom. And Weonodland wæs ûs ealne weg on stêorbord oð Wislemûðan. Sêo Wisle is swýðe mycel êa, and hîo tōlið Witland and Weonodland; and þæt Witland belimpeð tō Estum; and sêo Wisle lið út of Weonodlande, and lið in Estmere; and sê Estmere is hûru fiftêne mîla brâd. Ponne cymeð Ilfing êastan in Estmere of ðâm mere, ðe Trûsô standeð in stæðe; and cumað út samod in Estmere, Ilfing êastan of Estlande, and Wisle sûðan of Winodlande. And þonne benimð Wisle Ilfing hire naman, and ligeð of þæm mere west and norð on sê; for ðý hit man hæð Wislemûða.

licgað bufan eorðan on hyra hûsum. And ealle þâ hwîle þe þæt lic bið inne, þær sceal bêon gedrync and plega, oð ðone dæg þe hî hine forbærnað. Ponne þý ylcan dæge þe hî hine tō þæm âde beran wyllað, þonne tōdælað hî his feoh, þæt þær tō lāfe bið æfter þæm gedrynce and þæm plegan, on fîf oððe syx, hwýlum on mâ, swâ swâ þæs fêos andêfn bið. Alecgað hit ðonne forhwæga on ânre mîle þone mæstan dæl fram þæm tûne, þonne ôðerne, ðonne þone þridðan, oþ þe hyt eall âlêd bið on þære ânre mîle; and sceall bêon sê læsta dæl nýhst þæm tûne ðe sê dêada man on lið. Donne sceolon bêon gesamnode ealle ðâ menn ðe swyftoste hors habbað on þæm lande, forhwæga on fîf mîlum oððe on syx mîlum fram þæm fêo. Ponne ærnað hý ealle tōweard þæm fêo ðonne cymeð sê man sê þæt swiftoste hors hafað tō þæm ærestan dæle and tō þæm mæstan, and swâ ælc æfter ôðrum, oþ hit bið eall genumen; and sê nimð þone læstan dæl sê nýhst þæm tûne þæt feoh gærneð. And þonne rîdeð ælc hys weges mid ðæm fêo, and hyt môtan habban eall; and for ðý þær bêoð þâ swiftan hors ungefôge dýre. And þonne his gestrêon bêoð þus eall âspended, þonne byrð man hine út, and forbærneð mid his wæpnum and hrægle; and swîðost

ealle hys spêda h̃y forspendað mid þāem langan legere þæs dêadan mannes inne, and þæs þe h̃y be þāem wegum âlecgað, þe ðâ fremdan tō ærnað, and nimað. And þæt is mid Estum þêaw þæt þær sceal ælces geðêodes man bêon forbærned; and gyf þâr man ân bân findeð unforbærned, h̃i hit sceolan miclum gebêtan. And þær is mid Estum ân mægð þæt h̃i magon cyle gewyrcan; and þ̃y þær licgað þâ dêadan men swâ lange, and ne fûliað, þæt h̃y wyrcað þone cyle him on. And þêah man âsette twêgen fætels full ealað oððe wæteres, h̃y gedôð þæt ægþer bið oferfrozen, sam hit s̃y sumor sam winter.

# The Story of Cædmon

Old English Reader

In ðysse abbudissan mynstre wæs sum brôðor syndriglice mid godcundre gife gemæred ond geweorðad, for þon he gewunade gerisenlice lêoð wyrcan, þa ðe tō æfestnisse ond tō ârfæstnisse belumpon; swâ ðætte swâ hwæt swâ hê of godcundum stafum þurh bôceras geleornode, þæt hê æfter medmiclum fæce in scopgereorde mid þa mæstan swêtnisse ond inbryrdnisse geglengde, ond in Englis-  
cgereorde wel geworht forþ brôhte. Ond for his lêopsongum

monigra monna môd oft to worulde forhogdnisse ond tō gepêod-  
nisse þæs heofonlican lifes onbærnde wæron. Ond êac swelce monige ôðre æfter him in Ongelpêode ongunnon æfeste lêoð wyrcan, ac nænig hwæðre him þæt gelice dôn ne meahte; for þon hê nâlæs from monnum nê ðurh mon gelæred wæs þæt hê ðone lêoðcræft leornade, ac hê wæs godcundlice gefultumod, ond þurh Godes gife þone songcræft onfêng; ond hê for ðon næfre nôht lêasunge, nê idles lêopes wyrcan ne meahte, ac efne þa ân ða ðe tō æfestnisse belumpon ond his þa æfestan tungan gedafenode singan.

gongende tō nêata scipene, þara heord him wæs þære nihte bebo-  
den; þa hê ða þær on gelimplycre tîde his leomu on reste gesette ond onslêpte, þa stôð him sum mon æt þurh swefn, ond hine hâlette ond grêtte, ond hine be his noman nemndē "Cædmon, sing mē hwæth-  
wugu." Þa ondswarede hê, ond cwæð: "Ne con ic nôht singan; ond ic for þon of þyssum gebêorscipe út êode ond hider gewât, for þon ic nâht singan ne cûðe." Eft hê cwæð sê ðe wið hine sprecende wæs: "Hwæðre þu meaht mē singan." Þa cwæð hê: "Hwæt sceal ic singan?" Cwæð hê: "Sing mē frumsceaft." Þa hê ða þas andsware onfêng, þa ongon hê sôna singan, in herenisse Godes Scyppendes, þa fers ond þa word þe hê næfre ne gehyrde, þara endebyrdnes þis is:

Hē ærest scēop eorðan bearnum heofon tō hrōfe, hālig Scyppend; þā middangeard monncynnes Weard, êce Drihten, æfter tēode fīrum foldan, Frēa ælmihtig.

gifu forgifen. Þā rehton heo him ond sægdon sum hālig spell ond godcundre lāre word: bebudon him þā, gif hē meahte, þæt hē in swīnsunge lēoþsonges þæt gehwyrfde. Þā hē ðā hæfde þā wīsan onfongne, þā êode hē hām tō his hūse, ond cwōm eft on morgenne, ond þȳ betstan lēoðe geglenged him āsong ond āgeaf þæt him beboden wæs.

canōnes bōca; ond bī Crīstes menniscnesse, ond bī his þrōwunge, ond bī his ūpāstīgnesse in heofonas; ond bī þæs Hālgan Gāstes cyme, ond þāra apostola lāre; ond eft bī þām dæge þæs tōweardan dōmes, ond bī fyrhtu þæs tintreglīcan wītes, ond bī swētnesse þæs heofonlīcan rīces, hē monig lēoð geworhte; ond swelce êac ôðer monig be þām godcundan fremsumnessum ond dōmum hē geworhte. In eal-lum þām hē geornlīce gēmdede þæt hē men ātuge from synna lufan ond mândæda, ond tō lufan ond tō geornfulnesse āwehte gōdra dæda, for þon hē wæs, sē mon, swīpe æfest ond regollīcum þēodscipum ēaðmōdlīce underþēoded; ond wið þām þā ðe in ôðre wīsan dōn woldon, hē wæs mid welme micelre ellenwōdnisse onbærned. Ond hē for ðon fægre ende his līf betȳnde ond geendade.

# Alfred's Preface to the Pastoral Care

Old English Reader

Ælfred kyning hâteð grêtan Wærferð biscep his wordum luflice ond frêondlice; ond ðe cȳðan hâte ðæt mē côm swiðe oft on gemynd, hwelce witan iu wæron giond Angelcynn, ægðer ge godcundra hâda ge woruldcundra; ond hû gesæliglica tîda ða wæron giond Angelcynn; ond hû ða kyningas ðe ðone onwald hæfdon ðæs folces on ðam dagum Gode ond his ærendwrecum hêrsumedon; ond hû hie ægðer ge hiora sibbe ge hiora siodo ge hiora onweald innanbordes gehioldon, ond êac út hiora êðel gerȳmdon; ond hû him ða spêow ægðer ge mid wîge ge mid wîsdôme; ond êac ða godcundan hâdas hû giorne hie wæron ægðer ge ymb lâre ge ymb liornunga, ge ymb ealle ða ðiowotdômas ðe hie Gode dôn scoldon; ond hû man utanbordes wîsdôm ond lâre hieder on lond sôhte, ond hû wê hie nû sceoldon ute begietan, gif wê hie habban sceoldon. Swæ clæne hio wæs oðfeallenu on Angelcynne ðæt swiðe fêawa wæron behionan Humbre ðe hiora ðëninga cûðen understondan on Englisc oððe furðum ân ærendgewrit of Lædene on Englisc âreccean; ond ic wêne ðætte nôht monige begiondan Humbre næren. Swæ fêawa hiora wæron ðæt ic furðum ânne ânlepne ne mæg geðencean

be sûðan Temese, ða ða ic tô rice fêng. Gode ælmihtegum sîe ðonc ðætte wê nû ænigne onstâl habbað lâreowa. Ond for ðon ic ðe bebîode ðæt ðû dô swæ ic gelîefe ðæt ðû wille, ðæt ðû ðe ðissa worulddinga tô ðæm geæmetige, swæ ðû oftost mæge, ðæt ðû ðone wîsdôm ðe ðe God sealde ðær ðær ðû hiene befæstan mæge, befæste. Geðenc hwelc wîtu ûs ða becômon for ðisse worulde, ða ða wê hit nôhwæðer nê selfe ne lufodon, nê êac oðrum monnum ne lêfdon:

ðone naman āne wê lufodon ðætte wê Crîstne wæren, ond swiðe fêawe ða ðêawas.

nænne dæl noldon on hiora āgen geðiode wendan. Ac ic ða sōna eft mē selfum andwyrde, ond cwæð: "Hīe ne wēndon þætte æfre menn sceolden swæ reccelease weorðan, ond sio lār swæ oðfeallan; for ðære wilnunga hīe hit forlêton, ond woldon ðæt hēr ðy mārā wīsdōm on londe wære ðy wē mā geðeoda cūðon."

nānre oðerre note ne mægen, oð ðone first ðe hīe wel cunnen Englisc gewrit ārædan: lāre mon siððan furður on Lædengeðiode ða ðe mon furðor lāran wille, ond tō hierran hāde dōn wille. Ða ic ða gemunde hū sio lār Lædengeðiodes ær ðissum āfeallen wæs giond Angelcynn, ond ðeah monige cūðon Englisc gewrit ārædan, ða ongan ic ongemang oðrum mislīcum ond manigfealdum bisgum ðisses kynesrīces ða bōc wendan on Englisc ðe is genemned on Læden "Pastoralis," ond on Englisc "Hierdebōc," hwīlum word be worde, hwīlum andgit of andgiete, swæ swæ ic hīe geliornode æt Plegmunde mīnum ærcebiscepe, ond æt Assere mīnum biscepe, ond æt Grimbolde mīnum mæsseprīoste, ond æt Iōhanne mīnum mæsseprēoste. Siððan ic hīe ða geliornod hæfde, swæ swæ ic hīe forstōd, ond swæ ic hīe andgitfullīcost āreccean meahte, ic hīe on Englisc āwende; ond tō ælcum biscepstōle on mīnum rīce wille āne onsendan; ond on ælcra bið ān æstel, sē bið on fīftægum mancessa. Ond ic bebōde on Godes naman ðæt nān mon ðone æstel from ðære bēc ne dō, nē ða bōc from ðām mynstre; uncūð hū longe ðær swæ gelærede biscepas sīen, swæ swæ nū, Gode ðonc, wel hwær siendon. For ðy ic wolde ðætte hīe ealneg

æt ðære stōwe wæren, būton sē biscep hīe mid him habban wille, oððe hīo hwær tō læne sīe, oððe hwā oðre bī wrīte.



# The Wanderer

Old English Reader

- 1 Oft him ânhaga âre gebîdeð,  
Metudes miltse, þêah þe hê mōdcearig  
geond lagulâde longe sceolde  
hrêran mid hondum hrîmcealde sâ,  
5 wadan wræclæstas: wyrd bið ful âræd!  
Swâ cwæð eardstapa earfeþa gemyndig,  
wrâþra wælsleahta, winemæga hryres:  
"Oft ic sceolde âna ûhtna gehwylce  
mîne ceare cwîþan; nis nû cwicra nân,  
10 þe ic him mōdsefan mînne durre  
sweotule âsecgan. Ic tô sôþe wât  
þæt biþ in eorle indryhten þêaw,  
þæt hê his ferðlocan fæste binde,  
healde his hordcofan, hycge swâ hê wille;  
15 ne mæg wêrig mōd wyrde wiðstondan  
nê sê hrêo hyge helpe gefremman:  
for ðon dômgeorne drêorigne oft  
in hyra brêostcofan bindað fæste.  
Swâ ic mōdsefan mînne sceolde  
20 oft earmcearig êðle bidæled,  
frêomægum feor feterum sælan,  
siþþan gêara iû goldwine mînne  
hrûsan heolster biwrâh, and ic hêan þonan  
wôd wintercearig ofer wapema gebind,  
25 sôhte sele drêorig since bryttan,  
hwær ic feor oþþe nêah findan meahte  
þone þe in meoduhealle miltse wisse  
oþþe mec frêondlêasne frêfran wolde,

- wenian mid wyнным. Wāt sê þe cunnað  
 30 hū slīpen bið sorg tō gefêran  
 þām þe him lýt hafað léofra geholenā  
 warað hine wræclāst, nāles wunden gold,  
 ferðloca frêorig, nālæs foldan blæd;  
 gemon hê selescegas and sincþege,  
 35 hū hine on geoguðe his goldwine  
 wenede tō wistē wyn eal gedrêas!  
 For þon wāt sê þe sceal his winedryhtnes  
 léofes lārcwidum longe forþolian,  
 ðonne sorg and slæp somod ætgædre  
 40 earmne ānhagan oft gebindað:  
 þinceð him on mōde þæt hê his mondryhten  
 clyppe and cysse, and on cnêo lecge  
 honda and hêafod, swā hê hwīlum ær  
 in gêardagum giefstôles brêac;  
 45 ðonne onwæcneð eft winelêas guma,  
 gesihð him biforan fealwe wægās,  
 bapian brimfuglas, brædan feþra,  
 hrêosan hrīm and snāw hagle gemenged.  
 Ponne bêoð þȳ hefigran heortan benne,  
 50 sære æfter swæsne; sorg bið genīwad;  
 þonne māga gemynd mōd geondhweorfeð,  
 grêteð glīwstafum, georne geondscêawað.  
 Secga geseldan swimmað eft on weg;  
 flêotendra ferð nō þær fela bringeð  
 55 cūðra cwidegiedda; cearo bið genīwad  
 þām þe sendan sceal swīpe geneahhe  
 ofer wapema gebind wêrigne sefan.  
 For þon ic geþencan ne mæg geond þās woruld  
 for hwan mōdsefa mīn ne gesweorce,  
 60 þonne ic eorla līf eal geondþence,  
 hū hī færlīce flet ofgêafon,  
 mōdge maguþegnas. Swā þēs middangeard  
 ealra dōgra gehwām drêoseð and fealleþ;  
 for þon ne mæg weorþan wīs wer, ær hê āge  
 65 wintra dæl in woruldrīce. Wita sceal geþyldig,  
 ne sceal nō tō hātheort nê tō hrædwyrde,  
 nê tō wac wiga nê tō wanhȳdig,

- nê tô forht nê tô fægen nê tô feohgîfre,  
 nê næfre gielpes tô georn, ær hê geare cunne.
- 70 Beorn sceal gebīdan, þonne hê bêot spriceð,  
 oþ þæt collenferð cunne gearwe  
 hwider hreþra gehygd hweorfan wille.  
 Ongietan sceal glêaw hæle hû gæstlic bið,  
 þonne eall þisse worulde wela wêste stondeð,
- 75 swâ nû missenlice geond þisne middangeard  
 winde biwâune weallas stondaþ,  
 hrîme bihrorene, hryðge þâ ederas.  
 Wôriað þâ wînsalo, waldend licgað  
 drêame bidrorene; duguð eal gecrong
- 80 wlonc bî weallē sume wîg fornôm,  
 ferede in forðwege; sumne fugel oþbær  
 ofer hêanne holm; sumne sê hâra wulf  
 dêaðe gedælde; sumne drêorighlêor  
 in eorðscræfe eorl gehyðdē
- 85 yþde swâ þisne eardgeard ælda Scyppend,  
 oþ þæt burgwara breahmta lêase  
 eald enta geweorc idlu stôdon.  
 Sê þonne þisne wealsteal wîse geþôhte,  
 and þis deorce lif dêope geondþenceð,
- 90 frôd in ferðe feor oft gemon  
 wælsleahta worn, and þâs word âcwið:  
 'Hwær cwôm mearg? hwær cwôm mago? hwær cwôm  
 mâþpumgyfa?  
 hwær cwôm symbla gesetu? hwær sindon seledrêamas?  
 Êalâ beorht bune! êalâ byrnwiga!
- 95 êalâ þêodnes þrym! hû sêo þrâg gewât,  
 genâp under nihthelm, swâ hêo nô wære!  
 Stondeð nû on lâste lêofre duguþe  
 weal wundrum hêah, wyrmlícum fâh:  
 eorlas fornômon asca þrýþe,
- 100 wæpen wælgîfru, wyrd sêo mære;  
 and þâs stânhleoþu stormas cnyssað;  
 hrîð hrêosende hrûsan bindeð,  
 wintres wôma, þonne won cymeð,  
 nîpeð nihtscûa, norþan onsendeð
- 105 hrêo hæglfare hæleþum on andan.

- Eall is earfoðlíc eorþan ríce,  
onwendeð wyrda gesceaft weoruld under heofonum:  
hēr bið feoh læne, hēr bið frēond læne,  
hēr bið mon læne, hēr bið mæg læne;  
110 eal þis eorþan gesteal îdel weorþeð!”  
Swâ cwæð snottor on môde, gesæt him sundor æt rune.  
Til biþ sê þe his trêowe gehealdeð;  
ne sceal næfre his torn tô rycene  
beorn of his brêostum âcȳþan, nemþe hê ær þâ bôte cunne;  
115 eorl mid elne gefremman. Wel bið þâm þe him âre sêceð,  
frôfre tô Fæder on heofonum,  
þær ûs eal sêo fæstnung stondeð.

# SERMO DE INITIO CREATURÆ, AD POPULUM, QUANDO VOLUERIS

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

An angin is ealra þinga, þæt is God Ælmihtig. He is ordfruma and ende: he is ordfruma, forði þe he wæs æfre; he is ende butan ælcere geendunge, forðan þe he bið æfre ungeendod. He is ealra cyninga Cyning, and ealra hlaforða Hlaford. He hylt mid his mihte heofonas and eorðan, and ealle gesceafta butan geswince, and he besceawað þa niwelnyssa þe under þyssere eorðan sind. He awecð ealle duna mid anre handa, and ne mæg nan þing his willan wiðstandan. Ne mæg nan gesceaft fulfremedlice smeagan ne understandan ymbe god. Maran cyððe habbað englas to Gode þonne men, and þeah-hweðere hí ne magon fulfremedlice understandan ymbe God. Hé gesceop gesceafta þaða he wolde; þurh his wisdom he geworhte ealle þing, and þurh his willan hé hí ealle geliffæste. Deos þrynnys is án God; þæt is se Fæder and his wisdom of him sylfum æfre acenned; and heora begra willa, þæt is se Halga Gast: he nis na acenned, ac he gæð of þam Fæder and of þam Suna gelice. Ðas þry hadas sindon án Ælmihtig God, se geworhte heofenas, and eorðan, and ealle gesceafta. He gesceop tyn engla werod, þæt sind englas and heah-englas, thrони, dominationes, principatus, potestates, uirtutes, cherubim, seraphim. Her sindon nigon engla werod: hí nabbað nænne lichaman, ac hí sindon ealle gastas swiðe strange and mihtige and wlitige, on micelre fægernysse gesceapene, to lofe and to wurðmynte

heora Scyppende. Ðæt teoðe werod abreað and awende on yfel. God hí gesceop ealle góde, and let hí habban agenne cyre, swa hí heora Scyppend lufedon and filigdon, swa hí hine forleton. Ða wæs þæs teoðan werodes ealdor swiðe fæger and wlitig gesceapen, swa þæt hé wæs geháten Leohtberend. Þa began he to modigenne for þære fægernysse þe he hæfde, and cwæð on his heortan þæt hé wolde and eaðe mihte beon his Scyppende gelic, and sittan on þam norð-dæle heofenan rices, and habban andweald and rice ongearon God Ælmihtigne. Þa gefæstnode he þisne ræd wið þæt werod þe hé bewiste, and hí ealle to ðam ræde gebugon. Ðaða hí ealle hæfdon þysne ræd betwux him gefæstnod, þa becom Godes grama ofer hí ealle, and hí ealle wurdon awende of þam fægeran híwe, þe hí on gesceapene wæron, to laðlicum deoflum. And swiðe rihtlice him swa getimode, þaða he wolde mid modignysse beon betera þonne he gesceapen wæs, and cwæð, þæt he mihte beon þam Ælmihtigum Gode gelic. Þa wearð he and ealle his geferan forcupran and wýrsan þonne ænig oðer gesceaft; and þa hwile þe he smeade hu he mihte dælan rice wið God, þa hwile gearcode se Ælmihtiga Scyppend him and his geferum helle wite, and hí ealle adræfde of heofenan rices myrhðe, and let befeallan on þæt ece fyr, þe him gegearcod wæs for heora ofermetum. Þa sona þa nigon werod, þe ðær to lafe wæron, bugon to heora Scyppende mid ealre eaðmodnesse, and betæhton heora ræd to his willan. Þa getrymde se Ælmihtiga God þa nigon engla werod, and gestapelfæste swa þæt hí næfre ne mihton ne noldon syððan fram his willan gebugan; ne hí ne magon nu, ne hí nellað nane synne gewyr-can, ac hi æfre beoð ymbe þæt án, hu hi magon Gode gehyrsumian, and him gecweman. Swa mihton eac þa oðre þe ðær feollon dón, gif hi woldon; forþi ðe God hí geworhte to wlitigum engla gecynde, and let hí habban agenne cyre, and hí næfre ne gebigde ne ne nydde mid nanum þingum to þam yfelan ræde; ne næfre se yfela ræd ne com of Godes gepance, ac com of þæs deofles, swa swa we ær cwædon.

Nu þencð menig man and smeað hwanon deofol come; þonne wite he þæt God gesceop to mæran engle þone þe nu is deofol: ac God ne gesceop hine na to deofle; ac þaða he wæs mid ealle fordón and forscyldgod þurh þa miclan up-ahæfednysse and wiðerweardnysse, þa wearð he to deofle awend, seðe ær wæs mære engel geworht. Ða wolde God gefyllan and geinnian þone lyre þe forloren wæs of þam heofenlicum werode, and cwæð þæt hé wolde wyr-can mannan of eorðan, þæt se eorðlica man sceolde geþeow and gearnian mid ead-

modnysse þa wununga on heofenan rice, þe se deofol forwyrhte mid modignysse. And God þa geworhte ærne mannan of láme, and him on ableow gast, and hine gelíffæste, and he wearð þa mann gesceapen on sawle and on lichaman; and God him sette naman Adám, and he wæs þa sume hwile ástandende. God þa hine gebrohte on neorxna-wange, and hine þær gelogode, and him to cwæð, "Ealra þæra þinga þe on neorxna-wange sindon þu most brucan, and hí ealle beoð þe betæhte, buton anum treowe þe stent on middan neorxna-wange: ne hrepa þu þæs treowes wæstm, forþan ðe þu bist deadlic, gif ðu þæs treowes wæstm geetst." Hwí wolde God swa lytles þinges him forwyrnan, þe him swa miccle oðre þing betæhte? Gyse hu mihte Adám tocnawan hwæt hé wære, buton hé wære gehyrsum on sumum þince his Hlaforde. Swylce God ewáde to him, "Nast þu na þæt ic eom þin Hlaford and þæt þu eart min þeowa, buton þu do þæt ic þe háte, and forgáng þæt ic þe forbeode. Hwæt mæg hit þonne beon þæt þu forgán sceole: ic ðe secge, forgang ðu anes treowes wæstm, and mid þære eaðelican gehyrsumnysse þu geearnast heofenan rices myrhðu and þone stede þe se deofol of-afeoll þurh ungehyrsumnesse. Gif ðu þonne ðis lytle bebód tobrecst, þu scealt deaðe sweltan." And þa wæs Adam swa wís þæt God gelædde to him nytenu, and deorcynn, and fugelcynn, ðaða he hí gesceapene hæfde; and Adam him eallum naman gesceop; and swa swa hé hí þa genamode swa hí sindon gyt gehatene. Þa cwæð God, "Nis na gedafenlic þæt þes man ana beo, and næbbe nænne fultum; ac uton gewyrcean him gemacan, him to fultume and to frofre." And God þa geswefode þone Adam, and þaþa he slep ða genam he an rib of his sidan, and geworhte of ðam ribbe ærne wifman, and axode Adam hu heo hatan sceolde. Þa cwæð Adam, "Heo is ban of minum banum, and flæsc of minum flæsce; beo hire nama Uirago, þæt is fæmne; forðan ðe heo is of hire were genu-men." Ða sette Adam eft hire oðerne naman, Aeua, þæt is lif; forðan ðe heo is ealra lybbendra modor.

Ealle gesceafta, heofonas and englas, sunnan and monan, steorran and eorðan, ealle nytenu and fugelas, sáe and ealle fixas, and ealle gesceafta God gesceop and geworhte on six dagum; and on ðam sefoðan dæge hé geendode his weorc, and geswac ða and gehalgode þone sefoðan dæg, forðan ðe hé on ðam dæge his weorc geendode. And he beheold þa ealle his weorc ðe he geworhte, and hí wæron ealle swiðe gode. Ealle ðing he geworhte buton ælcum antimbre. He cwæð, "Geweorðe leoht," and ðærrihte wæs leoht geworden. He

cwæð eft, "Geweorðe heofen," and þærrihte wæs heofen geworht, swa swa he mid his wisdom and mid his willan hit gedihte. He cwæð eft, and het ða eorðan þæt heo sceolde forðlædan cuce nytenu; and hé ða gesceop of ðære eorðan eall nytencynn, and deorcynn, ealle ða ðe on feower fotum gað; ealswa eft of wætere he gesceop fixas and fugelas, and sealde ðam fixum sund, and ðam fugelum fliht; ac he ne sealde nanum nytene ne nanum fisce nane sawle; ac heora blod is heora lif, and swa hraðe swa hi beoð deade, swa beoð hí mid ealle geendode. Þaða he worhte ðone mann Adám, he ne cwæð ná, "Geweorðe man geworht," ac he cwæð, "Uton gewyrcean mannan to ure anlicnysse," and hé worhte ða þone man mid his handum, and him on ableow sawle; forði is se man betera, gif hé góde geðihð, þonne ealle ða nytenu sindon; forðan ðe hí ealle gewurðað to nahte, and se man is ece on anum dæle, þæt is on ðære sawle; heo ne geendað næfre. Se lichama is deadlic þurh Adames gylt, ac ðeah-hwæðere God arærð eft ðone lichaman to ecum ðingum on domes dæg. Nu cwædon gedwolmen þæt deofol gesceope sume gesceafta, ac hí leogað; ne mæg hé nane gesceafta gescyppan, forðan ðe he nis na Scyppend, ac is atelic sceocca, and mid leasunge he wile beswican and fordón þone unwaran; ac he ne mæg nænne man to nanum leahltre geneadian, buton se mon his agenes willes to his lare gebuge. Swa hwæt swa is on gesceaftum wiðerweardlic geþuht and mannum derige, þæt is eall for urum synnum and yfelum gearnungum.

Þa ongeat se deofol þæt Adam and Eua wæron to ðy gesceapene þæt hi sceolon mid eadmodnysse and mid gehyrsumnysse gearnian ða wununge on heofenan rice ðe hé of-afeoll for his up-ahefednysse, þa nam hé micelne gram and ándan to þam mannum, and smeade hú hé hí fordón mihte. He com ða on næddran hiwe to þam twam mannum, ærest to ðam wife, and hire to cwæð, "Hwí forbead God eow þæs treowes wæstm, ðe stent on middan neorxna-wange?" Þa cwæð þæt wíf, "God us forbead þæs treowes wæstm, and cwæð þæt we sceoldon deaðe sweltan, gif we his on byrigdon." Ða cwæð se deofol, "Nis hit na swa ðu segst, ac God wát genoh geare, gif ge of ðam treowe geetað, þonne beoð eowere eagan geopenode, and ge magon geseon and tocnáwan ægðer ge gód ge yfel, and ge beoð englum gelice." Næron hí blinde gesceapene, ac God hí gesceop swa bilewite þæt hí ne cuðon nan ðing yfeles, naðor ne on gesihðe, ne on spræce, ne on weorce. Wearð þeah þæt wíf ða forspanen þurh ðæs deofles láre, and genam of ðæs treowes wæstm, and geæt, and sealde hire



were, and hé geæt. Ða wæron hí butu deadlice, and cuðon ægðer ge gód ge yfel; and hí wæron ða nacode, and him ðæs sceamode. Ða com God and axode hwi he his bebod tobræce? and adræfde hí butu of neorxna-wange, and cwæð, "Forðan ðe ðu wære gehyrsum ðines wifes wordum, and min bebod forsawe, þu scealt mid earfoðnyssum þe metes tilian, and seo eorðe þe is awyriged on þinum weorce, sylð þe ðornas and bremblas. Þu eart of eorðan genumen, and þu awenst to eorðan. Þu eart dust, and ðu awentst to duste." God him worhte ða reaf of fellum, and hí wæron mid þam fellum gescrydde.

Ða deadan fell getacnodon þæt hí wæron ða deadlice þe mihton beon undeadlice, gif hi heoldon þæt eaðelice Godes bebod. Ne þorfte Adam ne eal mancynn þe him siððan ofacom næfre deaðes onbyrian, gif þæt treow moste standan ungehrepod, and his nan man ne on-byrigde; ac sceolde Adam and his ofspring tyman on asettum tyman, swa swa nu doð clæne nytenu, and siððan ealle buton deaðe faran to ðan ecan life. Næs him gesceapen fram Gode, ne hé næs genedd þæt hé sceolde Godes bebod tobrecan; ac God hine lét frigne, and sealde him agenne cyre, swa hé wære gehyrsum, swa hé wære ungehyrsum. Hé wearð þa deofle gehyrsum, and Gode ungehyrsum, and wearð betæht, hé and eal mancynn, æfter ðisum life, into helle-wíte, mid þam deofle ðe hine forlærde. Ða wiste God hwæðere þæt hé wæs forlæred, and smeade hu he mihte his and ealles mancynnes eft gemiltsian.

On twam þingum hæfde God þæs mannes sawle gegodod; þæt is mid undeadlicnysse, and mid gesælðe. Ða þurh deofles swicdom and Adames gylt we forluron þa gesælðe ure sawle, ac we ne forluron ná þa undeadlicnysse; heo is éce, and næfre ne geendað, þeah se lichama geendige, þe sceal eft þurh Godes mihte arisan to ecere wununge. Adam þa wæs wunigende on þisum life mid geswince, and hé and his wíf ða bearn gestryndon, ægðer ge suna ge dohtra; and he leofode nigon hund geara and þritig geara, and siððan swealt, swa swa him ær behaten wæs, for þan gylte; and his sawul gewende to helle.

Nu smeagiað sume men hwanon him come sawul? hwæper ðe of þam fæder, þe of þære meder? We cweðað of heora naðrum; ac se ylca God þe gesceop Adam mid his handum, he gescyppð ælces mannes lichaman on his modor innoðe; and se ylca seðe ableów on Adames lichaman, and him forgeaf sawle, se ylca forgyfð cildum sawle and lif on heora modor innoðe, þonne hí gesceapene beoð; and

he lætt hí habban agenne cyre, þonne hí geweaxene beoð, swa swa Adám hæfde.

Þa wearð þa hrædlice micel mennisc geweaxen, and wæron swiðe manega on yfel awende, and gegremodon God mid mislicum leahtrum, and swiðost mid forligere. Ða wearð God to þan swiðe gegremod þurh manna mándæda þæt he cwæð þæt him ofþuhte þæt hé æfre mancynn gesceop. Ða wæs hwæpere án man rihtwis ætforan Gode, se wæs Nóe geháten. Þa cwæð God to him, "Ic wylle fordón eal mancynn mid wætere, for heora synnum, ac ic wylle gehealdan þe ænne, and þin wíf, and þine þry suna, Sem, and Cham, and Iafeth, and heora þreo wíf; forðan þe ðu eart rihtwis, and me gecweme. Wyrsc þe nú ænne arc, þreo hund fæðma lang, and fiftig fæðma wíd, and þritig fæðma heah: gehref hit eall, and geclæm ealle þa seamas mid tyrwan, and gá inn syððan mid þinum híwum. Ic gegaderige in to þe of deorcynne, and of fugelcynne symble gemacan, þæt hí eft to fostre beon. Ic wille sendan flod ofer ealne middangeard." He dyde þa swa him God bebed, and God beleac hí bynnan þam arce, and asende rén of heofonum feowertig daga togædere, and geopenode þær togeanes ealle wyll-springas and wæter-þeotan of þære micclan niwelnyssse. Ðæt flod weox ða and abær up þone arc, and hit oferstah ealle dúna. Wearð þa ælc þing cuces adrenct, buton þam ðe binnon þam arce wæron; of þam wearð eft ge-edstaðelod eall middangeard. Ða behét God þæt hé nolde næfre eft eal mancynn mid wætere acwellan, and cwæð to Noe and to his sunum, "Ic wylle settan mín wedd betwux me and eow to þisum beháte; þæt is, þonne ic oferteo heofenas mid wólcnum, þonne bið æteowod mín rénboga betwux þam wolcnum, þonne beo ic gemyndig mines weddes, þæt ic nelle heonon-forð mancynn mid wætere adrencan." Noe leofode on eallum his life, ær þam flode and æfter þam flode, nigon hund geara and fiftig geara, and he þa forðferde.

Ða wæs þa sume hwíle Godes ege on mancynne æfter þam flode, and wæs án gereord on him eallum. Ða cwædon hi betwux him þæt hi woldon wyrscan ane burh, and ænne stypel binnon þære byrig, swa heahne þæt his hrof astige up to heofenum: and begunnon þa to wyrscenne. Ða com God þærto, þaða hí swiðost worhton, and sealde ælcum men þe ðær wæs synderlice spræce. Þa wæron þær swa fela gereord swa ðær manna wæron; and heora nán nyste hwæt oðer cwæð. And hí ða geswicon þære getimbrunge, and toferdon geond ealne middangeard.

Ða siððan wearð mancynn þurh deofol beswicen, and gebiged fram Godes geleafan, swa þæt hí worhton him anlicnyssa, sume of golde, sume of seolfre, sume eac of stanum, sume of treowe, and sceopon him naman; þæra manna naman þe wæron entas and yfel-dæde. Eft ðonne hí deade wæron, þonne cwædon þa cucan þæt hí wæron godas, and wurðodon hí, and him lác offrodon; and comon þa deoflu to heora anlicnyssum, and þæron wunodon, and to mannum spræcon swilce hí godas wæron; and þæt beswicene mennisc feoll on cneowum to þam anlicnyssum, and cwædon, "Ge sind ure godas and we besettað urne geleafan and urne hiht on eow." Ða asprang þis gedwyld geond ealne middangeard, and wæs se soða Scyppend, seðe ána is God, forsewen, and geunwurþod. Ða wæs hwæðere an mægð þe næfre ne abeah to nanum deofolgyldre, ac æfre wurðode þone soðan God. Seo mægð aspránc of Nôes eltstan suna, se wæs gehaten Sem: he leofode six hund geara, and his sunu hatte Arfafað, se leofode þreo hund geara and þreo and þrittig, and his sunu hatte Salé, se leofode feower hund geara and XXXIII.; þa gestrynde he sunu se wæs geháten Ebér, of þam aspránc þæt Ebreisce folc, þe God leofode: and of þam cynne comon ealle heahfæderas and witegan, þa ðe cyðdon Cristes to-cyme to þisum life; þæt hé wolde man beon, fornean on ende þyssere worulde, for ure alysednesse, seðe æfre wæs God mid þam healican Fæder. And þyssere mægðe God sealde and gesette æ, and hé hí lædde ofer sæ mid drium fotum, and hé hí afedde feowertig wintra mid heofenlicum hlafe, and fela wundra on þam folce geworhte; forþan ðe he wolde of þyssere mægðe him modor geceosan.

Ða æt nextan, þa se tíma com þe God foresceawode, þa asende he his engel Gabrihel to anum mædene of þam cynne, seo wæs María gehaten. Þa com se engel to hire, and hí gegrette mid Godes wordum, and cydde híre, þæt Godes Sunu sceolde beon acenned of hire, buton weres gemanan. And heo þa gelyfde his wordum, and wearð mid cilde. Ðaða hire tíma com heo acende, and þurhwunode mæden. Ðæt cild is tuwa acenned: he is acenned of þam Fæder on heofonum, buton ælcere meder, and eft þaða hé man gewearð, þa wæs hé acenned of þam clænan mædene Marían, buton ælcum eorðlicum fæder. God Fæder geworhte mancynn and ealle gesceafta þurh ðone Sunu, and eft, ðaða we forwyrhte wæron, þa asende hé ðone ylcan Sunu to úre alysednesse. Seo halige moder María þa afedde þæt cild

mid micelre arwurðnesse, and hit weox swa swa oðre cild doð, buton synne anum.

He wæs buton synnum acenned, and his líf wæs eal buton synnum. Ne worhte he þeah náne wundra openlice árdan ðe hé wæs þritig wintre on þære menniscnysse: þa siðþan geceas he him leorning-cnihtas; ærest twelf, þa we hátað apostolas, þæt sind ærendracan. Siþþan hé geceas twá and hund-seofontig, þa sind genemnede discipuli, þæt sind leorning-cnihtas. Ða worhte hé fela wundra, þæt men mihton gelyfan þæt he wæs Godes Bearn. Hé awende wæter to wine, and eode ofer sæ mid drium fotum, and he gestilde windas mid his hæse, and hé forgeaf blindum mannum gesihðe, and healtum and lamum rihtne gáng, and hreoflium smeðnysse, and hælu heora lichaman; dumbum hé forgeaf getingnysse, and deafum heorcunge; deofolseocum and wodum hé sealde gewitt, and þa deoflu todræfde, and ælce untrumnysse he gehælde; deade men hé arærde of heora byrgenum to lífe; and lærde þæt folc þe hé to com mid micclum wisdom; and cwæð þæt nán man ne mæg beon gehealden, buton he rihtlice on God gelyfe, and he beo gefullod, and his geleafan mid godum weorcum geglenge; he onscunode ælc unriht and ealle leasunga, and tæhte rihtwisnysse and soðfæstnysse.

Þa nam þæt Iudeisce folc micelne ándan ongean his láre, and smeadon hú hí mihton híne to deaðe gedón. Þa wearð án ðæra twelfa Cristes geferena, se wæs Iudas gehaten, þurh deofles tihtinge beswicen, and hé eode to þam Iudeiscum folce, and smeade wið hí, hu he Crist him beláewan mihte. Þeah ðe eal mennisc wære gegaderod, ne mihton hí ealle hine acwellan, gif he sylf nolde; forði he cóm to us þæt hé wolde for ús deað þrowian, and swa eal mancynn þa ðe gelyfað mid his agenum deaðe alysan fram helle-wite. Hé nolde geniman ús neadunge of deofles anwealde, buton he hit forwyrhte; þa hé hit forwyrhte genóh swiðe, þaða hé gehwette and tihte ðæra Iudeiscra manna heortan to Cristes slege. Crist ða geðafode þæt ða wælhreowan hine genámon and gebundon, and on róde hengegene acwealdon. Hwæt ða twegen gelyfede men hine arwurðlice bebyrigdon, and Crist on ðære hwile to helle gewende, and þone deofol gewylde, and him of-anám Adám and Euan, and heora ofspring, þone dæl ðe him ár gecwemde, and gelædde hí to heora lichaman, and arás of deaðe mid þam micclum werede on þam þriddan dæge his þrowunge. Cóm þa to his apostolum, and hí gefrefrode, and geond feowertigra daga fyrst him mid wunode; and ða ylcan lare

þe hé him ær tæhte eft ge-edlæhte, and het hí faran geond ealne mid-dangeard, bodigende fulluht and soðne geleafan. Drihten ða on ðam feowerteogoðan dæge his æristes astah to heofenum, ætforan heora ealra gesihðe, mid þam ylcan lichaman þe hé on þrowode, and sitt on ða swiðran his Fæder, and ealra gesceafta gewylt. Hé hæfð gerymed rihtwisum mannum infær to his rice, and ða ðe his beboda eallunga forseoð beoð on helle besencte. Witodlice hé cymð on ende þyssere worulde mid micclum mægenþrymme on wolcnum, and ealle ða ðe æfre sawle underfengon arisað of deaðe him togeanes; and hé ðonne ða mánfullan deofle betæcð into ðam ecan fyre helle susle; þa rihtwisan he læt mid him into heofonan rice, on þam hí rixiað á on ecnysse.

Men ða leofestan, smeagað þysne cwyde, and mid micelre gymene forbugað unrihtwysnysse, and geearniað mid godum weorcum þæt éce líf mid Gode seðe ána on ecnysse rixað. Amen.

# SERMO DE NATALE DOMINI

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

We wyllað to trymminge eowres geleafan eow gereccan þæs Hælendes acennednysse be ðære godspellican endebyrdnysse: hū he on ðysum dægðerlicum dæge on soðre menniscnysse acenned wæs on godcundnysse.

Lucas se Godspellere awrát on Cristes béc, þæt on ðam timan se Romanisca casere Octauianus sette gebánn, þæt wære on gewritum asett eall ymbhwyrft. Þeos towritennys wearð aræred fram ðam ealdormen Cyrino, of Sirian lande, þæt ælc man ofer-heafod sceolde cennan his gebyrde, and his áre on ðære byrig þe hé to gehyrde. Þa ferde Ioseph, Cristes foster-fæder, fram Galileiscum earde, of ðære byrig Nazareð, to Iudeiscre byrig, seo wæs Dauides, and wæs geciged Bethleém, forðan ðe hé wæs of Dauides mægðe, and wolde andettan mid Marían hire gebyrde, þe wæs þa gýt bearn-eaca. Ða gelámp hit, þaða hí on þære byrig Bethleém wícodon, þæt hire tima wæs gefylled þæt heo cennan sceolde, and acende ða hyre frumcennedan sunu, and mid cild-claðum bewánd, and aléde þæt cild on heora assena binne, forþan þe ðær næs nán rymet on þam gesthuse. Þa wæron hyrdas on þam earde waciende ofer heora eowede; and efne ða Godes engel stód on emn hí, and Godes beorhtnys hí bescean, and hí wurdon micclum afyrhte. Ða cwæð se Godes engel to ðam hyrdum, "Ne ondredað eow; efne ic eow bodige micelne gefean, þe becymð eal-lum folce; forðan þe nu to-dæg is eow acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre. Ge geseoð þis tácen, ge gemetað þæt cild mid cild-claðum bewunden, and on binne geléd." Þa færlice, æfter þæs engles spræce, wearð gesewen micel menigu heofenlices werodes God

herigendra and singendra, "Gloria in excelsis Deo, et in terra pax hominibus bone uoluntatis," þæt is on urum gereorde, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb mannum, þam ðe beoð godes willan." And ða englas ða gewiton of heora gesihðe to heofonum. Hwæt ða hyrdas þa him betweenan spræcon, "Uton faran to Bethleem, and geseon þæt word þe us God æteowde." Hí comon ða hrædllice, and gemetton Marian, and Ioseph, and þæt cild geled on anre binne, swa swa him se engel cydde. Þa hyrdas soðlice oncneowon be þam worde þe him gesæd wæs be ðam cilde, and ealle wundrodon þe þæt gehyrdon, and eac be ðam ðe þa hyrdas him sædon. María soðlice heold ealle þas wórd aræfniende on hire heortan. Ða gecyrdon þa hyrdas ongearde wuldrigende and herigende God on eallum ðam ðingum þe hí gehyrdon and gesawon, swa swa him fram þam engle gesæd wæs.

Mine gebroðra þa leofostan, ure Hælend, Godes Sunu, euen-ece and gelic his Fæder, se ðe mid him wæs æfre buton anginne, gemedemode hine sylfne þæt he wolde on ðisum dægðerlicum dæge, for middangeardes alysednysse beon lichamlice acenned of þam mædene Marian. He is Ealdor and Scyppend ealra gódnysa and sibbe, and he foresende his acennednysse ungewunelice sibbe, forðan ðe næfre næs swilc sibb ær þam fyrste on middangearde, swilc swa wæs on his gebyrde-tide, swa þæt eall middangeard wæs anes mannes rice underðeod, and eal mennisc him anum cynelic gafol ageaf. Witodlice on swa micelre sibbe wæs Crist acenned, se ðe is ure sib, forþan ðe hé geþeodde englas and men to ánum hirede, þurh his menniscnysse. Hé wæs acenned on þæs caseres dagum þe wæs Octavianus geháten, se gerymde Romana rice to ðan swiðe þæt him eal middangeard to beah, and he wæs forði Augustus geciged, þæt is geýcende his rice. Se nama gedafenað þam heofonlican Cyninge Criste, þe on his timan acenned wæs, se ðe his heofonlice rice geyhte, and ðone hryre, þe se feallenda deofol on engla werode gewanode, mid menniscum gecynde eft gefylde. Na þæt án þæt he ðone lyre anfealdlice gefylde, ac eac swylce micclum geihte. Soðlice swa micel getel mancynnes becymð þurh Cristes menniscnysse to engla werodum, swa micel swa on heofonum beláf haligra engla æfter ðæs deofles hryre. Þæs caseres gebann, þe het ealne middangeard awritan, getacnode swutellice þæs heofonlican Cyninges dæde, þe to ði com on middangeard þæt he of eallum ðeodum his gecorenan gegaderode, and heora naman on ecere eadignysse awrite. Þeos towritennys asprang

fram ðam ealdormen Cyrino: Cyrinus is gereht Yrfenuma, and he getacnode Crist, se ðe is soð yrfenuma þæs ecan Fæder; and he us forgifð þæt we mid him beon yrfenuman and efenhlyttan his wuldres. Ealle ðeoda þa ferdon þæt ælc synderlice be him sylfum cennan sceolde, on ðære byrig þe he to hyrde. Swa swa on ðam timan be ðæs caseres gebanne gehwilce ænlipige on heora burgum be him sylfum cendon, swa eac nu us cyðað lāreowas Cristes gebann, þæt we ús gegadrian to his halgan gelaðunge, and on ðære ures geleafan gafol mid estfullum mode him agifan, þæt ure naman beon awritene on lifes bec mid his gecorenum.

Drihten wæs acenned on þære byrig ðe is gehaten Bethleem; forðan ðe hit wæs swa ár gewitegod þisum wordum, "Þu Bethleem, Iudeisc land, ne eart ðu wacost burga on Iudeiscum ealdrum: soðlice of ðe cymð se latteow þe gewylt Israhela ðeoda." Crist wolde on ytinge beon acenned, to ði þæt he wurde his ehterum bedigelod. Bethleem is gereht 'Hlaf-hús,' and on hire wæs Crist, se soða hlaf, acenned, þe be him sylfum cwæð, "Ic eom se liflica hláf, þe of heofenum astáh, and se ðe of ðam hlafe geett ne swylt hé on ecnysse." Þæs hlafe we onbyriað þonne we mid geleafan to husle gað; forðan þe þæt halige husel is gastlice Cristes lichama; and þurh ðone we beoð alysede fram ðam ecan deaðe. María acende ða hire frumcennedan sunu on ðisum andweardan dæge, and hine mid cild-claðum bewánd, and for rymetleaste on anre binne geléde. Næs þæt cild forði gecweden hire frumcennede cild swilce heo oðer siððan acende, ac forði þe Crist is frumcenned of manegum gastlicum gebroðrum. Ealle cristene men sind his gastlican gebroðra, and hé is se frumcenneda, on gife and on godcundnysse ancenned of ðam Ælmihtigan Fæder. Hé wæs mid wacum cild-claðum bewæfed, þæt he ús forgeafe ða undeadlican tunecan, þe we forluron on ðæs frumsceapenan mannes forgægednysse. Se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu, ðe heofenas befon ne mihton, wæs geled on nearuwre binne, to ði þæt he ús fram hellicum nyrwette alyse. María wæs ða cuma ðær, swa swa þæt godspel ús segð; and for ðæs folces geðryle wæs þæt gesthus ðearle genyrwed.

Se Godes Sunu wæs on his gesthuse genyrwed, þæt he us rume wununge on heofonan rice forgife, gif we his willan gehyrsumiað. Ne bitt hé us nánes ðinges to edleane his geswinces, buton ure sawle hælo, þæt we ús sylfe clæne and ungewemmede him gegearcian, to blisse and to ecere myrhðe. Þa hyrdas ðe wacodon ofer heora eowode



on Cristes acennednysse, getacnodon ða halgan lareowas on Godes gelaðunge, þe sind gastlice hyrdas geleaffulra sawla: and se engel cydde Cristes acennednysse hyrdemannum, forðam ðe ðan gastlicum hyrdum, þæt sind lareowas, is swiðost geopenod embe Cristes meniscnysse, þurh boclice lare; and hī sceolon gecneordlice heora underþeoddum bodian, þæt þæt him geswutelod is, swa swa ða hyrdas þa heofenlican gesihðe gewiðmærsodan. Þam lareowe gedafenað þæt hé symle wacol sy ofer Godes eowode, þæt se ungesewenlica wulf Godes scep ne tostence.

Gelóme wurdon englas mannum æteowode on ðære ealdan æ, ac hit nis awriten þæt hī mid leohte comon, ac se wurðmynt wæs þises dæges mærdæ gehealden, þæt hī mid heofenlicum leohte hī geswutelodon, ðaða þæt soðe leoht aspráng on ðeostum riht geþancodum, se mildheorta and se rihtwisa Drihten. Se engel cwæð to þam hyrdum, "Ne beo ge afyrhte; efne ic bodige eow micelne gefean, ðe eallum folce becymð, forðan þe nu to-dæg is acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre." Soðlice hé bodade micelne gefean, seðe næfre ne geendað; forðan þe Cristes acennednys gegladode heofenwara, and eorðwara, and helwara. Se engel cwæð, "Nu to-dæg is eow acenned Hælend Crist on Dauides ceastre:" Rihtlice hé cwæð on dæge, and ná on nihte, forðan ðe Crist is se soða dæg, seðe todraefde mid his to-cyme ealle nytennysse þære ealdan nihte, and ealne mid-dangeard mid his gife onlihte. Þæt tacen þe se engel ðam hyrdum sæde we sceolon symle on urum gemynde healdan, and þancian ðam Hælende þæt he gemedemode hine sylfne to ðan þæt hé dælnimend wære ure deadlicnysse, mid menniscum flæsce befangen, and mid wáclicum cild-claðum bewunden. Þa færllice, æfter þæs engles spræce, wearð gesewen micel menigu heofenlices werodes God herigendra and singendra, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb þam mannum þe beoð godes willan." An engel bodade þam hyrdum þæs heofonlican Cyniges acennednysse, and ða færllice wurdon æteowode fela ðusend engla, þy læs ðe wære gepuht anes engles ealdordom to hwonlic to swa micelre bodunge: and hī ealle samod mid gedremum sange Godes wuldor hleoðrodon, and godum mannum sibbe bodedon, swutellice æteowiende þæt þurh his acennednysse men beoð gebigede to anes geleafan sibbe, and to wuldre godcundlicere herunge. Hī sungon, "Sy wuldor Gode on heannyssum, and on eorðan sibb mannum, ðam ðe beoð godes willan." Ðas word geswutelíað þæt ðær wunað Godes sibb þær se

goda willa bið. Eornostlice mancynn hæfde ungeþwærnyse to englum ær Drihtnes acennednyse; forðan ðe we wæron þurh synna ælfremede fram Gode; þa wurde we eac ælfremede fram his englum getealde: ac siððan se heofenlica Cyning urne eorðlican lichaman underfeng, siððan gecyrdon his englas to ure sibbe; and ða ðe hī ærðan untrume forsawon, þa hi wurðiað nu him to geferum. Witodlice on ðære ealdan æ, Loð, and Iosue, and gehwilce oðre þe englas gesawon, hī luton wið heora, and to him gebædon, and ða englas þæt geðafodon: ac Iohannes se Godspellere, on ðære Niwan Gecyðnyse, wolde hine gebiddan to þam engle þe him to spræc, þa forwyrnde se engel him ðæs, and cwæð, "Beheald þæt ðu ðas dæde ne dó; ic eom ðin efen-ðeowa, and ðinra gebroðra; gebide ðe to Gode anum." Englas gepafodon ær Drihtnes to-cyme þæt mennisce men him to feollon, and æfter his to-cyme þæs forwyrndon; forðan þe hī gesáwon þæt heora Scyppend þæt gecynd underfeng þe hī ær ðan wáclíc tealdon, and ne dorston hit forseon on ús, þonne hī hit wurðiað bufon him sylfum on ðam heofonlican Cyninge. Ne hī manna geferrædene ne forhógiað, þonne hī feallende hī to þam menniscum Gode gebiddað. Nu we sind getealde Godes ceaster-gewaran, and englum gelíce; uton forði hógian þæt leahtras us ne totwæmon fram ðisum micclum wurðmynte. Soðlice men syndon godas gecigede; heald forði, ðu mann, þinne godes wurðscipe wið leahtras; forðan þe God is geworden mann for ðe.

Þa hyrdas ða spræcon him betweenan, æfter ðæra engla framfærelde, "Uton gefaran to Bethléem, and geseon þæt word þe geworden is, and God us geswutelode." Eala hū rihtlice hī andetton þone halgan geleafan mid þisum wordum, "On frymðe wæs wórd, and þæt word wæs mid Gode, and þæt wórd wæs God"! Word bið wisdomes geswutelung, and þæt Word, þæt is se Wisdom, is acenned of ðam Ælmihtigum Fæder, butan anginne; forðan ðe hé wæs æfre God of Gode, Wisdom of ðam wisan Fæder. Nis hé na geworht, forðan ðe he is God, and na gesceaft; ac se Ælmihtiga Fæder gesceop þurh ðone Wisdom ealle gesceafta, and hi ealle ðurh þone Halgan Gast gelífæste. Ne mihte ure mennisce gecynd Crist on ðære godcundlican acennednyse geseon; ac þæt ylce Word wæs geworden flæsc, and wunode on ús, þæt we hine geseon mihton. Næs þæt Word to flæsce awend, ac hit wæs mid menniscum flæsce befangen. Swa swa anra gehwilc manna wunað on sawle and on lichaman án mann, swa eac Crist wunað on godcundnyse and menniscnyse, on ánum hade án

Crist. Hí cwædon, "Uton geseon þæt word þe geworden is," forðan ðe hí ne mihton hit geseon ær ðan ðe hit geflæschamod wæs, and to menn geworden. Nis þeahhwæðre seo godcundnys gemenged to ðære menniscnysse, ne ðær nan twæming nys. We mihton eow secgan ane lytle bysne, gif hit to wáclíc nære; Sceawa nú on anum æge, hú þæt hwite ne bið gemenged to ðam geolcan, and bið hwæðere án æg. Nis eac Cristes godcundnys gerunnen to ðære menniscnysse, ac he þurhwunað þeah á on ecnysse on anum hade untotwæmed.

Hrædlice ða comon þa hyrdas and gemetton Marian and Ioseph, and þæt cild geléd on ðære binne. Maria wæs be Godes dihte þam rihtwisan Iosepe beweddod, for micclum gebeorge; forðan ðe hit wæs swa gewunelic on Iudeiscre ðeode, æfter Moyses æ, þæt gif ænig wimman cild hæfde butan be rihtre æwe, þæt hí man sceolde mid stanum oftorfian. Ac God asende his engel to Iosepe, ða María eacnigende wæs, and bead þæt he hire gymene hæfde, and þæs cildes foster-fæder wære. Þa wæs geðuht ðam Iudeiscum swilce Ioseph þæs cildes fæder wære, ac hé næs; forðan þe hit næs nan neod þam Ælmihtigum Scyppende þæt hé of wífe acenned wære; ac hé genam ða menniscnysse of Marían innoðe, and forlet hí mæden na gewemmed, ac gehalgod þurh his acennednysse. Ne oncneow heo weres gemanan, and heo acende butan sare, and þurhwunað on mægðhade. Þa hyrdas gesawon, and oncneowon be ðam cilde, swa swa him gesæd wæs. Nis nan eadignys butan Godes oncnawennesse, swa swa Crist sylf cwæð ðaða he us his Fæder betæhte, "Þæt is ece líf, þæt hi ðe oncnawon soðne God, and ðone ðe þu asendest Hælend Crist." Hwæt ða ealle ða ðe þæt gehyrdon micclum ðæs wundrodon, and be ðam ðe ða hyrdas sædon. María soðlice heold ealle ðas wórd aræfniende on hire heortan. Heo nolde widmærsian Cristes digelnesse, ac anbidode oð þæt he sylf þaða he wolde hí geopenode. Heo cuðe Godes æ, and on ðæra witegena gesetnysse rædde, þæt mæden sceolde God acennan. Þa blissode heo micclum þæt heo hit beon moste. Hit wæs gewitegod þæt hé on ðære byrig Bethleem acenned wurde, and heo ðearle wundrode þæt heo æfter ðære witegunge ðær acende. Heo gemunde hwæt sum witega cwæð, "Se oxa oncneow his hlaford, and se assa his hlafordes binne." Þa geseah heo þæt cild licgan on binne, ðær se oxa and se assa gewunelice fodan secað. Godes heah-engel Gabríhel bodode Marían ðæs Hælendes to-cyme on hire innoðe, and heo geseah ða þæt his bodung unleaslice gefylled wæs. Ðyllice word María heold aræfnigende on hire heortan. And þa hyrdas gecyrdon

ongean wuldrigende and herigende God, on eallum ðam ðingum ðe hí gehyrdon and gesáwon, swa swa him gesæd wæs.

Þyssera ðreora hyrda gemynd is gehæfd be eastan Bethleem áne mile, on Godes cyrcan geswutelod, þam ðe ða stowe geneosiað. We sceolon geefenlæcan þysum hyrdum, and wuldrian and hérian urne Drihten on eallum ðam ðingum þe he for ure lufe gefremode, ús to alysednysse and to ecere blisse, ðam sy wuldor and lof mid ðam Ælmihtigum Fæder, on annysse þæs Halgan Gastes, on ealra worulda woruld. Amen.

# PASSIO BEATI STEPHANI, PROTOMARTYRIS

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

We rædað on ðære béc þe is geháten Actus Apostolorum, þæt ða apostolas gehádodon seofon diaconas on ðære gelaðunge þe of Iudeiscum folce to Cristes geleafan beah, æfter his ðrowunge, and áriste of deaðe, and upstige to heofenum. Þæra diacona wæs se forma Stephanus, þe we on ðisum dæge wurðiað. He wæs swiðe geleafful, and mid þam Halgum Gaste afylled. Þa oðre six wæron gecigede ðisum namum: Stephanus wæs se fyrmesta, oðer Philippus, þridda Procorus, feorða Nicanor, fifta Timotheus, sixta Parmenen, seofða Nicolaus. Ðas seofon hí gecuron and gesetton on ðæra apostola gesihðe, and hi ða mid gebedum and bletsungum to diaconum gehadode wurdon. Weox ða dægghwonlice Godes bodung, and wæs gemenigfylld þæt getel cristenra manna þearle on Hierusalem. Þa wearð se eadiga Stephanus mid Godes gife, and mid micelre strençðe afylled, and worhte forebeacena and micle tácsa on ðam folce. Ða astodon sume ða ungeleaffullan Iudei, and woldon mid heora gedwylde þæs eadigan martyres láre oferswiðan; ac hi ne mihton his wisdomes wiðstandan, ne ðam Halgum Gaste, ðe ðurh hine spræc. Þa setton hí lease gewitan, ðe hine forlugon, and cwædon, þæt hé tállice word spræce be Moyse and be Gode. Þæt folc wearð ða micclum astyred, and þa heafod-menn, and þa Iudeiscan boceras, and gelahton Stephanum, and tugon to heora geþeahhte; and ða leasan gewitan him on besædon, "Ne geswicð ðes man to sprecenne tallice word ongean þas halgan stowe and Godes æ. We gehyrdon hine secgan þæt Crist towyrpð þas stowe, and towent ða gesetnysse ðe ús Moyses tæhte." Þa beheoldon ða hine ðe on þam geðeahhte sæton,

and gesawon his nebwlite swylce sumes engles ansyne. Ða cwæð se ealdor-biscop to ðam eadigan cyðere, "Is hit swa hí secgað?" Ða wolde se halga wer Stephanus heora ungeleaffullan heortan gerihtlæcan mid heora forðfædera gebysnunge and gemynde, and to soðfæstnysse wege mid ealre lufe gebigan. Begann ða him to recenne be ðam heahfædere Abrahame, hu se heofenlica God hine geceas him to gepoftan, and him behet, þæt ealle ðeoda on his ofspringe gebletsode wurdon, for his gehyrsumnesse. Swa eac ðæra oðra heahfædera gemynd, mid langsumere race, ætforan him geniwode; and hu Moy-ses, ðurh Godes mihte, heora forengan ofer ða Readan Sæ wundorlice gelædde, and hú hí siððan feowertig geara on westene wæron, mid heofenlicum bigleofan dæghwonlice gereordode; and hu God hí lædde to ðam Iudeiscan earde, and ða hæðenan ðeoda ætforan heora gesihðum eallunga adwæscte; and be Dauides mærdæ, þæs mæran cyninges, and Salomones wuldre, ðe Gode þæt mære tempel arærde. Cwæð þa æt nextan, "Ge wiðstandað þam Halgum Gaste mid stiðum swuran, and ungeleaffulre heortan; ge sind meldan and manslagan, and ge ðone rihtwisan Crist niðfullice acwealdon; ge underfengon æ on engla gesetnysse, and ge hit ne heoldon." Hwæt ða Iudeiscan þa wurdon þearle on heora heortan astyrode, and biton heora teð him togeanes. Se halga Stephanus wearð þa afylled mid þam Halgum Gaste, and beheold wið heofonas weard, and geseah Godes wuldor, and þone Hælend standende æt his Fæder swiðran; and he cwæð, "Efne ic geseo heofenas opene, and mannes Sunu standende æt Godes swiðran." Iudei ða, mid micelre stemne hrymende, heoldon heora earan, and anmodlice him to scuton, and hi hine gelæhton, and of ðære byrig gelæddon to stænenne. Þa leas-gewitan ða lédon heora hacelan ætforan fotum sumes geonges cnihtes, se wæs geciged Saulus. Ongunnon ða oftorfian mid heardum stanum ðone eadigan Stephanum; and hé clypode, and cwæð, "Drihten Hælend, onfóh minne gast." And gebigde his cneowu, mid micelre stemne clypigende, "Min Drihten, ne sete ðu ðas dæda him to synne." And hé mid þam worde ða gewát to ðan Ælmihtigum Hælende, þe he on heofenan healicne standende geseah.

Se wisa Augustinus spræc ymbe ðas rædinge, and smeade hwí se halga cyðere Stephanus cwæde þæt he gesawe mannes bearn standan æt Godes swyðran, and nolde cweðan Godes bearn; þonne ðe is gepuht wurðlicor be Criste to cweðenne Godes Bearn ðonne mannes Bearn. Ac hit gedafenode þæt se Hælend swa geswutelod wære on

heofenum, and swa gebodod on middangearde. Eall ðæra Iudeiscra teona aras þurh þæt, hwí Drihten Crist, seðe æfter flæsce soðlice is mannes Sunu, eac swilce wære gecweden Godes Sunu? forði gemunde swiðe gedafenlice þæt godcunde gewrit, mannes Sunu standan æt Godes swiðran to gescyndenne þæra Iudeiscra úngeleaffulnysse. Crist wæs æteowed his eadigan cyðere Stephane on heofenum, seðe fram ungeleaffullum on middangearde acweald wæs, and seo heofenlice soðfæstnyss be ðam cydde gecyðnysse, þone seo eorðlice arleasnyss huxlice tælde. Hwá mæg beon rihtlice gecígged mannes Bearn, buton Criste anum, þonne ælc man is twegra manna bearn, buton him anum? Se eadiga Stephanus geseah Crist standan, forðan þe he wæs his gefylsta on ðam gastlicum gefeohte his martyrdomes. Witodlice we andettað on urum credan, þæt Drihten sitt æt his Fæder swiðran. Setl gedafenað déman, and steall fylstendum oððe feohtendum. Nu andet ure geleafa Cristes setl, forðan ðe hé is se soða déma lybbendra and deadra: and se eadiga cyðere Stephanus hína geseah standende, forðan ðe he wæs his gefylsta, swa swa we ár sædon. Ealra gecorenra halgena deað is deorwurðe on Godes gesiðde; ac ðeah-hwæðere is gepuht, gif ænig todál beon mæg betwux martyrum, þæt se is healicost seðe ðone martyrdom æfter Gode astealde. Witodlice Stephanus wæs to diacone gehádod æt ðæra apostola handum; ac hé hí forestóp on heofenan rice mid sigefæstum deaðe; and swa se ðe wæs neoðor on endebyrdnysse, wearð fyrrest on ðrowunge; and se ðe wæs leorning-cniht on háde, ongann wesan láreow on martyrdomes. ðone deað soðlice þe se Hælend gemedemode for mannum þrowian, ðone ageaf Stephanus fyrrest manna þam Hælende. He is gecweden protomartyr, þæt is se forma cyðere, forðan ðe hé æfter Cristes ðrowunge ærest martyrdom geðrowode. Stephanus is Grecisc nama, þæt is on Leden, Coronatus, þæt we cweðað on Englisc, Gewuldorbeagod; forðan ðe hé hæfð þone ecan wuldorbeah, swa swa his nama him forewítegode. Þa leasan gewitan, ðe hine forsædon, hína ongunnon ærest to torfienne; forðan þe Moyses æ tæhte, þæt swa hwá swa oðerne to deaðe forsæde, sceolde wurpan ðone forman stán to ðam ðe hé ær mid his tungan acwealde. Ða reðan Iudei wedende þone halgan stándon: and hé clypode, and cwæð, "Drihten, ne sete ðu ðas dáda him to synne."

Understandað nu, mine gebroðra, þa micclan lufe þæs eadigan weres. On deaðe hé wæs gesett, and ðeah he bæd mid soðre lufe for his cwelleras; and betwux ðæra stana hryre, ðaða gehwá mihte his le-

ofostan frynd forgytan, ða betæhte hé his fynd Gode, þus cweðende, "Drihten, ne sete þu ðas dæda him to synne." Swiðor he besorgade þa heora synna þonne his agene wunda; swiðor heora arleasnysse þonne his sylfes deað; and rihtlice swiðor, forðan ðe heora arleasnysse fyligde se eca deað, and þæt ece líf fyligde his deaðe. Saulus heold ðæra leasra gewitena reaf, and heora mod to þære stæninge geornlice tihte. Stephanus soðlice gebigedum cneowum Drihten bæd þæt hé Saulum alysde. Wearð ða Stephanes bén fram Gode gehyred, and Saulus wearð alysed. Se árfæsta wæs gehyred, and se arleasa wearð gerihtwisod.

On ðyssere dæde is geswutelod hu micclum fremige þære soðan lufe gebed. Witodlice næfde Godes gelaðung Paulum to lareowe, gif se halga martyr Stephanus swa ne bæde. Efne nú Paulus blissað mid Stephane on heofenan rice; mid Stephane hé bricð Cristes beorhtnysse, and mid him hé rixað. Þider ðe Stephanus forestóp, mid Saules stanum oftorfod, ðider folgode Paulus gefultumod þurh Stephanes gebedu. Þær nis Paulus gescynd þurh Stephanes slege, ac Stephanus gladað on Paules gefærrædene; forðan þe seo soðe lufu on heora ægðrum blissað. Seo soðe lufu oferwann ðæra Iudeiscra reðnysse on Stephane, and seo ylce lufu oferwreah synna micelnysse on Paule, and heo on heora ægðrum samod gearnode heofenan rice. Eornostlice seo soðe lufu is wylspring and ordfruma ealra godnyssa and æðele trumnys, and se weg þe læt to heofonum. Se ðe færð on soðre lufe ne mæg hé dwelian, ne forhtian: heo gewissað, and gescylt, and gelæt. Þurh þa soðan lufe wæs þes halga martyr swa gebyld þæt he bealdlice ðæra Iudeiscra ungeleaffulnysse ðreade, and he órsorh betwux ðam greatum hagolstanum þurhwunode; and he for ðam stænendum welwillende gebæd, and þær to-eacan ða heofenlican healle cucu and gewuldorbeagod inn-ferde.

Mine gebroðra, uton geefenlæcan be sumum dæle swa miccles lareowes geleafan, and swa mæres cyðeres lufe. Uton lufian ure gebroðra on Godes gelaðunge mid swilcum mode swa swa ðes cyðere þa lufode his fynd. Beoð gemyndige hwæt seo sylfe Soðfæstnys on ðam halgan godspelle behét, and hwilc wedd us gesealde. Se Hælend cwæð, "Gif ge forgyfað þam mannum þe wið eow agyltað, þonne forgyfð eow eower Fæder eowere synna: gif ge ðonne nellað forgyfan, nele eac eower Fæder eow forgifan eowere gyltas." Ge gehyrað nu, mine gebroðra, þæt hit stent þurh Godes gyfe on urum agenum dihte hu ús bið æt Gode gedémed. He cwæð, "Gif ge forgyfað, eow



bið forgyfen." Ne bepæce nán man hine sylfne: witodlice gif hwa furðon ænne man hatað on ðisum middangearde, swa hwæt swa he to góde gedéð, eal he hit forlyst; forðan ðe se apostol Paulus ne bið geligenod, þe cwæð, "Þeah ðe ic aspende ealle mine æhta on ðearfena bigleofan, and ðeah ðe ic minne agenne lichaman to cwale gelylle, swa ðæt ic forbyrne on martyrdome; gif ic næbbe ða soðan lufe, ne fremað hit me nan ðing." Be ðan ylcan cwæð se godspellere Iohannes, "Seðe his broðor ne lufað, he wunað on deaðe." Eft hé cwæð, "Ælc ðæra þe his broðor hatað is manslaga." Ealle we sind gebroðra þe on God gelyfað, and we ealle cweðað, "Pater noster qui es in celis," þæt is, "Ure Fæder þe eart on heofonum." Ne gedyrstlæce nan man be mægðhade, butan soðre lufe. Ne truwiges nan man be ælmesdædum oððe on gebedum, butan ðære foresædan lufe; forðan ðe swa lange swa hé hylt ðone sweartan nið on his heortan, ne mæg he mid nanum ðinge þone mildheortan God gegladian. Ac gif he wille þæt him God milde sý, þonne hlyste hé gódes rædes, na of minum muðe, ac of Cristes sylfes: he cwæð, "Gif ðu offrast ðine lác to Godes weofode, and þu þær gemyndig bist þæt ðin broðor hæfð sum ðing on gearweorðe, forlæt ðærrihte ða lác ætforan ðam weofode, and gang ærest to þinum breðer, and þe to him gesibsuma; and ðonne ðu eft cymst to ðam weofode, geoffra ðonne ðine lác." Gif ðu ðonne þinum cristenum breðer deredest, þonne hæfð he sum ðing on gearweorðe, and þu scealt be Godes tæcunge hine gegladian, ær ðu ðine lác geoffrige. Gif ðonne se cristena mann, þe ðin broðor is, ðe ahwar geyfelode, þæt ðu scealt miltsigende forgyfan. Ure gastlican lác sind ure gebedu, and lofsang, and husel-halgung, and gehwilce oðre lác ðe we Gode offriað, þa we sceolon mid gesibsumere heortan and broðerlicere lufe Gode betæcan. Nu cwyð sum man on gearweorðe ðas rædinge, Ne mæg ic minne feond lufian, ðone ðe ic dæghwonlice wælhreowne togeanes me geseo. Eala ðu mann, þu sceawast hwæt ðin broðor þe dyde, and þu ne sceawast hwæt ðu Gode gedydest. Ponne ðu micle swærran synna wið God gefremodest, hwí nelt ðu forgyfan ða lytlan gyltas anum menn, þæt se Ælmihtiga God þe ða micclan synna forgyfe? Nu cwyst ðu eft, Micel gedeorf bið me þæt ic minne feond lufige, and for ðone gebidde þe me hearmes cepð. Ne wiðcweðe we þæt hit micel gedeorf ne sy; ac gif hit is hefigtyme on ðyssere worulde, hit becymð to micelre mede on ðære toweardan. Witodlice þurh ðines feondes lufe þu bist Godes freond; and na þæt an þæt ðu his freond sy, ac eac swilce þu bist Godes bearn, þurh ða rædene þæt þu þinne feond lu-

fige; swa swa Crist sylf cwæð, "Lufiað eowere fynd, doð þam tela þe eow hatiað, þæt ge beon eoweres Fæder cild, seðe on heofenum is." Menigfealde earfoðnyssa and hospas wolde gehwá eaðelice forberan wið þan þæt he moste sumum rican men to bearne geteald beon, and his yrfenuma to gewitendlicum æhtum: forberað nu geðyldelice for ðam ecan wurðmynte, þæt ge Godes bearn getealde beon, and his yrfenuman on heofenlicum spedum, þæt þæt se oðer forðyldigan wolde for ateorigendlicere edwiste.

We secgað eow Godes riht; healdað gif ge willon. Gif we hit forsuwiað, ne bið us geborgen. Cristes lufu us neadað þæt we simle þa góðan tihton, þæt hí on gódnysse þurhwunion; and ða yfelan we mynegiað, þæt hí fram heora yfelnessum hrædlice gecyrron. Ne beo se rihtwisa gymeleas on his anginne, ne se yfela ortruwige ðurh his unrihtwisnysse. Ondræde se goda þæt hé fealle; hogige se yfela þæt hé astande. Se ðe yfel sy geefenlæce hé Paules gecyrrednysse; se ðe gód sy þurhwunige hé on gódnysse mid Stephane; forðan ðe ne bið nán anginn herigendlic butan godre geendunge. Ælc lof bið on ende gesungen.

Mine gebroðra, gyrstan-dæg gemedemode ure Drihten hine sylfne, þæt hé ðysne middangeard þurh soðe menniscnysse geneosode: nu to-dæg se æðela cempa Stephanus, fram lichamlicere wununge gewitende, sigefæst to heofenum ferde. Crist niðer-astáh, mid flæsce bewæfed; Stephanus up-astáh, þurh his blod gewuldorbeagod. Gyrstan-dæg sungon englas "Gode wuldor on heannyssum;" nu to-dæg hí underfengon Stephanum blissigende on heora geferrædene, mid þam hé wuldrað and blissað á on ecnysse. Amen.

# ASSUMPTIO SANCTI IOHANNIS APOSTOLI

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

Iohannes se Godspellere, Cristes dyrling, wearð on ðysum dæge to heofenan rices myrhðe, þurh Godes neosunge, genumen. He wæs Cristes moddrian sunu, and he hine lufode synderlice; na swa micclum for ðære mæglican sibbe swa for ðære clænnysse his ansundan mægðhades. He wæs on mægðháde Gode gecoren, and hé on ecnysse on ungewemmedum mægðhade þurhwunode. Hit is geræd on gewyrdelicum racum þæt hé wolde wífian, and Críst wearð to his gyftum gelaðod. Þa gelámp hit þæt æt ðam gyftum wín wearð ateorod. Se Hælend ða het þa ðenig-men afyllan six stænene fatu mid hluttrum wætere, and he mid his bletsunge þæt wæter to æðelum wine awende. Þis is þæt forme tácn ðe hé on his menniscnysse openlice geworhte. Þa wearð Iohannes swa onbryrd þurh þæt tácn, þæt hé ðærrihte his bryde on mægðhade forlét, and symle syððan Drihtne folgode, and wearð ða him inweardlice gelufod, forðan ðe he hine ætbræd þam flæsclicum lustum. Witodlice ðisum leofan leorningcnihte befæste se Hælend his modor, þaþa hé on rode hengene mancynn alysde; þæt his clæne líf ðæs clænan mædenes Marian gymde, and heo ða on hyre swyster suna ðenungum wunode.

Eft on fyrste, æfter Cristes upstige to heofonum, rixode sum wælhreow casere on Romana ríce, æfter Nerone, se wæs Domicianus gehaten, cristenra manna ehtere: se het afyllan ane cyfe mid wealendum ele, and þone mæran godspellere þæron het bescufan; ac he, ðurh Godes gescyldnysse, ungewemmed of ðam hatum bæðe eode. Eft ðaða se wæltreowa ne mihte ðæs eadigan apostoles bodunge alecgan, þa asende he hine on wræcsið to anum igeoðe þe is

Paðmas geciged, þæt he ðær þurh hungres scearpnysse acwæle. Ac se Ælmihtiga Hælend ne forlét to gymeleaste his gelufedan apostol, ac geswutelode him on ðam wræcsiðe þa towearðan onwrigenyssse, be ðære hé awrat ða bók ðe is gehaten Apocalipsis : and se wælhreowa Domicianus on ðam ylcan geare wearð acweald æt his witenahandum; and hí ealle anmodlice ræddon þæt ealle his gesetnyssa aydlode wæron. Þa wearð Nerua, swiðe arfæst man, to casere gecoren. Be his geðafunge gecyrde se apostol ongearð mid micclum wurðmynte, seðe mid hospite to wræcsiðe asend wæs. Him urnon ongearð weras and wif fægnigende, and cweðende, "Gebletsod is se ðe com on Godes naman."

Mid þam ðe se apostol Iohannes stop into ðære byrig Ephesum, þa bær man him togeanes anre wydewan líc to byrigenne; hire nama wæs Drusiana. Heo wæs swiðe gelyfed and ælmesgeorn, and þa ðearfan, ðe heo mid cystigum mode eallunga afedde, dreorige mid wópe ðam líce folgodon. Ða het se apostol ða bære settan, and cwæð, "Min Drihten, Hælend Crist! Arære ðe, Drusiana; aris, and gecyrr ham, and gearca ús gereordunge on þinum huse." Drusiana þa arás swilce of slæpe awreht, and, carfull be ðæs apostoles hæse, ham gewende.

On ðam oðrum dæge eode se apostol be ðære stræt, þa ofseah he hwær sum uðwita lædde twegen gebroðru, þe hæfdon behwyrfd eall heora yldrena gestreon on deorwurðum gymstanum, and woldon ða tocwysan on ealles þæs folces gesihðe, to wæfersyne, swylce to forsewennysse woruldlicra æhta. Hit wæs gewunelic on ðam timan þæt ða ðe woldon woruld-wisdom gecneordlice leornian, þæt hí behwyrfdon heora are on gymstanum, and ða tobræcon; oððe on sumum gyldenum wecge, and ðone on sá awurpan; þilæs ðe seo smeaug þæra æhta hí æt þære lare hremde. Þa clypode se apostol ðone uðwitan Graton him to, and cwæð, "Dyslic bið þæt hwa woruldlice speda forhogige for manna hérunge, and beo on Godes dome geniðerod. Ydel bið se læcedom þe ne mæg ðone untruman gehælan; swa bið eac ydel seo lár ðe ne gehæld ðære sawle leahtras and unðeawas. Soðlice min lareow Crist sumne cniht ðe gewilnode þæs ecan lifes þysum wordum lærde, þæt he sceolde ealle his welan beceapian, and þæt wurð ðearfum dælan, gif hé wolde fulfremed beon, and he syððan hæfde his goldhord on heofenum, and ðær to eacan þæt ece líf." Graton ða se uðwita him andwyrde, "Þas gymstanas synd tocwysede for ydelum gylpe, ac gif ðin lareow is soð God, gefeg ðas bricas to ansundnysse, þæt heora wurð mæge þear-

fum fremian." Iohannes þa gegaderode ðæra gymstana bricas, and beseah to heofonum, þus cweðende, "Drihten Hælend, nis ðe nan ðing earfoðe; þu ge-edstaðelodest ðisne tobrocenan middangeard on þinum geleaffullum, þurh tácen þære halgan rode; ge-edstaðela nu þas deorwurðan gymstanas, ðurh ðinra engla handa, þæt ðas nyte-nan menn þine mihta oncnáwon, and on þe gelyfon." Hwæt, ða fær-lice wurdon ða gymstanas swa ansunde, þæt furðon nan tácen þære ærran tocwysednysse næs gesewen. Þa se uðwita Graton samod mid þam cnihtum feoll to Iohannes fotum, gelyfende on God. Se apostol hine fullode mid eallum his hirede, and hé ongann Godes geleafan openlice bodian. Þa twegen gebroðra, Atticus and Eugenius, sealdon heora gymstanas, and ealle heora æhta dældon wædlum, and filigdon þam apostole, and micel menigu geleaffulra him eac to geðeodde.

Þa becom se apostol æt sumum sæle to þære byrig Pergamum, þær ða foresædan cnihtas iú ær eardodon, and gesawon heora ðe-owan mid godewebbe gefreatewode, and on woruldlicum wuldre sci-nende. Ða wurdon hí mid deofles flan þurhscotene, and dreorige on mode, þæt hí wædligende on ánum waclicum wæfelse ferdon, and heora ðeowan on woruldlicum wuldre scinende wæron. Þa undergeat se apostol ðas deoflican facn, and cwæð, "Ic geseo þæt eower móð is awend, and eower andwlita, forðan ðe ge eowre speda þear-fum dældon, and mines Drihtnes lare fyligdon: gað nu forði to wuda, and heawað incre byrðene gyrda, and gebringað to me." Hí dydon be his hæse, and hé on Godes naman ða grenan gyrda gebletsode, and hí wurdon to readum golde awende. Eft cwæð se apostol Iohannes, "Gað to ðære sæ-strande, and feccað me papolstanas." Hí dydon swa; and Iohannes þa on Godes mægenðrymme hí gebletsode, and hí wurdon gehwyrfede to deorwurðum gymmum. Þa cwæð se apostol, "Gað to smiððan, and fandiað þises goldes and ðissera gymstana." Hí ða eodon, and eft comon, þus cweðende, "Ealle ðas goldsmiðas secgað þæt hí næfre ær swa clæne gold, ne swa read ne gesawon: eac ðas gym-wyrhtan secgað þæt hi næfre swa deorwurðe gymstanas ne gemetton." Þa cwæð se apostol him to, "Nimað þis gold, and ðas gymstanas, and farað, and bicgað eow land-ære; forðan þe ge forluron ða heofenlican speda. Bicgað eow pællene cyrtlas, þæt ge to lytelre hwile scinon swa swa róse, þæt ge hrædlice forweornion. Beoð blowende and welige hwilwendlice, þæt ge ecelice wædlion. Hwæt la, ne mæg se Ælmihtiga Wealdend þurhteon þæt hé do his

ðeowan rice for worulde, genihtsume on welan, and unwiðmetenlice scinan? Ac he sette gecámp geleaffullum sawlum, þæt hi gelyfon to geagenne þa ecan welan, ða ðe for his naman þa hwilwendan speda forhógiað. Ge gehældon untruman on þæs Hælendes naman, ge aflugdon deoflu, ge forgeafon blindum gesihðe, and gehwilce uncoðe gehældon: efne nu is ðeos gifu eow ætbroden, and ge sind earmingas gewordene, ge ðe wæron mære and strange. Swa micel ege stod deoflum fram eow, þæt hí be eowere hæse þa ofsettan deofolseocan forleton; nu ge ondrædað eow deoflu. Þa heofenlican æhta sind us eallum gemæne. Nacode we wæron acennede, and nacode we gewitað. Þære sunnan beorhtnys, and þæs monan leoht, and ealra tungla sind gemæne þam rican and ðam heanan. Rén-scuras, and cyrcan duru, fulluht, and synna forgyfenys, huselgang, and Godes neosung, sind eallum gemæne, earmum and eadigum: ac se ungesæliga gytsere wile mare habban þonne him genihtsumað, þonne he furðon orsorh ne bricð his genihtsumnysse. Se gytsere hæfð ænne lichaman, and menigfealde scrúd; he hæfð ane wambe, and þusend manna bigleofan: witodlice þæt he for gytsunge úncyste nanum oðrum syllan ne mæg, þæt he hordað, and nat hwam; swa swa se witega cwæð, 'On ídel bið ælc man gedrefed, seðe hordað, and nat hwam he hit gegaderað.' Witodlice ne bið he þæra æhta hlaford, þonne he hi dælan ne mæg; ac he bið þæra æhta ðeowa, þonne he him eallunga þeowað; and þær to-eacan him weaxað untrumnyssa on his lichaman, þæt hé ne mæg ætes oððe wætes brucan. Hé carað dæges and nihtes þæt his feoh gehealden sy; hé gymð grædelice his teolunge, his gafoles, his gebytl; he berypð þa wánnspedigan, he fulgæð his lustum and his plegan; þonne færlice gewitt he of ðissere worulde, nacod and forscyldigod, synna ana mid him ferigende; forðan þe he sceal éce wíte ðrowian."

Efne ðaða se apostol þas lare sprecende wæs, ða bær sum wuduwe hire suna lic to bebyrgenne, se hæfde gewifod þritigum nihtum ær. Seo dreorige modor þa samod mid þam licmannum rarigende hí astrehte æt þæs halgan apostoles fotum, biddende þæt he hire sunu on Godes naman arærde, swa swa he dyde þa wydewan Drusianam. Iohannes ða ofhreow þære meder and ðæra licmanna dreorignysse, and astrehte his lichaman to eorðan on langsumum gebede, and ða æt nextan arás, and eft up-ahafenum handum langlice bæd. Þaða he ðus ðriwa gedón hæfde, ða het he unwindan þæs cnihtes líc, and cwæð, "Eala ðu cniht, ðe þurh ðines flæscs lust hrædlice ðine

sawle forlure; eala þu cniht, þu ne cuðest ðinne Scyppend; þu ne cuðest manna Hælend; þu ne cuðest ðone soðan freond; and forði þu beurne on þone wyrstan feond. Nu ic ageat mine tearas, and for ðinre nyttenysse geornlice bæd, þæt þu of deaðe arise, and þisum twam gebroðrum, Attico and Eugenio, cyðe hū micel wuldor hī forluron, and hwilc wite hī geearnodon." Mid ðam þa arás se cniht Stacteus, and feoll to Iohannes fotum, and begann to ðreagenne þa gebroðru þe miswende wæron, þus cweðende, "Ic geseah þa englas, þe eower gymdon, dreorige wepan, and ða awyrigedan sceoccan blissigende on eowerum forwyrde. Eow wæs heofenan rice gearo, and sciende gebytlum mid wistum afyllede, and mid eowum leohte: þa ge forluron þurh unwærscipe, and ge begeaton eow ðeosterfulle wununga mid dracum afyllede, and mid brastligendum ligum, mid unasec-gendlicum witum afyllede, and mid anðræcum stencum; on ðam ne ablinð granung and þoterung dæges oþþe nihtes: biddað forði mid inweardre heortan ðysne Godes apostol, eowerne lareow, þæt he eow fram ðam eowum forwyrde arære, swa swa he me fram deaðe arærde; and he eowre saula, þe nu synd adylegode of þære liflican béc, gelæde eft to Godes gife and miltsunge."

Se cniht þa Stacteus, ðe of deaðe arás, samod mid þam gebroðrum, astrehte hine to Iohannes fótswaðum, and þæt folc forð mid ealle, anmodlice biddende þæt he him to Gode geþingode. Se apostol þa be-bead ðam twam gebroðrum þæt hi ðritig daga be hreowsunge dædbetende Gode geoffrodon, and on fæce geornlice bædon, þæt ða gylde-nan gyrda eft to þan ærran gecynde awendon, and þa gymstanas to heora wacnysse. Æfter ðritigra daga fæce, þa þa hī ne mihton mid heora benum þæt gold and þa gymstanas to heora gecynde awendan, ða comon hi mid wope to þam apostole, þus cweðende, "Symle ðu tæhtest mildheortnysse, and þæt man oðrum miltsode; and gif man oðrum miltsað, hu micle swiðor wile God miltsian and arian mannum his hand-geweorc! Þæt þæt we mid gitsigendum eagum agylton, þæt we nu mid wependum eagum bereowsiað." ða andwyrde se apostol, "Berað ða gyrda to wuda, and þa stanas to sære-strande: hi synd gecyrrede to heora gecynde." Þaða hi þis gedon hæfdon, ða underfengon hi eft Godes gife, swa þæt hi adræfdon deoflu, and blinde, and untrume gehældon, and fela tacna on Drihtnes naman gefremedon, swa swa hi ær dydon.

Se apostol þa gebigde to Gode ealne þone eard Asiam, se is geteald to healfan dæle middan-eardes; and awrat ða feorðan Cristes béc,

seo hrepað swyðost ymbe Cristes godcundnysse. Ða oðre þry god-spelleras, Matheus, Marcus, Lucas, awriton æror be Cristes menniscnysse. Ða asprungon gedwolmenn on Godes gelaðunge, and cwædon þæt Crist nære ær he acenned wæs of Marian. Ða bædon ealle þa leod-bisceopas ðone halgan apostol þæt he þa feorðan bōc gesette, and þæra gedwolmanna dyrstignesne adwæscte. Iohannes þa beað ðreora daga fæsten gemænlice; and he æfter ðam fæstene wearð swa miclum mid Godes gaste afylled, þæt he ealle Godes englas, and ealle gesceafta, mid heahlicum mode oferstāh, and mid ðysum wordum þa godspellican gesetnysse ongan, "In principio erat uerbum, et uerbum erat apud Deum, et Deus erat uerbum, et reliqua:" þæt is on Englisc, "On frymðe wæs word, and þæt word wæs mid Gode, and þæt word wæs God; þis wæs on frymðe mid Gode; ealle ðing sind þurh hine geworhte, and nis nan þing buton him gesceapen." And swa forð on ealre þære godspellican gesetnysse, he cydde fela be Cristes godcundnysse, hu he ecelice butan angynne of his Fæder acenned is, and mid him rixað on annysse þæs Halgan Gastes, á butan ende. Feawa he awrat be his menniscnysse, forðan þe þa ðry oðre godspelleras genihtsumlice be þam heora bec setton.

Hit gelamp æt sumum sæle þæt þa deofolgyldan þe þa gýt ungeleaffulle wæron, gecwædon þæt hi woldon þone apostol to heora hæðenscipe geneadian. Ða cwæð se apostol to ðam hæðengyldum, "Gað ealle endemes to Godes cyrcan, and clypiað ealle to eowerum godum, þæt seo cyrce afealle ðurh heora mihte; ðonne buge ic to eowerum hæðenscipe. Gif ðonne eower godes miht þa halgan cyrcan towurpan ne mæg, ic towurpe eower tempel þurh ðæs Ælmihtigan Godes mihte, and ic tocwyse eower deofolgyld; and bið þonne rihtlic geðuht þæt ge geswycon eoweres gedwyldes, and gelyfon on ðone soðan God, se ðe ana is Ælmihtig." Ða hæðengyldan ðisum cwyde geðwærlæhton, and Iohannes mid geswæsum wordum þæt folc tihte, þæt hí ufor eodon fram þam deofles temple; and mid beorhtre stemne ætforan him eallum clypode, "On Godes naman ahreose þis tempel, mid eallum þam deofolgyldum þe him on eardiað, þæt þeos menigu tocnawe þæt ðis hæðengyld deofles biggeng is." Hwæt ða færlice ahreas þæt tempel grundlunga, mid eallum his anlicnyssum to duste awende. On ðam ylcan dæge wurdon gebigede twelf ðusend hæðenra manna to Cristes geleafan, and mid fulluhte gehalgode.

Ða sceorede ða gyt se yldesta hæðengylda mid mycelre þwyrnysse, and cwæð þæt he nolde gelyfan buton Iohannes attor drunce, and



þurh Godes mihte ðone cwelmbæran drenc oferswiðde. Ða cwæð se apostol, "Þeah þu me attor sylle, þurh Godes naman hit me ne derað." Ða cwæð se hæðengylða Aristodemus, "Þu scealt ærest oðerne geseon drincan, and ðærrihte cwelan, þæt huru ðin heorte swa forhtige for ðam deadbærum drenc." Iohannes him andwyrde, "Gif ðu on God gelyfan wylt, ic unforhtmod ðæs drences onfó." Ða getengde se Aristodemus to ðam heahgerefan, and genám on his cwearterne twegen ðeofas, and sealde him ðone unlybban ætforan eallum ðam folce, on Iohannes gesihðe; and hi ðærrihte æfter þam drenc gewiton. Syððan se hæðengylða eac sealde ðone attorbæran drenc þam apostole, and hé mid rodetacne his muð, and ealne his lichaman gewæpnode, and ðone unlybban on Godes naman halsode, and siððan mid gebildum mode hine ealne gedranc. Aristodemus ða and þæt folc beheoldon þone apostol ðreo tída dæges, and gesawon hine habban glædne andwlitan, buton blácunge and forhtunge; and hi ealle clypodon, "An soð God is, seðe Iohannes wurðað." Ða cwæð se hæðengylða to ðam apostole, "Gyt me tweonað; ac gif ðu ðas deadan sceaðan, on ðines Godes naman arærst, þonne bið min heorte geclænsod fram ælcere twynunge." Ða cwæð Iohannes, "Aristodeme, nim mine tunecan, and lege bufon ðæra deadra manna lic, and cweð, 'Þæs Hælendes Cristes apostol me asende to eow, þæt ge on his naman of deaðe arison, and ælc man oncnáwe þæt deað and líf ðeowiað minum Hælende.'" He ða be ðæs apostoles hæse bær his tunecan, and alede uppon ðam twám deadum; and hí ðærrihte ansunde arison. Ða ða se hæðengylða þæt geseah, ða astrehte he hine to Iohannes fotum, and syððan ferde to ðam heahgerefan, and him ða wundra mid hluddre stemne cydde. Hí ða begen þone apostol gesohton, his miltsunge biddende. Ða bead se apostol him seofon nihta fæsten, and hi siððan gefullode; and hi æfter ðam fulluhte towurpon eall heora deofolgyld, and mid heora maga fultume, and mid eallum cræfte arærdon Gode mære cyrcan on ðæs apostoles wurðmynte.

Ða ða se apostol wæs nigon and hund-nigontig geara, þa æteowode him Drihten Crist mid þam oðrum apostolum, þe hé of ðisum life genumen hæfde, and cwæð, "Iohannes, cum to me; tima is þæt þu mid ðinum gebroðrum wistfullige on minum gebeorscipe." Iohannes þa arás, and eode wið þæs Hælendes; ac he him to cwæð, "Nu on sunnan-dæg, mines æristes dæge, þu cymst to me:" and æfter ðam worde Drihten gewende to heofenum. Se apostol micclum blissode on ðam beháte, and on þam sunnan-uhtan ærwacol to ðære cyrcan

com, and þam folce, fram hancrede oð undern, Godes gerihta lærde, and him mæssan gesang, and cwæð þæt se Hælend hine on ðam dæge to heofonum gelaðod hæfde. Het ða delfan his byrgene wið þæt weofod, and þæt greot ut-awegan. And hé eode cucu and gesund into his byrgene, and astrehtum handum to Gode clypode, "Drihten Crist, ic þancige ðe þæt þu me gelaðodest to þinum wistum: þu wást þæt ic mid ealre heortan þe gewilnode. Oft ic ðe bæd þæt ic moste to ðe faran, ac ðu cwæde þæt ic anbidode, þæt ic ðe mare folc gestrynde. Þu heolde minne lichaman wið ælce besmittennysse, and þu simle mine sawle onlihtest, and me nahwar ne forlete. Þu settest on minum muðe þinre soðfæstnysse word, and ic awrat ða lare ðe ic of ðinum muðe gehyrde, and ða wundra ðe ic ðe wyrcan geseah. Nu ic ðe betæce, Drihten! þine bearn, ða ðe þin gelaðung, mæden and moder, þurh wæter and þone Halgan Gast, ðe gestrynde. Onfoh me to minum gebroðrum mid ðam ðe ðu come, and me gelaðodest. Geopena ongean me lifes geat, þæt ðæra ðeostra ealdras me ne gemeton. Þu eart Crist, ðæs lifigendan Godes Sunu, þu þe be ðines Fæder hæse middangeard gehældest, and us ðone Halgan Gast asendest. Þe we heriað, and þanciað þinra menigfealdra goda geond ungeendode worulde. Amen."

Æfter ðysum gebede æteowode heofenlic leoht bufon ðam apostole, binnon ðære byrgene, ane tid swa beorhte scinende, þæt nanes mannes gesihð þæs leohtes leoman sceawian ne mihte; and he mid þam leohte his gast ageaf þam Drihtne þe hine to his rice gelaðode. He gewát swa freoh fram deaðes sarnysse, of ðisum andweardan life, swa swa he wæs ælfremed fram lichamlicere gewemmednysse. Soðlice syððan wæs his byrgen gemet mid mannan afylled. Manna wæs gehaten se heofenlica mete, þe feowertig geara afedde Israhela folc on westene. Nu wæs se bigleofa gemett on Iohannes byrgene, and nan ðing elles; and se mete is weaxende on hire oð ðisne andweardan dæg. Pær beoð fela tacna æteowode, and untrume gehælde, and fram eallum frecednyssum alysed, þurh ðæs apostoles ðingunge. Pæs him getiðað Drihten Crist, þam is wuldor and wurðmynt mid Fæder and Halgum Gaste, á butan ende. Amen.

# NATALE INNOCENTIIUM INFANTUM

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

Nu to-dæg Godes gelaðung geond ealne ymbhwyrft mærsað þæra eadigra cildra freols-tide, þe se wælhreowa Herodes for Cristes acennednysse mid arleasre ehtnysse acwealde, swa swa us seo god-spellice racu swutellice cyð.

Matheus awrat, on þære forman Cristes bec, ðysum wordum be ðæs Hælendes gebyrd-tide, and cwæð, "Þaða se Hælend acenned wæs on þære Iudeiscan Bethleem, on Herodes dagum cyninges, efne ða comon fram east-dæle middangeardes þry tungel-witegan to ðære byrig Hierusalem, þus befrinende, Hwær is Iudeiscra leoda Cyning, seðe acenned is? We gesawon soðlice his steorran on east-dæle, and we comon to ði þæt we ús to him gebiddon. Hwæt ða Herodes cyning þis gehyrende wearð micclum astyred, and eal seo burhwaru samod mid him. He ða gesamnode ealle þa ealdor-biscopas, and ðæs folces boceras, and befran hwær Cristes cennungstów wære. Hí sædon, on ðære Iudeiscan Bethleem. Þus soðlice is awriten þurh ðone witegan Micheam, Eala þu Bethleem, Iudeisc land, ne eart ðu nateshwón wacost burga on Iudeiscum ealdrum: of ðe cymð se Heretoga seðe gewylt and gewissað Israhela folc. Ða clypode Herodes þa ðry tungel-witegan on sunder-spræce, and geornlice hí befrán to hwilces timan se steorra him ærst æteowode, and asende hí to Bethleem, ðus cweðende, Farað ardlice, and befrínað be ðam cilde, and þonne ge hit gemetað, cyðað me, þæt ic máge me to him gebiddan. Þa tungel-witegan ferdon æfter þæs cyninges spræce, and efne ða se steorra, þe hí on east-dæle gesawon, glad him beforan, oð þæt he gestód bufon ðam gesthúse, þær þæt cild on wunode. Hi gesáwon ðone steorran,

and pearle blissodon. Eodon ða inn, and þæt cild gemetton mid Marian his meder, and niðerfeallende hí to him gebádon. Hi geopenodon heora hórdfatu, and him lác geoffrodon, gold, and recels, and myrram. Hwæt ða God on swefne hí gewarnode and bebead þæt hi eft ne cyrdon to ðan reðan cyninge Herode, ac þurh oðerne weg hine forcyrdon, and swa to heora eðele becomon. Efnē ða Godes engel æteowode Iosepe, ðæs cildes foster-fæder, on swefnum, cweðende, 'Arís, and nim þis cild mid þære meder, and fleoh to Egypta lánde, and beo þær oð þæt ic þe eft secge: soðlice toweard is þæt Herodes smeað hú hé þæt cild fordó.' Ioseph ða arás nihtes, and þæt cild mid þære meder samod to Egypta lánde ferede, and þær wunode oð þæt Herodes gewát; þæt seo witegung wære gefylled, þe be ðære fare ær ðus cwæð, Of Egypta lánde ic geclypode minne sunu."

Nu secgað wyrd-writeras þæt Herodes betwux ðisum wearð gewréged to þam Romaniscan casere, þe ealne middangeard on þam timan geweold. Þa gewende he to Rome, be ðæs caseres hæse, þæt he hine betealde, gif he mihte. Þa betealde he hine swiðe geaplice, swa swa he wæs snotorwyrde to ðan swiðe, þæt se casere hine mid maran wurðmynte ongear to Iudeiscum rice asende. Þa þa he ham com, þa gemunde he hwæt he ær be ðan cilde gemynte, and geseah þæt he wæs bepæht fram ðam tungel-witegum, and wearð þa ðearle gegremod. Sende ða his cwelleras, and ofsloh ealle ða hyse-cild, þe wæron on þære byrig Bethleem, and on eallum hyre gemærum, fram twywintrum cilde to anre nihte, be ðære tide þe hé geaxode æt ðam tungel-witegum. Þa wæs gefylled Hieremias witegung, þe ðus witegode, "Stemn is gehyred on heannysse, micel wóp and ðoterung: Rachel beweop hire cildru, and nolde beon gefrefrod, forðan ðe hi ne sind."

On ðam twelftan dæge Cristes acennednysse comon ða ðry tungel-witegan to Herode, and hine axodon be ðam acennedan cilde; and þa þa hí his cennung-stowe geaxodon, þa gewendon hí wið þæs cildes, and noldon ðone reðan cwellere eft gecyrran, swa swa he het. Þa ne mihte he forbugan þæs caseres hæse, and wæs ða, þurh his langsume fær, þæra cildra slege geuferod swiðor þonne he gemynt hæfde; and hí wurdon ða on ðysum dægperlicum dæge wuldorfullice gemartyrode; na swa-þeah þæs gearas þe Crist acenned wæs, ac æfter twegra geara ymbryne æfter ðæs wælhreowan hamcyme.

Næs hé æðelboren, ne him naht to þam cynecynne ne gebyrode; ac mid syrewungum and swicdome he becom to ðære cynelican

geðincðe; swa swa Moyses be ðam awrát, þæt ne sceolde ateorian þæt Iudeisce cynecynn, oþþæt Crist sylf come. Ða com Crist on ðam timan þe seo cynelice mæigð ateorode, and se ælfremeda Herodes þæs rices geweold. Ða wearð he micclum afyrht and anðracode þæt his rice feallan sceolde, þurh to-cyme þæs soðan cyninges. Ða clypode hé ða tungel-witegan on sunder-spræce, and geornlice hí be-frán, on hwilcne timan hí ærest þone steorran gesawon; forðan ðe he ondred, swa swa hit gelamp, þæt hí eft hine ne gecyrdon. Ða het he forðy acwellan ealle ða hyse-cild þære burhscire, fram twywintrum cilde oð anre nihte: ðohte gif he hí ealle ofsloge, þæt se án ne ætburste þe he sohte. Ac he wæs ungemyndig þæs halgan gewrites, ðe cwyð, "Nis nán wisdom, ne nán ræd naht ongean God."

Se swicola Herodes cwæð to ðam tungel-witegum, "Farað, and geornlice befrinað be ðam cilde, and cyðað me, þæt ic eac mage me to him gebiddan." Ac he cydde syððan his facenfullan syrewunge, hu he ymbe wolde, gif he hine gemette, ðaða he ealle his efenealdan adylegode for his anes ehtnysse. Pearflæs he syrwe ymbe Crist: ne com he forðy þæt he wolde his eorðlice rice, oþþe æniges oðres cyninges mid riccetere him to geteon; ac to ði hé com þæt he wolde his heofenlice rice geleaffullum mannum forgyfan. Ne com he to ðy þæt he wære on mærlicum cynesetle ahafen, ac þæt he wære mid hospe on rode hengene genæglod. He wolde ðeah þæs wælhreowan syrewunge mid fleame forbugan, na forði þæt he deað forfluge, seðe sylfwilles to ðrowienne middangearde genealæhte; ac hit wære to hrædlíc, gif he ða on cild-cradole acweald wurde, swilce ðonne his to-cyme mancynne bedíglod wære; þi forhradode Godes engel þæs arleasan geþeaht, and beþead þæt se foster-fæder þone heofenlican æþeling of ðam earde ardlice ferede.

Ne forseah Crist his geongan ceman, ðeah ðe he lichamlice on heora slege andwerd nære; ac hé asende hí fram þisum wræcfullum life to his ecan rice. Gesælige hí wurdon geborene þæt hi moston for his intingan deað þrowian. Eadig is heora yld, seoðe þa gyt ne mihte Crist andettan, and moste for Criste þrowian. Hí wæron þæs Hælendes gewitan, ðeah ðe hí hine ða gyt ne cuðon. Næron hí gerípode to slege, ac hi gesæliglice þeah swulton to life. Gesælig wæs heora acennednys, forðan ðe hí gemetton þæt ece lif on instæpe þæs andweardan lifes. Hí wurdon gegripene fram moderlicum breostum, ac hi wurdon betæhte þærrihte engellicum bosmum. Ne mihte se mánfulla ehtere mid nanre ðenunge þam lytlingum swa mic-

clum fremian, swa micclum swa hé him fremode mid ðære reðan ehtnysse hatunge. Hí sind gehátene martyra blostman, forðan ðe hí wæron swá swá up-aspringende blostman on middeweardan cyle ungeleaffulnysse, swilce mid sumere ehtnysse forste forsodene. Eadige sind þa innoðas þe hí gebæron, and ða breost þe swylce gesihton. Witodlice ða modдру on heora cildra martyrdome þrowodon; þæt swurd ðe þæra cildra lima þurh-árn becóm to ðæra moddra heortan; and neod is þæt hí beon efenhlyttan þæs ecan edleanes, þonne hí wæron geferan ðære ðrowunge. Hí wæron gehwæde and ungewitige acwealde, ac hí arisað on þam gemænelicum dome mid fullum wæstmæ, and heofenlicere snoternysse. Ealle we cumað to anre ylde on þam gemænelicum æriste, þeah ðe we nu on myslicere ylde of þyssere worulde gewiton.

Þæt godspel cweð þæt Rachel beweóp hire cildra, and nolde beon gefrefrod, forðan þe hí ne sind. Rachel hatte Iacobes wif, ðæs heah-fæderes, and heo getacnode Godes gelaðunge, þe bewypð hire gastlican cild; ac heo nele swa beon gefrefrod, þæt hí eft to woruldlicum gecampe gehwyrfon, þa þe æne mid sygefæstum deaðe middangeard oferswiðdon, and his yrmða ætwundon to wuldorbeagienne mid Criste.

Eornostlice ne breac se arleasa Herodes his cynerices mid langsumere gesundfulnysse, ac buton yldinge him becom seo godcundlice wracu, þe hine mid menigfealdre yrmðe fordyde, and eac geswutelode on hwilcum suslum he moste æfter forðsiðe ecelice cwymlian. Hine gelæhte unasecgendlic adl; his lichama barn wiðutan mid langsumere hætan, and he eal innan samod forswæled wæs, and toborsten. Him wæs metes micel lust, ac ðeah mid nanum ætum his gyfernysse gefyllan ne mihte. He hriðode, and egeslice hweos, and angsumlice siccetunga teah, swa þæt hé earfoðlice orðian mihte. Wæter-seocnyss hine ofereode, beneoðan þam gyrdle, to ðan swiðe, þæt his gesceapu maðan weollon, and stincende attor singallice of ðam toswollenum fotum fleow. Unaberendlic gyhða ofereode ealne ðone lichaman, and ungelyfendlic toblawennys his innoð geswencte. Him stóð stincende steam of ðam muðe, swa þæt earfoðlice ænig læce him mihte genealæcan. Fela ðæra læca hé acwealde; cwæð þæt hí hine gehælan mihton and noldon. Hine gedrehte singal slæpleast, swa þæt he þurhwacole niht buton slæpe adreah; and gif hé hwon hnáppode, ðærrihte hine drehton nihtlice gedwímor, swa þæt him ðæs slæpes ofpuhte. Paða hé mid swiðlicum luste his lifes gewilnode,

þa hét hé hine ferigan ofer ða eá Iordanen, ðærþær wæron gehæfde háte baðu, þe wæron halwende gecwedene adligendum lichaman. Wearð þa eac his læcum geðuht þæt hí on wlacum ele hine gebeðedon. Ac ðaða hé wæs on ðissere beðunge geléd, þa wearð se lichama eal toslopen, swa þæt his eagan wendon on gelicnysse sweltendra manna, and hé læg cwydeleas butan andgite. Eft ðaða he com, þa het he hine ferigan to ðære byrig Hiericho.

Þaþa he wearð his lifes orwene, þa gelaðode he him to ealle ða Iudeiscan ealdras of gehwilcum burgum, and het hí on cwearterne beclysan, and gelangode him to his swustur Salome and hire wer Alexandrum, and cwæð, "Ic wát þæt ðis Iudeisce folc micclum blisigan wile mines deaðes; ac ic mæg habban arwurðfulle líc-ðenunge of heofigendre menigu, gif ge willað minum bebodum gehyrsumian. Swa ricene swa ic gewíte, ofsleað ealle ðas Iudeiscan ealdras, ðe ic on cwearterne beclysde, þonne beoð heora siblingas to heofunge geneadode, þa ðe wyllað mines forðsiðes fagnian." He ða his cempa to ðam slege genamode, and het heora ælcum fiftig scyllinga to sceatte syllan, þæt hi heora handa fram ðam blodes gyte ne wiðbrudon. Þaða hé mid ormætre angsumnysse wæs gecwylmed, þa het he his agenne sunu Antípatrem arleaslice acwellan, to-eacan þam twam þe hé ær acwealde. Æt nextan, ðaða hé gefredde his deaðes nealæcunge, þa het he him his seax aræcan to screadigenne ænne æppel, and hine sylfne hetelice ðyde, þæt him on acwehte. Pyllic wæs Herodes forðsið, þe mánfullice ymbe þæs heofenlican æpelinges to-cyme syrwe, and his efen-ealdan lytlingas unsæððige arleaslice acwealde.

Efne ða Godes engel, æfter Herodes deaðe, æteowode Iosepe on swefnum, on Egypta lande, þus cweðende, "Arís, and nim þæt cild and his moder samod, and gewend ongean to Israhela lande; soðlice hí sind forðfarene, ðaðe ymbe þæs cildes feorh syrwdon." Hé ða arás, swa swa se engel him bebead, and feroðe þæt cild mid þære meder to Israhela lande. Þa gefrán Ioseph þæt Archelaus rixode on Iudea lande, æfter his fæder Herode, and ne dorste his neawiste genealæcan. Þa wearð he eft on swefne gemynegod þæt he to Galilea gewende, forðan ðe se eard næs ealles swa gehende þam cyninge, þeah ðe hit his rice wære. Þæt cild ða eardode on þære byrig þe is gehaten Nazareth, þæt seo wítegung wære gefylled, þe cwæð, þæt he sceolde beon Nazarenisc geciged. Se engel cwæð to Iosepe, "Þa sind forðfarene, þe embe ðæs cildes feorh syrwdon." Mid þam worde he geswutelode þæt má ðæra Iudeiscra ealdra embe Cristes cwale

smeadon; ac him getimode swiðe rihtlice þæt hī mid heora arleasan hlaforde ealle forwurdon.

Nelle we ðas race na leng teon, þylæs ðe hit eow æðryt þince; ac biddað eow þingunge æt þysum unscæððigum martyrum. Hi sind ða ðe Criste folgiað on hwitum gyrlum, swa hwider swa hé gæð; and hī standað ætforan his ðrymsetle, butan ælcere gewemmednysse, hæbbende heora palmtwigu on handa, and singað þone niwan lof-sang, þam Ælmihtigan to wurðmynte, seþe leofað and rixað á butan ende. Amen.



# OCTABAS ET CIRCUMCISIO DOMINI NOSTRI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Se Godspellere Lucas beleac þis dægþerlice godspel mid feawum wordum, ac hit is mid menigfealdre mihte þære heofenlican gerynu afylled. He cwæð, "Postquam consummati sunt dies octo ut circumcideretur puer, uocatum est nomen ejus Iesus, quod uocatum est ab angelo, priusquam in utero conciperetur." Þæt is on ure geðeode, "Æfter þan ðe wæron gefyllede ehta dagas Drihtnes acennednyse þæt he ymbsniden wære, þa wæs his nama geciged Iesus, þæt is Hælend, ðam naman he wæs geháten fram ðam engle, ærðam þe hé on innoðe geeacnod wære."

Abraham se heahfæder wæs ærest manna ymbsniden, be Godes hæse. Abraham wæs Godes gespreca, and God to him genam gepoftrædene æfter Noes flóde swiðost, and him to cwæð, "Ic eom Ælmihtig Drihten, gang beforan me, and beo fulfremed. And ic sette min wed betwux me and ðe; and ic ðe þearle gemenigfylde, and þu bist manegra þeoda fæder. Cyningas aspringað of ðe, and ic sette min wed betwux me and ðe, and þinum ofspringe æfter ðe, þæt ic beo ðin God and ðines ofspringes." Abraham hine astrehte eallum limum to eorðan, and God him to cwæð, "Heald þu min wed, and þin ofspring æfter ðe on heora mægðum. Ðis is min wed, þæt ge healðan sceolon betwux me and eow; þæt ælc hyse-cild on eowrum cynrene beo ymbsniden: þæt tácn sy betwux me and eow. Ælc hyse-cild, þonne hit eahta nihta eald bið, sy ymbsniden, ægðer ge æpelboren ge þeowetling; and seðe þis forgæið his sawul losað, forðan þe hé

min wed aýdlode. Ne beo ðu geciged heonon-forð Abram, ac Abraham, forðan þe ic gesette ðe manegra þeoda fæder. Ne ðin wif ne beo gehaten Saraí, ac beo gehaten Sarra; and ic hí gebletsige, and of hire ic ðe sylle sunu, þone ðu gecigest Isaac; and ic sette min wed to him and to his ofspringe on ecere fæstnunge. And æfter ðære spræce se Ælmihtiga up gewende." On þam ylcan dæge wæs Abraham ymsniden, and eal his hyred, and syððan his sunu Isaac, on ðam eahtoðan dæge his acennednysse.

Abrahames nama wæs æt fruman mid fif stafum gecweden, Abram, þæt is, 'Healic fæder'; ac God geyhte his naman mid twam stafum, and gehet hine Abraham, þæt is, 'Manegra ðeoda fæder'; forðan þe God cwæð, þæt he hine gesette manegum ðeodum to fæder. Saraí wæs his wif gehaten, þæt is gereht, 'Min ealdor,' ac God hi het syððan Sarra, þæt is, 'Ealdor,' þæt heo nære synderlice hire hiredes ealdor geciged, ac forðrihte 'Ealdor'; þæt is to understandenne ealra gelyfedra wifa moder. Hund-teontig geara wæs Abraham, and his gebedda hund-nigontig, ærðan ðe him cild gemæne wære. Þaða him cild com, þa com hit mid Godes foresceawunge and bletsunge to þan swiðe, þæt God behet eallum mancynne bletsunge þurh his cynn. Ða heold Abrahames cynn symle syððan Godes wed; and se here-toga Moyses, and eal Israhela mægð ealle hi ymsnidon heora cild on þam eahtoðan dæge, and him naman gesceopon, oð þæt Crist on menniscnysse acenned wearð, se ðe fulluht astealde, and ðære ealdan æ getacnunge to gastlicere soðfæstnysse awende.

Wén is þæt eower sum nyte hwæt sy ymsnidennys. God bebead Abrahame, þæt he sceolde and his ofspring his wed healdan; þæt sum tacn wære on heora lichaman to geswutelunge þæt hi on God be-lyfdon, and het þæt he náme scarepcedne flint, and forcurfe sumne dæl þæs felles æt foreweardan his gesceape. And þæt tacn wæs ða swa micel on geleaffullum mannum, swa micel swa nu is þæt halige fulluht, buton ðam anum þæt nan man ne mihte Godes rice gefaran, ærðan þe se come þe ða ealdan æ sette, and eft on his andwerdnysse hí to gastlicum þingum awende: ac gehwylce halgan andbidodon on Abrahames wununge buton tintregum, þeah on helle-wite, oðþæt se Alysend com, þe ðone ealdan deofol gewylde, and his gecorenan to heofenan rice gelædde.

Se ylca Hælend, þe nu egefullice and halwendlice clypað on his godspelle, "Buton gehwa beo ge-edcenned of wætere and of þam Halgum Gaste, ne mæg he faran into heofenan rice," se ylca clypode

gefyrrn þurh ða ealdan æ, "Swa hwylc hyse-cild swa ne bið ymb-sniden on þam fylmene his flæsces his sawul losað, forðan þe he ayd-lode min wed." Þis tacen stóð on Godes folce oð þæt Crist sylf com, and he sylf wæs þære halgan æ underþeod þe he gesette, þæt he ða alydsde þe neadwislice ðære æ underþeodde wæron. He cwæð þæt he ne cōme to ðy þæt he wolde þa ealdan æ towurpan, ac gefyllan. Þa wearð he on þam eahtoðan dæge his gebyrd-tide lichamlice ymb-sniden, swa swa he sylf ær tæhte; and mid þam geswutelode þæt seo ealde æ wæs halig and gód on hire timan, þam ðe hire gehyrsume wæron. Hit wæs gewunelic þæt þa magas sceoldon þam cilde naman gescyppan on ðam eahtoðan dæge mid þære ymb-snidennysse, ac hí ne dorston nænne oðerne naman Criste gescyppan þonne se heah-engel him gesette, ærðan þe hé on his modor innoðe geeacnod wære, þæt is, Iesus, and on urum gereorde, Hælend, forðan ðe he gehæld his folc fram heora synnum.

Nis nu alyfed cristenum mannum þæt hi þas ymb-snidennysse lichamlice healdan, ac þeah-hwæðere nan man ne bið soðlice cristen, buton he ða ymb-snidennysse on gastlicum ðeawum gehealde. Hwæt getacnað þæs fylmenes of-cyrf on ðam gesceape, buton galnysse wununge? Eaðe mihte þes cwyde beon læwedum mannum bediglod, nære seo gastlice getacning. Hit ðincð ungelæredum mannum dyselig to gehyrenne; ac gif hit him dyslic þince, þonne cide he wið God, þe hit gesette, na wið us, þe hit secgað. Ac wite gehwa to gewisan, buton he his flæsclican lustas and galnysse gewanige, þæt he ne hylt his cristendóm mid rihtum biggenge. Be ðysum ðinge ge habbað oft gehyred, ac us is acumendlicere eower gebel, þonne þæs Ælmihtigan Godes grama, gif we his bebodu forsuwiað. Gif ge willað æfter menniscum gesceade lybban, þonne sind ge gastlice ymb-snidene; gif ge þonne eowere galnysse underþeodde beoð, þonne beo ge swa se witega cwæð, "Se mann ðaða he on wurðmynte wæs he hit ne understod; he is forðy wiðmeten stuntum nytenum, and is him gelíc geworden."

Forðy sealde God mannum gesceád, þæt hi sceoldon oncnawan heora Scyppend, and mid biggenge his beboda þæt ece lif geearnian. Witodlice se fyrenfulla bið earmra ðonne ænig nyten, forðan þe þæt nyten næfð nane sawle, ne næfre ne ge-educað, ne þa toweardan wita ne ðrowað. Ac we ðe sind to Godes anlicnysse gesceapene, and habbað únateorigendlice saule, we sceolon of deaðe arísan, and agyl-dan Gode gescead ealra ura geðohta, and worda, and weorca. Ne

sceole we forðy sinderlice on anum lime beon ymbsnidene, ac we sceolon ða fulan galnysse symle wanian, and ure eagan fram yfelre gesi-hðe awendan, and earan from yfelre heorcunge; urne mûð fram lea-sum spræcum, handa fram mándædum; ure fotwylmas fram dead-bærum siðfæte, ure heortan fram facne. Gif we swa fram leahtrum ymbsnidene beoð, þonne bið ús geset níwe nama; swa swa se wítega Isaías cwæð, "God gecígð his ðeowan oðrum naman." Eft se ylca wítega cwæð, "Þu bist gecígged niwum naman, þone ðe Godes mûð genemnode." Se níwa nama is 'Cristianus,' þæt is, Cristen. Ealle we sind of Criste cristene gehátene, ac we sceolon ðone arwurðful-lan naman mid æðelum þeawum geglangan, þæt we ne beon lease cristene. Gif we ðas gastlican ymbsnidennysse on urum ðeawum healdað, þonne sind we Abrahames cynnes, æfter soðum geleafan; swa swa se þeoda lareow Paulus cwæð to geleaffullum, "Gif ge sind Cristes, þonne sind ge Abrahames sáed, and æfter behate yrfenuman." Petrus eac se apostol tihte geleaffulle wíf to eadmodnysse and gemet-fæstnysse, ðus cweðende, "Swa swa Sarra gehyrsumode Abrahame, and hine hlaford het, ðære dohtra ge sind, wel donde and na ondræ-dende ænige gedrefednysse."

Se eahtoða dæg, þe þæt cild on ymbsniden wæs, getacnode ða eah-toðan ylde ðyssere worulde, on þære we arisað of deaðe ascyrede fram ælcere brosnunge and gewemmednysse ures lichaman. Þæt stænene sex, þe þæt cild ymbsnað, getacnode ðone stán ðe se apos-tol cwæð, "Se stán soðlice wæs Crist." He cwæð wæs for ðære getac-nunge, na for edwiste. Purh Cristes geleafan, and hiht, and soðe lufe, beoð singallice estfulle heortan mid dæghwonlicere ymbsnidenysse afeormode fram leahtrum, and ðurh his gife onlihte.

We habbað oft gehyred þæt men hatað þysne dæg geares dæg, swylce þes dæg fyrrest sy on geares ymbryne; ac we ne gemetað nane geswutelunge on cristenum bocum, hwí þes dæg to geares anginne geteald sy. Þa ealdan Romani, on hæðenum dagum, ongun-non þæs geares ymbryne on ðysum dæge; and ða Ebreiscan leoda on lenctenlicere emnihte; ða Greciscan on sumerlicum sunstede; and þa Egyptiscan ðeoda ongunnon heora geares getel on hærfeste. Nu onginð ure gerím, æfter Romaniscre gesetnysse, on ðysum dæge, for nanum godcundlicum gesceade, ac for ðam ealdan gewunan. Sume ure ðening-béc onginnað on Aduentum Domini; nis ðeah þær forðy ðæs geares ord, ne eac on ðisum dæge nis mid nánum gesceade; þeah ðe ure gerím-béc on þissere stówe ge-edlæcon. Rihtlicost bið geðuht

þæt þæs gearæs anginn on ðam dæge sy gehæfd, þe se Ælmihtiga Scyppend sunnan, and mōnan, and steorran, and ealra tida anginn gesette; þæt is on þam dæge þe þæt Ebreisce folc heora gearæs getel onginnað; swa swa se heretoga Moyses on ðam ælicum bocum awrát. Witodlice God cwæð to Moysen be ðam monðe, "Þes monað is monða anginn, and he bið fyrrest on gearæs monðum." Nu heold þæt Ebreisce folc ðone forman gearæs dæg on lenctenlicere emnihte, forðan ðe on ðam dæge wurdon gearlice tida gesette.

Se eahteteoða dæg þæs monðes þe we hātað Martius, ðone ge hatað Hlyda, wæs se forma dæg ðyssere worulde. On ðam dæge worhte God leoht, and merigen, and æfen. Ða eódon þry dagas forð buton tida gemetum; forðan þe tunglan næron gesceapene, ær on þam feorðan dæge. On ðam feorðan dæge gesette se Ælmihtiga ealle tungla and gearlice tida, and hét þæt hí wæron to tacute dagum and gearum. Nu ongyrnað þa Ebreiscan heora gearæs anginn on þam dæge þe ealle tida gesette wæron, þæt is on ðam feorðan dæge woruldlicere gesceapenyse; and se lareow Beda telð mid micclum gesceade þæt se dæg is XII. K L , ðone dæg we freolsiað þam halgum were Benedick to wurðmynte, for his micclum geðincðum. Hwæt eac seo eorðe cyð mid hire ciðum, þe ðonne ge-edcuciað, þæt se tima is þæt rihtlicoste gearæs anginn, ðe hí on gesceapene wæron.

Nu wígliað stunte men menigfealde wígelunga on ðisum dæge, mid micclum gedwylde, æfter hæðenum gewunan, ongean heora cristendom, swylce hí magon heora líf gelengan, oppe heora gesundfulnyse, mid þam ðe hí gremiað þone Ælmihtigan Scyppend. Sind eac manega mid swa micclum gedwylde befangene, þæt hí cepað be ðam monan heora fær, and heora dæda be dagum, and nellað heora ðing wanian on monan-dæg, for anginne ðære wucan; ac se monan-dæg nis na fyrrest daga on þære wucan, ac is se oðer. Se sunnan-dæg is fyrrest on gesceapenyse and on endebyrdnyse, and on wurðmynte. Secgað eac sume gedwæsmenn þæt sum orfcyn sy þe man bletsigan ne sceole, and cweðað þæt hí þurh bletsunge misfarað, and ðurh wyrigunge geðeoð, and brucað þonne Godes gife him on teonan, buton bletsunge, mid deofles awyrigednyse. Ælc bletsung is of Gode, and wyrigung of deofle . God gesceop ealle gesceafta, and deofol nane gesceafta scyppan ne mæg, ac he is yfel tihtend, and leas wyrchend, synna ordfruma, and sawla bepæcend.

Þa gesceafta ðe sind þwyrlice geðuhte, hí sind to wrace gesceapene yfel-dædum. Oft halige men wunedon on westene betwux reðum

wulfum and leonum, betwux eallum deorcynne and wurmcynne, and him nan ðing derian ne mihte; ac hī totæron þa hyrnedan næddran mid heora nacedum handum, and þa micclan dracan eaðelice acwealdon, buton ælcere dare, þurh Godes mihte.

Wa ðam men þe brícð Godes gesceafta, buton his bletsunge, mid deofellicum wíglungum, þonne se ðeoda lareow cwæð, Paulus, "Swa hwæt swa ge doð on worde, oððe on weorce, doð symle on Drihtnes naman, þancigende þam Ælmihtigan Fæder þurh his Bearn." Nis þæs mannes cristendom naht, þe mid deoflicum wíglungum his líf adrihð; he is gehíwod to cristenum men, and is earm hæðengylða; swa swa se ylca apostol be swylcum cwæð, "Ic wene þæt ic swunce on ydel, ðaða ic eow to Gode gebigde: nu ge cepað dagas and monðas mid ydelum wíglungum."

Is hwæðere æfter gecynde on gesceapennysse ælc lichamlice gesceaft ðe eorðe acenð fulre and mægenfæstre on fullum monan þonne on gewanedum. Swa eac treowa, gif hī beoð on fullum monan geheawene, hī beoð heardran and langfærran to getimbrunge, and swiðost, gif hī beoð unsæpige geworhte. Nis ðis nan wíglung, ac is gecyndelic ðincg þurh gesceapennysse. Hwæt eac seo sæ wonderlice geþwærlæcð þæs monan ymbrene; symle hī beoð geferan on wæstm and on wanunge. And swa swa se mona dæghwonlice feower pricon lator arist, swa eac seo sæ symle feower pricum lator fleowð.

Uton besettan urne hiht and ure gesælða on þæs Ælmihtigan Scyppendes foresceawunge, seðe ealle gesceafta on ðrim ðingum gesette, þæt is on gemete, and on getele, and on hefe. Sy him wuldor and lof á on ecnysse. Amen.

# EPIPHANIA DOMINI

Ælfric's Catholic Homilies

Men ða leofostan, nu for feawum dagum we oferræddon þis godspel ætforan eow, þe belimpð to ðysses dæges ðenunge, for gerecednysse ðære godspellican endebyrdnysse; ac we ne hrepodon þone traht na swiðor þonne to ðæs dæges wurðmynte belámp: nu wille we eft oferyrnan þa ylcan godspellican endebyrdnysse, and be ðyssere andweardan freolstíde trahtnian.

Matheus se Godspellere cwæð, "Cum natus esset Iesus in Bethleem Iudæ, in diebus Herodis regis, ecce Magi ab oriente uenerunt Hierosolimam, dicentes, Ubi est qui natus est Rex Iudeorum?" et reliqua. "Þaða se Hælend acenned wæs on þære Iudeiscan Bethleem, on Herodes dagum cyninges, efne ða comon fram east-dæle middangeardes ðry tungel-witegan to ðære byrig Hierusalem, þus befrírende, Hwær is Iudeiscra leoda Cyning, se ðe acenned is?" etc.

Ðes dæg is gehaten Epiphania Domini, þæt is Godes geswutelung-dæg. On þysum dæge Crist wæs geswutelod þam ðrym cyningum, ðe fram east-dæle middangeardes hine mid þrimfealdum lacum gesohton. Eft embe geara ymbrynum hé wearð on his fulluhte on þysum dæge middangearde geswutelod, ðaða se Halga Gást, on culfran híwe, uppon him gereste, and þæs Fæder stemn of heofenum hlúde swegde, þus cweðende, "Þes is min leofa Sunu, þe me wél licað; gehyrað him." Eac on ðisum dæge he awende wæter to æðelum wine, and mid þam geswutelode þæt he is se soða Scyppend, þe ða gesceafta awendan mihte. For ðisum þrym ðingum is ðes freols-dæg Godes swutelung gecweden. On ðam forman dæge his gebyrd-tide he wearð æteowed þrym hyrdum on Iudeiscum earde, þurh ðæs engles bodunge. On ðam ylcum dæge he wearð gecydd þam ðrym tungel-witegum on east-dæle, þurh ðone beorhtan steorran; ac on þysum dæge hí comon mid heora lacum. Hit wæs gedafenlic þæt

se gesceadwisa engel hine cydde þam gesceadwisum Iudeiscum, ðe Godes æ cuðon, and ðam haðenum, þe ðæs godcundan gesceades nyston na ðurh stemne, ac ðurh tacn wære geswutelod.

Þa Iudeiscan hyrdas getácnodon ða gastlican hyrdas, þæt sind ða apostolas, þe Crist geceas of Iudeiscum folce, ús to hyrdum and to lareowum. Ða tungel-witegan, ðe wæron on hæðenscipe wuni- gende, hæfdon getacnunge ealles hæðenes folces, ðe wurdon to Gode gebígede þurh ðæra apostola láre, þe wæron Iudeiscre ðeode. Soðlice se sealm-sceop awrát be Criste, þæt hé is se hyrn-stan þe gefegð þa twegen weallas togædere, forðan ðe he geþeodde his gecorenan of Iudeiscum folce and þa geleaffullan of hæðenum, swilce twee- gen wagas to anre gelaðunge; be ðam cwæð Paulus se apostol, "Se Hælend bodade on his to-cyme sibbe us ðe feorran wáeron, and sibbe þam ðe gehende wáeron. He is ure sibb, seðe dyde ægðer to anum, towurpende ða árran feondscipas on him sylfum." Þa Iudeiscan ðe on Crist gelyfdon wæron him gehéndon stówlíce, and eac ðurh cyððe þære ealdan á: we wæron swiðe fyrlyne, ægðer ge stówlíce ge ðurh uncýððe; ac he us gegaderode mid ánum geleafan to ðam healicum hyrn-stane, þæt is to annysse his gelaðunge.

Ða easternan tungel-witegan gesáwon níwne steorran beorhtne, na on heofenum betwux oðrum tunglum, ac wæs ángenga betwux heofenum and eorðan. Ða undergeaton hí þæt se seldcuða tungel gebicnode þæs soðan Cyninges acennednysse, on ðam earde ðe he oferglád; and forði comon to Iudea rice, and þone arleasan cyning Herodem mid heora bodunge ðearle afærdon; forðan ðe buton tweon seo eorðlice arleasnys wearð gescynd, þaða seo heofenlice healicnyss wearð geopenod.

Swutol is þæt ða tungel-witegan tocneowon Crist soðne mann, ðaða hí befrunon, "Hwær is se ðe acenned is?" Hí oncneowon hine soðne Cyning, þaða hí cwædon, "Iudea Cyning." Hí hine wurðodon soðne God, þaða hí cwædon, "We comon to ðy þæt we us to him gebiddan." Eaðe mihte God hí gewissian þurh ðone steorran to ðære byrig þe þæt cild on wæs, swa swa he his acennednysse þurh ðæs steorran up-spring geswutelode; ac he wolde þæt ða Iudeiscan boceras ða witegunge be ðam ræddon, and swa his cennig-stowe geswutelodon, þæt hí gehealdene wæron, gif hí woldon mid þan tungel-witegum hí to Criste gebiddan: gif hí þonne noldon, þæt hí wurdon mid þære geswutelunge geniðerode. Þa tungel-witegan fer-



don and hí gebædon, and ða Iudeiscan boceras bæftan belifon, þe þa cennung-stowe þurh bôclíc gescead gebícnodon.

Ealle gesceafta oncneowon heora Scyppendes to-cyme, buton ðam arleasum Iudeiscum anum. Heofonas oncneowon heora Scyppend, ðaða hí on his acennednyssse níwne steorran æteowdon. Sá oncneow ðaða Crist mid drium fot-wylmum ofer hyre yða mihtelice eode. Sunne oncneow, þaþa heo on his ðrowunge hire leoman fram mid-dæge oð nón behydde. Stanas oncneowon, ðaða hí on his forðsiðe sticmælum toburston. Seo eorðe oncneow, ðaða heo on his æriste eall byfode. Hell oncneow, ðaða heo hire hæftlingas unðances forlet. And ðeah þa heard-heortan Iudei noldon for eallum ðam tacnum þone soðan Scyppend tocnáwan, þe þa dumban gesceafta undergeaton, and mid gebicnungum geswutolodon. Næron hí swa ðeah ealle endemes ungeleaffulle, ac of heora cynne wæron ægðer ge wítegan ge apostolas, and fela ðusenda gelyfedra manna.

Þaþa ða tungel-witegan þone cynning gecyrdon, þa wearð se steorra him ungesewen; and eft, ðaða hí to ðam cilde gecyrdon, þa gesawon hí eft ðone steorran, and he ða hí gelædde to þam huse, þær hé inne wunode. Ne glad hé ealne weig him ætforan, ac syððan hí comon to Iudeiscum earde, syððan he wæs heora latteow, oð þæt he bufan Cristes gesthuse ætstod.

Herodes hæfde deofles getacnunge; and se ðe fram Gode bichð to deofle he forlyst Godes gife, þæt is his modes onlihtinge, swa swa ða tungel-witegan ðone steorran forluron, ðaða hí ðone reðan cynning gecyrdon. Gif he ðonne eft þone deofol anrædlice forlæt, ðonne gemét hé eft þæs halgan Gastes gife, þe his heortan onliht, and to Criste gelæt.

Us is eac to witenne, þæt wæron sume gedwolmen ðe cwædon, þæt ælc man beo acenned be steorrena gesetnyssum, and þurh heora ymbryna him wyrd gelimpe, and námon to fultume heora gedwylde þæt níwe steorra asprang þaþa Drihten lichamlice acenned wearð, and cwædon þæt se steorra his gewyrd wære. Gewíte ðis gedwyld fram geleaffullum heortum, þæt ænig gewyrd sy, buton se Ælmihtiga Scyppend, seðe ælcum men foresceawað lif be his geearnungum. Nis se man for steorrum gesceapen, ac ða steorran sint mannum to nihtlicere lihtinge gesceapene. Þaða se steorra glád, and þa tungel-witegan gelædde, and him ðæs cildes inn gebícnode, ða geswutelode he þæt he wæs Cristes gesceaft, and rihtlice his Scyppende þenode: ac hé næs his gewyrd. Eft we biddað þæt nán geleafful man his ge-

leafan mid þisum gedwylde ne befyle. Witodlice Rebecca, Isaáces wíf, acende twegen getwysan, Iacob and Esau, on ánnre tide, swa þæt Iacob heold þone ylðran broðer Esau be ðam fét on ðære cenninge, and hi næron ðeah gelice on ðeawum, ne on lifes geearnungum. Witodlice þæt halige gewrit cwyð þæt God lufode Iacob, and hatode Esau; na for gewyrde, ac for mislicum geearnungum. Hit gelimpð forwel oft þæt on anre tíde acenð seo cwén and seo wyln, and ðeah geðicð se æðeling be his gebyrdum to healicum cynesetle, and ðære wylne sunu wunað eal his líf on ðeowte.

Nu cweðað oft stunte men þæt hi be gewyrde lybban sceolon, swylce God hí neadige to yfel-dædum! Ac we wyllað þyssera stuntra manna ydele leasunge adwæscan mid deopnysse godcundra gewrita. Se Ælmihtiga Scyppend gesceop englas þurh his godcundan mihte, and for his micclan rihtwisnysse forgeaf him agenne cyre, þæt hí moston ðurhwunian on ecere gesælðe ðurh gehyrsumnysse, and mihton eac ða gesælða forleosan, na for gewyrde, ac for ungehyrsumnysse. His deope rihtwisnys nolde hí neadian to naðrum, ac forgeaf him agenne cyre; forðan ðe þæt is rihtwisnys þæt gehwylcum sy his agen cyre geðafod. Þonne wære seo rihtwisnys awæged, gif he hí neadunge to his ðeowte gebigde, oððe gif he hí to yfelnysse bes-cufe. Ða miswendon sume þa englas heora agenne cyre, and þurh modignysse hy sylfe to awyrigedum deoflum geworhton.

Eft ðaða se ðrimwealdenda Scyppend mancyn geworhte, þa forgeaf hé Adame and Euan agenne cyre, swa hi, ðurh gehyrsumnysse, á on ecnysse, butan deaðe, on gesælðe wunodon, mid eallum heora ofspringe, swa hi, ðurh ungehyrsumnysse, deadlice wurdon. Ac ðaþa hí Godes bebod forgægdon, and þæs awyrigedan deofles lare gehyrsumodon, þa wurdon hi deadlice, and forscyldegode þurh agenne cyre, hí and eall heora ofspring; and ðeah ðe næfre ne wurde syððan mancynne gemiltsod, ðe má ðe ðam deoflum is, ðeah wære Godes rihtwisnys eallunga untæle. Ac eft seo miccle mildheortnys ures Drihtnes us alysdre þurh his menniscnysse, gif we his bebodum mid ealre heortan gehyrsumiað. Witodlice ða ðe nu þurh agenne cyre and deofles tihtinge God forlætað, God forlæt hí eac to ðam ecan for-wyrde.

Georne wiste se Ælmihtiga Scyppend, ærðan þe he þa gesceafta gesceope, hwæt toeward wæs. He cuðe gewislice getel ægðer ge gecorenra engla ge gecorenra manna, and eac ðæra modigra gasta and arleasra manna, þe ðurh heora arleasnysse forwurðað; ac he

ne forestihte nænne to yfelnyssse, forðan þe he sylf is eall gódnysse; ne hé nænne to forwyrde ne gestihthe, forðan ðe he is soð líf. He forestihte ða gecorenan to ðam ecan life, forðan ðe he wiste hí swilce towearde, þurh his gife and agene gehyrsumnysse. He nolde forestihtan þa arleasan to his rice, forðan ðe he wiste hí swilce towearde, þurh heora agene forgægednysse and ðwyrnysse. Healdað þis fæste on eowerum heortum, þæt se Ælmihtiga and se Rihtwisa God nænne mann ne neadað to syngigenne, ac he wát swa-ðeah on ær hwilce þurh agenne willan syngian willað. Hwí ne sceal he ðonne rihtlice wrecan þæt yfel þæt he onscunað? He lufað ælc gód and rihtwisnysse, forðan ðe he is gecyndelice gód and rihtwis; and he hatað ealle ða ðe unrihtwisnysse wyrcað, and þa fordeð þe leasunge sprecað. Witodlice þa þe on God belyfað, hi sind þurh ðone Halgan Gást gewissode. Nis seo gecyrrednys to Gode of us sylfum, ac of Godes gife, swa swa se apostol cwyð, "Þurh Godes gife ge sind gehealdene on geleafan."

Þa ðe ne gelyfað ðurh agenne cyre hí scoriað, na ðurh gewyrd, forðan ðe gewyrd nis nan ðing buton leas wena; ne nan ðing soðlice be gewyrde ne gewyrð, ac ealle ðing þurh Godes dom beoð geen-debyrde, seðe cwæð þurh his witegan, "Ic afandige manna heortan, and heora lendena, and ælcum sylle æfter his færelde, and æfter his agenre afundennysse." Ne talige nan man his yfelan dæda to Gode, ac talige ærest to þam deofle, þe mancyn beswác, and to Adámes forgægednysse; ac ðeah swiðost to him sylfum, þæt him yfel gelicað, and ne licað gód.

Bið þeah gelome ofspring forscyldegod þurh forðfædera mándæda, gif he mid yfele him geefenlæhð. Gif ðonne se ofspring rihtwis bið, þonne leofað he on his rihtwisnysse, and nateshwon his yldrena synna ne aberð. Ne sy nán man to ðan arleas þæt hé Adam wyrige oððe Euan, ðe nu on heofenum mid Gode rixiað, ac geearnige swiðor Godes mildheortnysse, swa þæt hé wende his agenne cyre to his Scyppendes gehyrsumnysse and bebodum; forðan þe nan man ne bið gehealden buton þurh gife Hælendes Cristes: þa gife he gearcode and forestihte on ecum ræde ær middangeardes gesetnysse.

Mine gebroðra, ge habbað nu gehyred be ðan leasan wenan, þe ydele men gewyrd hatað: uton nu fón on þæs godspelles trahtnunge, þær we hit ær forleton. Þa tungel-witegan eodon into ðæs cildes gesthuse, and hine gemetton mid þære meder. Hí ða mid astrehtum

lichaman hi to Criste gebædon, and geopenodon heora hordfatu, and him geoffrodon þryfealde lác, gold, and recels, and myrran. Gold gedafenað cyninge; stór gebyrað to Godes ðenunge; mid myrran man behwyrfd deadra manna líc, þæt hí late rotian. Ðas ðrý tungel-wítegan hí to Criste gebædon, and him getacnigendlice lac offrodon. Þæt gold getacnode þæt he is soð Cyning. Se stór þæt he is soð God. Seo myrre þæt he wæs ða deadlic; ac he þurhwunað nu undeadlic on ecnysse.

Sume gedwolmen wæron þe gelyfdon þæt hé God wære, ac hi nateshwón ne gelyfdon þæt hé æghwær rixode: hi offrodon Criste gastlice recels, and noldon him gold offrian. Eft wæron oðre gedwolmen ðe gelyfdon þæt he soð Cyning wære, ac hi wiðsocon þæt he God wære: ðas, buton twyn, him offrodon gold, and noldon offrian recels. Sume gedwolan andetton þæt he soð God wære and soð Cyn- ing, and wiðsocon þæt hé deadlic flæsc underfenge: þas witodlice him brohton gold and stór, and noldon bringan myrran þære onfan- genre deadlicnysse.

Mine gebroðra, uton we geoffrian urum Drihtne gold, þæt we an- dettan þæt hé soð Cyning sy, and æghwær rixige. Uton him offrian stór, þæt we gelyfon þæt hé æfre God wæs, seðe on þære tide man æteowde. Uton him bringan myrran, þæt we gelyfan þæt he wæs deadlic on urum flæsce, seðe is unðrowigendlic on his godcundnysse. He wæs deadlic on menniscnysse ær his ðrowunge, ac he bið heonon- forð undeadlic, swa swa we ealle beoð æfter ðam gemænelicum æriste.

We habbað gesæd embe ðas þryfealdan lac, hú hí to Criste be- limpað: we willað eac secgan hú hí to ús belimpað æfter ðeawlicum andgite. Mid golde witodlice bið wisdom getácnod, swa swa Sa- lomon cwæð, "Gewilnigendlic gold-hord lið on ðæs witan muðe." Mid store bið geswutelod halig gebed, be ðam sang se sealm-scop, "Drihten, sy min gebed asend swa swa byrnende stór on ðinre gesi- hðe." Þurh myrran is gehíwod cwelmbærnys ures flæscs; be ðam cweð seo halige gelaðung, "Mine handa drypton myrran." Þam acennedan Cyninge we bringað gold, gif we on his gesihðe mid beorhtnysse þæs upplican wisdomes scinende beoð. Stór we him bringað, gif we ure geðohtas ðurh gecnyrdnysse haligra gebeda on weofode ure heortan onálað, þæt we magon hwæthwega wynsum- lice ðurh heofenlice gewilnunge stincan. Myrran we him offriað, gif we ða flæsclican lustas þurh forhæfednysse cwymliað. Myrra deð,

swa we ær cwædon, þæt þæt deade flæsc eaðelice ne rotað. Witodlice þæt deade flæsc rotað leahtorlice, þonne se deadlica lichama ðeowað þære flowendan galnysse, swa swa se wítega be sumum cwæð, "Ða nytenu forrotedon on heora meoxe." Þonne forrotiað þa nytenu on heora meoxe, þonne flæsclīce men on stence heora galnysse geendiað heora dagas. Ac gif we ða myrran Gode gastlice geoffriað, þonne bið ure deadlica lichama fram galnysse stencum ðurh forhæfednysse gehealden.

Sum ðing miccles gebícnodon þa tungel-witegan us mid þam þæt hi ðurh oðerne weg to heora earde gecyrdon. Ure eard soðlice is neorxna-wang, to ðam we ne magon gecyrran þæs wegēs ðe we comon. Se frumsceapena man and eall his ofspring wearð adraefed of neorxena-wanges myrhðe, þurh ungehyrsumnysse, and for ðigene þæs forbodenan bigleofan, and ðurh modignysse, ðaða he wolde beon betera ðonne hine se Ælmihtiga Scyppend gesceop. Ac us is micel neod þæt we ðurh oðerne weg þone swicolan deofol forbugan, þæt we moton gesæliglice to urum eðele becoman, þe we to gesceapene wæron.

We sceolon þurh gehyrsumnysse, and forhæfednysse, and eadmodnysse, ánmodlice to urum eðele stæppan, and mid halgum mægnum ðone eard ofgan, þe we ðurh leahtras forluron. Rihtlice wæs se swicola Herodes fram þam tungel-witegum bepæht, and he to Criste ne becom, forðan ðe hé mid facenfullum mode hine sohte. He getacnode þa leasan licceteras, ðe mid híwunge God secað, and næfre ne gemetað. He is to secenne mid soðfæstre heortan, and anrædum mode, seðe leofað and rixað mid Fæder and Halgum Gaste, on ealra worulda woruld. Amen.

# DOM. III. POST EPIPHANIA DOMINI

*Ælfric's Catholic Homilies*

Cum descendisset Iesus de monte secute sunt eum turbe multe: et reliqua.

Matheus, se eadiga Godspellere awrát on þissere godspellican rædinge, þæt "se Hælend niðer-eode of anre dune, and him filigde micel menigu. Efne ða com sum hreoflig mann, and aleat wið þæs Hælendes, þus cweðende, Drihten, gif þu wilt, þu miht me geclænsian. Se Hælend astrehte his hand, and hine hrepode, and cwæð, Ic wylle; and sy ðu geclænsod. Þa sona wearð his hreofla eal geclænsod, and he wæs gehæled. Ða cwæð se Hælend him to, Warnu þæt þu hit nanum menn ne secge; ac far to Godes temple, and geswutela ðe sylfne ðam sacerde, and geoffra ðine lác, swá swá Moyses bebead him on gewitnysse."

Se láreow Hægmon cweð on ðissere trahtnunge þæt seo dún þe se Hælend of-astah getacnode heofenan rice, of ðam niðer-astah se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu, ðaða he underfeng ure gecynde, and to meniscum men geflæschamod wearð, to ðy þæt he mancynn fram deofles anwealde alycde. He wæs ungesewenlic and unðrowigendlic on his gecynde; þa wearð he gesewenlic on urum gecynde, and þrowigendlic. Seo micle menigu ðe him filigde getacnode ða geleafullan cristenan, þe mid heora þeawa stæpum Drihtne filiað. Witodlice we folgiað Cristes fotswaðum, gif we his gebisnungum mid godum weorcum geefenlæcað. "Efne ða com sum hreoflig man, and aleat wið þæs Hælendes, þus cweðende, Drihten, gif þu wilt, ðu miht me geclænsian. Se Hælend astrehte his hand, and hine hrepode, and

cwæð, Ic wille; and sy ðu geclænsod. Ða sona wearð his hreofla eal geclænsod, and he wæs gehæled."

On ðissere dæde is geswutelod Godes miht, and his eadmodnys. Moyses æ forbead to hrepenne ænigne hreoflan, ac se eadmoda Crist nolde hine forseon, þeah ðe he atelic wære, and eac geswutelode þæt hé wæs Hlaford þære ealdan æ, and na ðeow. Mihtiglice he mihte mid his worde hine gehælan, buton hrepunge; ac he geswutelode þæt his hrepung is swiðe halwende geleaffullum. Geleafful wæs se hreoflia, ðaða he cwæð, "Drihten, gif þu wilt, ðu miht me geclænsian." Se Hælend andwyrde, "Ic wylle; and þu beo geclænsod." Godes hæs soðlice is weorc, swa swa se sealm-wyrhta cwæð, "He hit gecwæð, and þa gesceafta wæron geworhte. He bebead, and hī wæron gesceapene."

On gastlicum andgite getacnode þes hreoflia man eal mancyn, þe wæs atelice hreoflig, mid mislicum Leahtrum on þam inran menn; ac hit gebeah to Cristes geleafan, and gleawlice undergeat þæt hit ne mihte þære sawle clænsunge onfon, buton þurh Drihten, þe nane synne ne worhte, ne nan facn næs on his muðe gemet. Laðlic bið þæs hreoflian lic mid menigfealdum springum and geswelle, and mid mislicum fagnyssum; ac se inra mann, þæt is seo sawul, bið micle atelicor, gif heo mid mislicum Leahtrum begripen bið. We sceolon rihtlice gelyfan on Crist, þæt he ure sawle fram synna fagnyssum gehælan mæge; and we sceolon anrædlice his willan to ðære fremminge biddan. His hand getacnað his mihte and his flæsclicnysse. Swa swa Crist mid his handa hrepunge þone hreoflian gehælde, swa eac he alysd us fram ure sawla synnum ðurh anfenge ures flæsc; swa swa se witega Isaias cwæð, "Soðlice he sylf ætbræd ure adlunga, and ure sarnyssa he sylf abær."

Mid þam ðe he forbead þam gehæledum hreoflian þæt he hit nanum men ne cydde, mid þam he sealde us bysne þæt we ne sceolon na wídmærsian ure wel-dæda, ac we sceolon onscunian, mid inweardre heortan, þone ydelan gylp, gif we hwæt lytles to góde gedoð. Witodlice ne bið us mid nanum oðrum edleane forgolden, gif we goód for gylpe doð, buton mid helle susle; forðan ðe gylp is an heofod-leahter.

Seo ealde æ bebead þæt gehwíl hreoflig man gecome to þam sacerde, and se sacerd sceolde hine fram mannum ascirian, gif hé soðlice hreoflig wære. Gif he nære swutelice hreoflig, wære ðonne be his dome clæne geteald. Gif se sacerd hine hreofligne tealde, and Godes

miht hine syððan gehælde, þonne sceolde he mid lace his clænsunge Gode ðancian. Swa sceal eac se ðe mid heafod-leahtrum wiðinnan hreoflig bið cuman to Godes sacerde, and geopenian his digelnyse ðam gastlican læce, and be his ræde and fultume his sawle wunda dædbetende gelacnian. Sume men wenað þæt him genihtsumige to fulfremedum læcedome, gif hí heora synna mid onbryrdre heortan Gode ánum andettað, and ne ðurfon nanum sacerde geandettan, gif hí yfeles geswicað: ac gif heora wena soð wære, ðonne nolde Drihten asendan þone ðe he sylf gehælde to þam sacerde mid ænigre lace. For ðære ylcan gebisnunge eac hé asende Paulum, þone ðe he sylf of heofenum gespræc, to ðam sacerde Annanian, þus cweðende, "Ga inn to ðære ceastre, and ðær þe bið gesæd hwæt þe gedafenað to dónne."

Ne gedyde se sacerd þone man hreofligne oððe unhreofligne, ac hé démde þæt he sceolde beon ascyred fram manna neawiste, gif his hreofla wyrsigende wære; oððe betwux mannum wunian, gif his hreofla godigende wære. Swa sceal don se gastlica sacerd: he sceal gerihtlæcan Godes folc, and ðone ascyrian, and amánsumian fram cristenum mannum, þe swa hreoflig bið on mánfullum ðeawum þæt he oðre mid his yfelnyse besmit; be ðam cwæð se apostol Paulus, "Afyrsiað þone yfelan fram eow, ðylæs ðe an wannhal scep ealle ða eowde besmite." Gif his hreofla bið godigende, þæt is gif he yfeles geswicð, and his ðeawas ðurh Godes ege gerihtlæcð, he hæbbe wununge betwux cristenum mannum, oð þæt he full hal sy on his drohtnungum.

Se godspellere cwæð, þæt "Drihten ferde æfter ðisum to anre byrig þe is geháten Capharnaum; þa genealæhte him to sum hundredes ealdor, biddende and cweðende, Drihten, min cniht lið æt hám bedreda, and is yfele geðreatod. Drihten him andwyrde, Ic cume and hine gehæle. Þa andwyrde se hundredes ealdor, and cwæð, Drihten, ne eom ic wyrðe þæt þu innfare under minum hrofe; ac cweð þin word, and min cniht bið gehæled. Ic eom án man geset under anwealde, hæbbende under me cempa; and ic cweðe to ðisum, Far ðu, and he færð; to oðrum, Cum ðu, and he cymð; to minum ðeowan, Do ðis, and he deð. Þa wundrode se Hælend, ðaða hé ðis gehyrde, and cwæð to ðære fyligendan menigu, Soð ic eow secge, ne gemette ic swa micelne geleafan on Israhela ðeode. Ic secge eow to soðum, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle and west-dæle, and gerestað hí mid Abrahame ðam heahfædere, and Isaáce, and Iacobe, on heofenan rice. Þa rícan bearn beoð aworpene into ðam yttrum þeostrum, þær bið wóp and toða gebitt. Ða cwæð eft se Hælend to þam hundredes eal-



dre, Far ðe hám, and getimige ðe swa swa ðu gelyfdest. And se cniht wearð gehæled of ðære tide."

Pes hundredes ealdor genealæhte ðam Hælende na healfunga, ac fulfremedlice. He genealæhte mid micclum geleafan, and mid soðre eadmodnysse, and snotornysse, and soðre lufe. Micelne geleafan he hæfde, þaþa he cwæð, "Drihten, cweð þin word, and min cniht bið hal." Soðlice he geswutelode micle eadmodnysse, mid þam ðe he cwæð, "Drihten, ne eom ic wyrðe þæt þu innfare under mine ðecene." He hæfde micle snotornysse, þaþa hé understód þæt Crist is æghwær andweard þurh godcundnysse, seðe lichamlice betwux mannum gesewenlic eode. Næs he bedæled þære soðan lufe, ðaða he bæd Drihten for his ðeowan hæle. Manega oðre men bædon Drihten, sume for heora agenre hæle, sume for heora bearna, sume for leofra freonda; ac ðes ðegen bæd for his þeowan hælðe mid soðre lufe; forðan ðe heo ne toscæt nænne be mæglicere sibbe. Drihten geseah ðises ðegenes menigfealdan godnysse, and cwæð, "Ic cume, and ðinne cniht gehæle."

Iohannes se Godspellere awrát, þæt "Sum under-cyning com to Criste, and hine bæd þæt he hám mid him siðode, and his sunu gehælde; forðan þe hé læig æt forðsiðe. Þa cwæð se Hælend to ðam under-cyninge, Gewénd þe hám, þin sunu leofað. He gelyfde þæs Hælendes spræce, and hám siðode. Ða comon his ðegnas him togeanes, and cyddon þæt his sunu gesund wære. He ða befrán on hwilcere tide he gewyrpte. Hí sædon, Gyrstan-dæg ofer midne dæg hine forlét se fefor. Þa oncneow se fæder þæt hit wæs seo tíð on ðære ðe se Hælend him to cwæð, Far ðe hám, þin sunu leofað. Se cyning gelyfde ða on God, and eal his hired."

Drihten nolde gelaðod lichamlice siðian to þæs cyninges untruman bearne, ac únandweard mid his worde hine gehælde; and he wæs gearo ungelaðod to siðigenne lichamlice mid þam hundredes ealdre. Wel wát gehwá þæt cyning hæfð maran mihte þonne ænig hundredes ealdor, ac se Ælmihtiga Godes Sunu geswutelode mid þære dæde þæt we ne sceolon ða rícan, for heora riccetere wurðian, ac for menniscum gecynde; ne we ne sceolon ða wánnspedigan for heora hafenleaste forseon; ac we sceolon Godes anlicnysse on him wurðian. Se eadmoda Godes Sunu wæs gearo to geneosigenne þone ðeowan mid his andwerdnysse, and he gehælde þone æðeling mid hæse; be ðam cwæð se witega, "Se healica Drihten sceawað þa eadmodan, and þa modigan feorran oncnæwð."

Drihten wundrode þæs hundredes ealdres geleafan, na swilce he hine ær ne cuðe, seðe ealle ðing wát, ac he geswutelode mannum his geleafan mid herunge þam þe he wundorlic wæs. Hwanon com se geleafa þam þegene buton of Cristes gife, seðe hine syððan þisum wordum herede? "Soð ic eow secge, na gemette ic swa micelne geleafan on Israhela ðeode." Næs ðis gecweden be ðam heahfæderum oððe wítegum, ac be ðam andwerdan folce, ðe ða-gyt næron swa micles geleafan.

Maria and Martha wæron twa geswystru swiðe on God belyfede: hí cwædon to Criste, "Drihten, gif ðu her andwerd wære, nære ure broðer forðfaren." Þes ðegen cwæð to Criste, "Cweð þin word, and min cniht bið hal. Ic eom man under anwealde gesett, hæbbende under me cempa; and ic secge ðisum, Far ðú, and he færð; to oðrum, Cum ðu, and he cymð; to minum þeowan, Do þis, and he deð. Hu miccle swiðor miht ðu, þe Ælmihtig God eart, þurh ðine hæse gefremman swa hwæt swa ðu wilt!" Drihten cwæð, "Ic secge eow to soðan, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle and west-dæle, and gerestað hí mid Abrahame þam heahfædere, and Isaáce, and Iacobe, on heofenan rice." Þas word sind lustbære to gehyrenne, and hí micclum ure mod gladiað, þæt manega cumað fram east-dæle middangeardes, and fram west-dæle, to heofenan rice, and mid þam heahfæderum on ecere myrhðe rixiað.

Þurh ða twegen dælas, east-dæl and west-dæl, sind getacnode ða feower hwemmas ealles middangeardes, of þam beoð gegaderode Godes gecorenan of ælcere mægðe to þæra heahfædera wununge, and ealra halgena. Þurh east-dæl magon beon getacnode þa ðe on geogoðe to Gode bugað; forðan ðe on east-dæle is þæs dæges angin. Þurh west-dæl sind getacnode þa ðe on ylde to Godes ðeowdome gecyrrað; forðan ðe on west-dæle geendað se dæg.

Ðes æfterfiligenda cwyde is swiðe egefull, "Þa rícan bearn beoð awórpene into ðam yttrum ðeostrum, þær bið wóp and toða gebitt." Ða rícan bearn sind þa Iudeiscan, on ðam rixode God ðurh ða ealdan æ; ac hí awurpon Crist, and his lare forsawon; and hé awyrpð hí on ða yttran þeostu, ðær bið wóp and toða gebitt. Fela ricra manna geðeoð Gode, swa-þeah, gif hí rihtwise beoð, and mildheorte. Rice man wæs se heahfæder Abraham, and Daud se mæra cyning, and Zacheus, seðe healfe his æhta þearfum dælde, and mid healfum dæle forgeald be feowerfealdum swa hwæt swa he ær on unriht be

anfealdum reafode. Þas rican and heora gelican becumað þurh gode gecyrrednysse to ðam ecan rice, ðe him næfre ne ateorað.

Ða sind Godes bearn gecigede, þe hine lufiað swiðor þonne þisne middangeard; and ða sind ða rican bearn gecwedene, ðe heora heortan wyrtruman on ðisum andwerdum life plantiað swiðor þonne on Criste: swylce beoð on þeostru aworpene. Þæt godspel cwyð, "On þa yttran þeostru." Ða yttran þeostru sind þæs lichaman blindnyssa wiðutan. Ða inran þeostru sind þæs modes blindnyssa wiðinnan. Se ðe on ðisum andweardum life is wiðinnan ablend, swa þæt he næfð nan andgit ne hōga embe Godes beboda, he bið þonne eft wiðutan ablend, and ælces leohtes bedæled; forðan ðe he ær his lif aspende butan Godes gemynde. Þa earman forscyldegodan cwyllmiað on ecum fyre, and swa-ðeah þæt swearte fyr him nane lihtinge ne deð. Wurmas toslitað heora lichaman mid fyrenum toðum, swa swa Crist on his godspelle cwæð, "Þær næfre heora wrym ne swylyt, ne heora fyr ne bið adwæsced." Þær beoð þonne gefeclæhte on anre susle, þa þe on life on mǫndædum geðeodde wæron, swa þæt þa manslagan togædere ecelice on tintregum cwyllmiað; and forligras mid forligrum, gitseras mid gytserum, sceaðan mid sceaðum, ða forsworenan mid forsworenem, on ðam bradan fire, butan ælcere geendunge forwurðað. Þær bið wóp and toða gebitt, forðan ðe ða eagan tyrað on ðam micclum bryne, and ða teð cwaciað eft on swiðlicum cyle. Gif hwam twynige be ðam gemænelicum æriste, þonne understande he þisne drihtenlican cwyde, Þæt þær bið soð ærist, ðær ðær beoð wepende eagan and cearcigende teð.

Drihten cwæð to þam hundredes ealdre, "Far ðe hām, and getimige ðe swa swa ðu gelyfdest; and his cniht wearð gehæled of ðære tide." Be ðisum is to understandenne hu micclum þam cristenum men his agen geleafa fremige, þonne oðres mannes swa micclum fremode. Witodlice, for ðæs hundredes ealdres geleafan wearð se bedreda gehæled. Geleafa is ealra mægena fyrrest; buton þam ne mæg nān man Gode lician; and se rihtwisa leofað be his geleafan. Uton gelyfan on þa Halgan Drynnysse, and on soðe Annysse, þæt se Ælmihtiga Fæder, and his Sunu, þæt is his wisdom, and se Halga Gast, seðe is heora begra lufu and willa, þæt hī sind þry on hadum and on namum, and ān God, on ānre godcundnysse æfre wunigende, butan angynne and ende. Amen.